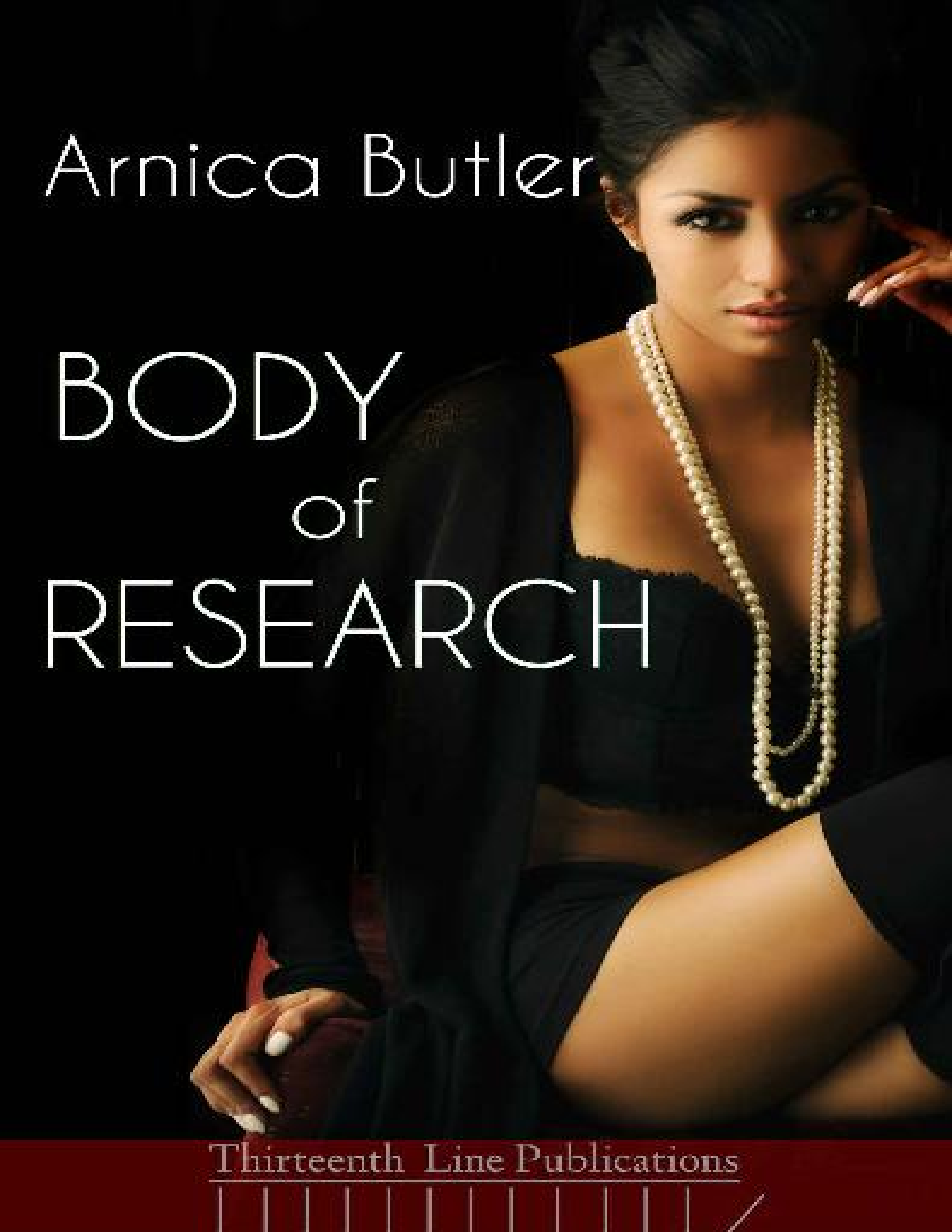


A woman with dark hair pulled back, wearing a black long-sleeved top and a multi-strand pearl necklace. She is looking directly at the camera with a slight smile. The background is dark.

Arnica Butler

BODY
of
RESEARCH

Thirteenth Line Publications

BODY OF RESEARCH

By Arnica Butler

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Chapter 1

NO REAL CONCLUSIONS

I reached over to the passenger seat without taking my eyes off the entrance to the Mackenzie Building, and unlocked my phone.

Just to be sure.

Triply sure.

Ringer: *On*.

Alerts: *On*.

Number of missed calls and messages:

My heart felt hollow and I sighed audibly.

Zero.

How long had I been waiting? I unlocked my phone again and looked at the time.

9:07.

Only two minutes.

Two long minutes.

I sighed again. Mine was a lone car in front of the building. I was parked in the fire lane, a light dusting of snow settling onto my windshield. I had spent the few minutes I had been waiting, tapping my foot, sweeping my glance in jerky circles from phone to windshield to my passenger window and the exit of the building visible through the glass.

Patience. Not my forte.

My leg tap-tap-tapped on the floorboard. I had my pointer finger pressed against my pursed lips.

Chris. If she was fucking Dave Emery, PhD., good-looking Indiana-Jones anthropologist and world-class asshole, would she have asked you to come pick her up?

No, of course not.

Still.

The door shimmered in my peripheral vision, and I jerked my head to look at it.

Exiting the building was not one long-legged Jen Sandoval, but a scrawny undergrad, nearly tipping over with the weight of a heavy

backpack. Jesus. She looked like she should be in middle school.

Disappointed, and not-so disappointed, I looked at my phone again.
9:08.

My stomach treated me to a cool shudder.

The door opened again.

This time, there was no mistaking it: Jen, a red knit cap pulled over her ears. Emery, in his very professorial wool trench coat and impossibly masculine scarf. Jen had fat, long red mittens on her hands, which she used to pat her hat down childishly (and endearingly) as she turned to Professor Emery, S.O.B., and smiled. They had evidently found something of such great importance to say to each other. Something that couldn't be said in the hallway or the office, or at any point in the whole day they had spent together, and so they needed to stand there in subzero temperatures, talking about it and laughing. Their breath left their mouths in wet clouds and mingled in the air between them.

I looked at my phone, irritated.

9:10.

I grimaced and gripped the steering wheel. I was determined not to make a spectacle of myself by honking.

I had also been determined not to get carried away by my imagination. But I had abandoned all hope with the latter goal.

For the past ten minutes, which was really all the amount of time I could reasonably claim to have been waiting, I had been doing just that: letting my imagination run wild.

Jen, do you have a minute? Emery would say. *I just need to run over these stats with you.. it seems that you've made a very, very, bad error.*

Oh have I, Dr. Emery? Whatever can I do to make it up to you?

I turned on the car engine and looked pointedly out the window as I did so. Jen and Emery continued talking, oblivious to the thickening snow, the cold, the running car.

I flipped the headlights on.

Still nothing.

I fished a scraper out of the back of the car and got out to wipe the very dry snow, which would have blown off, from the back of the car.

Jen looked over at that point. "Oh," she said, and her voice echoed like breaking crystal over the cement compound. "Sorry, I gotta go."

I raised my scraper, hoping it looked a little more like a weapon than what it was. “Hey there, *Dave*.”

I was satisfied to see the little twitch in his right hand, a slight squeeze of his briefcase. Jen had probably told me a hundred times to call him “David.” I kept my deliberate jabs to a minimum – maybe one in every ten times I whipped out “Dave.” The infrequency was for plausible deniability, as well as impact.

He raised his briefcase slightly and tucked his shmaltzy hat down against the wind before turning on his heel to head off in the direction of his cozy underground faculty parking lot.

“Jackass,” I muttered under my breath.

Jen was skipping down the steps. “Hey sweetie,” she said. She looked up at the sky.

“Whoa. Really comin' down out here,” she proclaimed, using an overzealous imitation of a rural Minnesotan accent. She delighted peppering any and all humorous statements with this accent, ever since she had returned with me to Minnesota and discovered that people actually spoke like that.

“You and 'Emeritus' really had a lot to talk about, there,” I said.

Jen rolled her eyes and used her fat mitten to flip the car door handle up. “We're soooo academic.” She slipped into the car and settled down, immediately blasting the heat.

Her cheeks were rosy red. Even bundled in her usual grad-schooly getup, which was a far cry from the schoolgirl-slutty I liked to imagine in my fantasies, she was quite stunning. Jen was a third-generation Mexican, and her skin was fair but tinted by the slightest ocher-brown, like a cup of very creamy coffee. She had a long mane of very straight, rich chocolate-colored hair, and dark brown eyes with long lashes that were also straight and subjected her to the only daily beauty regimen she seemed to indulge in: she had to curl them. (Otherwise, she looked half-asleep, and, as she put it, people started talking to her more slowly.)

Jen had a pretty face, not a stunning one: she was doll-cute. Her big, dark eyes and the straight lashes that framed them looked like they might blink slowly if you tipped her head. Her nose sloped like a ski-jump, with a little upturned hop at the end. The mannequin-nose hovered over a pretty, tidy mouth, her lips almost mirror images of each other, full but not

overflowing. The features of her face made her look far younger than she was, though she was still quite a bit younger than me (seven years, which had seemed like much more of a distance when I first met her).

Jen was one of those very nerdy girls who could best be animated by talking about space exploration or the origins of life or her own work in sociology. Her excitement about a political discussion knew no bounds, and most guys didn't really want to get into it with her. When this was combined with her androgynous clothing choices, it all kept Jen's very pretty face and lean figure from ever being accused of being "sexy."

However, Jen was a real animal in bed. That was something you wouldn't see coming, and frankly I was pretty content that most people didn't see it coming.

Content, and... discontent. But more on that later.

It was complicated situation.

"Did you," Jen said, turning to me to bat her eyelashes, "happen to buy me any Chinese takeout?"

The thing about my wife is that it was very easy, when she was nowhere around, to fall into a cycle of jealous, negative thoughts. Once she was near me, however, it was much more difficult not to just be sucked in. Jen made my thinking hazy.

"What will you give me for it?" I asked.

Jen raised her eyebrows seductively, and pulled her mitten off with her teeth. She slid her hand over my thigh. Her fingers didn't quite touch my cock as she moved her hand in a gentle, massaging roll over my leg, but the heat of her hand sent an electric shiver through me.

She shrugged.

She looked out the window - and while I knew it was just part of her enticing ploy, her way of teasing me before we got home and had pretty hot sex (for a married couple) - I couldn't help but indulge in my own twisted fantasy.

Because the direction she was looking, with a faintly smug grin on her face, and her fingers brushing *just* next to my cock, was the way Dr. Emery had gone.

*

The idea of my wife sleeping with Dr. Emery had been unsettling me for some time.

I use the word “unsettling” because it's the closest to what the idea had been doing. It kept me awake. It disrupted my thoughts. It made me think in incredibly convoluted ways.

Incredibly convoluted ways.

When we got home that night, Jen's thigh-massage, which had promised to, but never quite did, turn into an actual massage of my cock, ended abruptly. The car was barely parked in the garage when she opened the door and began to hop out. “I have to take a shower,” she said abruptly.

Convoluted thought: *Jen is taking a shower because she fucked Emery in his office and doesn't want to get caught. She wants to get in the shower and wash his cum, his dank smell, his stickiness, from her skin and the folds of her cheating cunt before I can find her out.*

Convoluted action:

I leaned over and pulled her gently back toward me. I kissed her on the mouth, which made her bristle in surprise, pull away, and then give in. I probed her mouth with my tongue, searching for the evidence of this convoluted thing I both wanted and didn't want.

It was complicated.

Jen pulled away. “Whoa,” she said. “Okay... I'm going to take a shower and you get the Chinese ready.”

She seemed to be trying to get out as fast as she could.

My chest burned with suspicion as I watched her hop up the steps.

Then she turned and held her hand up to the light, still streaming from the headlights I hadn't turned off. “You did get Chinese, didn't you?”

But she didn't wait for my answer. She dashed into the house.

I turned off the car and followed slowly. Treading in an even, measured pace into the kitchen, letting the cool fingers of jealousy and arousal curl around me.

Was I savoring the feeling?

Or trying to avoid it?

Who can say?

I walked down the hall and into the master bedroom, connected to the bathroom where I could hear the shower running. Great splashes of water crashed on the tile as Jen wrung water from her hair.

Washing her hair.

It was an invitation to imagine Emery pulling his cock, sticky with her saliva, from her mouth, so he could come all over her face. An invitation to imagine that sticky ropes of his cum had squirted from his cock, landing on her lips and cheeks. To imagine her using a finger to swipe them into her mouth, and smile as she tasted his salty seed. To picture him noticing, at the last minute, that rogue ropes of cum had dried in her satin hair.

Don't worry about it, she had laughed, pulling her red knit cap over her hair to cover them.

I sat down on the bed and picked up her red cap.

I sniffed it.

There was nothing of course, but the scent of Jen's shampoo and the faint undertone of her skin.

Of course there wasn't.

I walked into the bathroom and leaned against the wall. The tub, an antique someone had tiled into the wall, was enclosed by shower doors. Jen hated them, but I had a nice view of her lithe body, streaks of soapy water outlining her curves. Her eyes were closed as she rinsed her hair beneath the showerhead. She didn't know I was there yet. She moved her hands, eyes still closed, to the built-in shelves from which she grabbed the shampoo and put a little in her hand.

I watched her, fascinated, my imagination running wild, as she guided the shampoo to her glistening, dark curls.

I shuddered, imagining now a scene in which Emery's fat pink cock slid furiously in and out of my wife's warm cunt, and then filled her up with his creamy cum. But when he finally eased his prick from inside of her, she overflowed, and his seed gushed into her pubic hair, soaking it with the scent of her betrayal.

I slid my own shirt over my head and unbuckled my pants.

Jen still hadn't heard me, and my eyes were riveted on her fingers, combing water through her pubic curls, sliding between the folds of her pussy.

I let my pants drop to the floor, along with my underwear. My cock was rigid in front of me, and I swept my hand over it absently, still watching my wife.

Then I slid the door open.

“Ah! Fuck! Jesus!”

Jen slapped me just as I was stepping into the tub, which had a high, tiled side and a slippery, old basin. I slipped, and the momentum of Jen's slap almost sent me flying. I grabbed the shower door and knocked it off the track.

“You scared the shit out of me!” Jen said, then started laughing when she saw the swaying shower door.

It was comical. Sure.

But my mind was on other things.

Jen smiled as she looked back to me. “Well, now maybe we can get rid of...”

But she cut herself off when she saw my erection, and raised her eyebrows.

Her curls were still soapy. Water streamed down her mocha skin. Her nipples had filled out like small, round balloons, burgeoning with excitement.

I moved my hand toward her pussy. I planned to slide my fingers into her folds, and find what I wanted: some kind of evidence that she had been very naughty. Even if it was just the slipperiness of unexplained excitement. I wanted to feel the silky wetness that came from inside of her. Or maybe from inside of her lover, delivered on the couch in the office, an injection from his pale cock.

But Jen pushed my hand away lightly. Not forcefully, but deliberately. My fingers never found their mark.

And then she surprised me by sliding down to the floor of the tub, my cock in her hand. She pushed me back a little, to clear the falling water. It streamed onto the back of her head, down her shoulders, splashing a little at my balls in hot, feathery spray.

Jen looked up at me and moved my cock to her mouth. Her brown eyes burned through me as she opened, and swallowed me to the middle of my shaft. She wrapped her hand around the base, then worked her mouth and hand together to suck and pump me. I was very quickly nearing the edge. As she moved her head, water streamed down her face, and she closed her eyes.

Imagining Dave Emery's cock?

I gripped her shoulder. A sign for her that I was about to burst.

Jen looked up at me, and popped her mouth off the end of my cock. But she held the crown of my dick close to her mouth as she pumped my shaft furiously until I came.

She let my cum spurt all over her chest. A little landed on her cheek.

It all washed away with the pouring water, and then she smiled and leaned back into the water as I stood over her, panting.

My cum slid away from her body and down the drain.

“Okay, turn that off, would you? I’m going to kill myself trying to stand up with that on.”

I reached forward and turned off the water, still shaking a little.

Jen opened her eyes and looked up at me.

“That better be some good Chinese food,” she quipped.

Then she stood up, gave my cock a squeeze, and slid between the shower doors.

And that is how it was. Me and my fantasies, and my suspicions, and no real conclusions to be drawn.

That is, until she left her phone at home.

Chapter 2

LATE AGAIN

“Hey,” Jen said. She sounded slightly out-of-breath.

The back of my neck prickled with arousal. The familiar fingers of jealousy brushed over my spine.

“Hi,” I said cautiously.

Jen breathed into the phone. She was definitely doing something physical. She wasn't panting into the phone, but very low, I could hear heavier, more rapid exhales. She didn't say anything for a moment, which made my imagination run wild.

I pictured her in Emery's office, reclined on his fat beige couch. She had the phone to her ear, but her eyes were aimed between her legs, where Emery was nibbling on her pussy.

Or else she was on her knees, her hands pressed to the wall, Emery's cock inside of her.

The seconds ticked by and she breathed in little pants. In and out. In and out.

She was distracted. Distracted by whatever he was doing to her.

And he was probably smiling smugly, that fucker. Maybe all he was doing was nuzzling his mouth up against her neck and listening to her tell me lies.

“I'm going to be a little late,” she said, finally.

“Oh yeah?” I said. I did my best to make myself sound casual, but I sounded accusatory instead.

Another pause. A little bit of panting. “Yeah. Sorry. I...this is David's phone, I forgot mine or I would have called you earlier.”

David.

“So you're working late with Dave?” I said.

“Hey,” she said. It was too late when I realized that she was saying hello to someone else. I was already replying, awkwardly. “Hey, what?”

“Huh? Listen, I'm almost there. Stats are in the basement so this phone will probably cut out.”

“You need a ride?” I said. “What time will you be done?”

“You know it's...” her voice drifted off.

Oh, I got it. She had run into *David*. They were smiling at each other. About to go to the basement, to work on “stats.” I pictured her smiling at him, pointing at the phone, making a sign to indicate that she was nearly finished talking to her husband.

“...it's sort of...complicated. I'm not sure. I'll just get a ride.”

“With Dave?”

There was a long pause, while I imagined her smiling at him.

“No, with Sven the Swedish stats star,” she said, in a theatrical Scandinavian accent. “He's *so* good at binary logistic regression. It's really hot.”

I had to laugh at myself. And her, for having me pegged. She was, after all, doing a postdoctoral fellowship. She was, in fact, going into a stats lab and consulting a statistician about... statistics. And if the guy was a Scandinavian statistician, he was probably about as sexually stimulating as a plate of salted fish.

“Okay, okay,” I said, conceding her veiled point.

“He's also very good at massage,” Jen continued. I could practically see her smiling through the phone now.

“Okay,” I laughed again. Jen was great at driving me wild but also calling me out. “But no idea when you'll be home?”

Another pause. It seemed to me that she was still out of breath, which was unusual. For as big of a nerd as she was, and as little exercise as she did, she was in remarkably good shape. Her heavy breathing seemed almost ominous. “I don't know, honey,” she sighed, and for a second I was worried I had taken the joke too far. Then she quipped, in a breathy voice. “These massages can last all night.”

“I do pretty good linear binary regressionism myself,” I said suggestively.

I got a chuckle.

But no correction.

Even though it was ludicrous, my suspicions reignited. My imagination went wild again.

Maybe there actually was a Sven the Swede, doing complex algorithmic maneuvers on my wife.

“It's...sort of complicated,” she said mysteriously. Then sharply, quickly, (as if someone had appeared, someone she didn't want to know that she was talking to me) she said: “Yeah, so, I don't know. I'll just...get a ride, okay? Okay. Bye.”

“Uh...” I was saying, but I realized that she had ended already the call.

*

I stood up and paced the room. I indulged in a little more fantasizing about Jen and “Sven,” Jen and David. Then a central part of the conversation struck me:

Her phone.

She had left her phone behind.

My eyes scanned the office.

In the back of my mind, there was a rational voice, telling me that looking for my wife's phone, in order to sneak a peek at what she was up to, was a breach of trust and a bad thing to do.

Etc., etc.

It was precisely for this sort of thing, I feel I should mention here, that I was seeing a shrink. I was seeing her tomorrow, in fact - and the voice in my head took on the timbre and cadence of Dr. Heller. The voice advised me to deal with my suspicions and fantasies about my wife head-on, instead of indirectly. The voice told me not to violate our trust, and not to do the very thing I was doing.

I do possess a voice of reason, after all.
I just never listen to it.

Which is part of the reason I'm seeing a shrink.

I ran my eyes over the clutter in the office, which Jen used rarely. She had a desk piled high with dog-eared printouts of articles and books. Somewhere beneath the heaps of paper were a computer, a highlighter, and some chewed-up pencils. She knew exactly where they were, and if anyone moved one piece of paper in the messy-looking pile, she knew that, too.

No, the phone wouldn't be there. She turned her phone off when she sat down to work.

Almost putting on a show, though no one was present to observe me, I strolled casually into the kitchen and made myself a cup of tea. I looked around on the counters, and even went so far as to take a sponge out and use the pretense of cleaning to move jars and containers – in reality, searching for her phone.

Oh, sure. The voice in my head was telling me what an idiot I was being. At least I know this about myself. I'm not entirely severed from reality. Half of my mind was laughing at myself, pretending to make tea I didn't even want, in order to give myself an excuse for myself being in the kitchen looking for a phone.

I *know* exactly how psychotic I am.

It all fell apart pretty quickly anyway. I went to the living room, and gave it a brief once-over: Jen never spent any time in there, so there wasn't much point in digging around unless it was the last place I looked.

I walked quickly to the bedroom, a cool boil of excitement percolating inside of me. It would be hours before Jen got home, but there was something thrilling about imagining I was under some sort of time pressure. Sneaking around. Doing something voyeuristic.

I looked on the dresser, in her drawers, in the pockets of a jacket I thought she had worn. All to no avail. I worked quickly, feeling like a burglar in my own home. Every time I sorted through an empty pocket, or found only clothing in my hands, my excitement actually *increased*.

My imagination began to go to work, off to the side of my determined search for the phone. Maybe she hadn't left the phone here at all. *Maybe* she had left it someplace she shouldn't have been. In a car she shouldn't have been riding in. An office she had snuck away to with Dave.

A hotel room.

Dave's fancy-pants townhome.

Maybe she had lied about the phone to cover up even more lies.

I shuddered, both repulsed and delighted by the thought.

Then I began my search again.

I spun around the room, looking for additional places the phone might be.

I slid my hand under the pillows, doing it quickly and half-heartedly, because I really didn't expect to find anything there.

I was so shocked when my fingers brushed against the phone that I jerked my hand away as though something had bitten me, and the phone slid behind the bed.

I fished it out from behind the headboard, annoyed and cursing. But with the phone in my hands, my annoyance quickly faded, drowned out by the excitement I was feeling.

I know. It's a little perverse.

I promised myself to bring it up with Dr. Heller the next day.

I was working on it.

I let go of my guilt about it and indulged fully in the thing I was about to do. (This was another thing I was working on in therapy: my grand potential for justifying things I did, or making excuses for breaking my own promises).

It was strange that Jen would leave her phone under her pillow, I thought.

The dark ideas this fact inspired were very arousing.

Maybe she was texting David at night. Lying next to me and texting him when she thought I was asleep.

To get into her phone, I entered Jen's standard code for everything: 771133. Doubled digits of the address first apartment she'd rented, 713 Whitby Circle, apartment 12. Her pin for her bank card was 7711. Her password for gmail was Whitby12. She was so predictable it hurt. She had confessed all of this to me one night while she was drunk, and I had never forgotten, because I lectured her daily about password safety.

And I also liked being able to occasionally spy on her.

I stared at the phone.

Inexplicably, I had been denied access to the phone.

I shook the phone a little with my hand and re-entered the code.

Denied again.

Maybe she changed it because she didn't want you to get in, Chris. She didn't want you to get and see her dirty messages to her professor. What do they say? They must be damning, filthy, trashy messages...maybe sexts. Maybe she sends him pictures of herself...of her tits...of her excited cunt...

I shook my head and began entering all of the possible variations of Jen's usual password that could be entered in a smartphone.

I was working so fast, getting myself so worked up and paranoid about why she might have changed her code, and getting denied over and over, wondering if her Samsung would lock me out and for how long, that when I finally entered the right combination and the display opened up for me, I had no idea what I had entered to get it to do so.

I sank onto the bed.

I went to messages first. Making sure to keep my hands moving on Jen's screen, so as not to let it turn off and lock me out again, I looked at my own phone to get David's number.

My stomach was twisting into knots. Delicious, double-edged knots.

I found "Dr. Emery" in her messages.

I frowned. She seemed to have entered the name a long time ago, back when he had been her mentor and not a colleague, and it implied no real familiarity.

And she hadn't changed it.

If she was fucking Emery, wouldn't she have entered a more familiar version of his name?

It could be some kind of private joke between them, now, my dirty mind offered helpfully. Or, better yet, a way to keep her secret, secret.

I pressed on, searching for a conversation between them.

There must have been something.

My heart sank when I found it.

A single screen of text, dated and sparse:

[Dr. Emery]: *Jen. Can you stop by Harding Street to print out the BLR from last night's run?*

SAT JUNE 12 2015 3:15PM

[Me]: *Hedda's is closed. You want Starbuck's instead?*

WED MARCH 11 8:07PM

[Dr. Emery]: *Sure. Make it a soy latte then*

WED MARCH 11 8:08PM

[Me]: *I can't believe this. Out of soy.*

WED MARCH 11 8:14PM

[Dr. Emery]: *Milk's fine*

WED MARCH 11 8:15PM

Banal.

Banality overflowing. The two conversations were nearly a full year apart, and evidently Emery hadn't even followed up on the first one.

I groaned.

My reason-voice was calmly telling me that I should be both happy (my wife was obviously not having an affair with Dr. Emery) and ashamed of myself for thinking she was.

Ashamed of myself for engaging in the very perverse pleasure of spying on her, digging into her phone like this.

Actually... sort of hoping to find something else.

Actually *disappointed* that all she discussed with Emery was soy lattes.

I kept tapping at the phone, keeping it open while I thought about what to do next, what to pry into.

I should have been elated. She wasn't texting Emery late at night.

Hopefully, I went to her call log anyway.

Oh, but she was *calling* him, I saw, and my stomach twisted again. I felt a delicious squeeze in my cock. Calling him at...

2:13pm.

Seven days ago.

10:17 am, February 21.

Another plunge of disappointment.

I almost let the phone close on me.

Except...

I quickly swiped my finger over the screen.

Except: she could have deleted her messages. She could have deleted her calls.

I began to frantically swipe my finger around on her screen, keeping the phone open, trying to figure out what I could dig into on her phone to find out where she had hidden her messages.

I could get into her email, I realized, with a sudden flash of hope.

Surely something incriminating would be there.

I looked down at the phone and swiped through her apps. Jen was a geek who used geeky applications for certain things and not others, extra security for some things and then shitty passwords for them... she drove me insane. There was no telling what her email app was called -

I was looking for an email app, not really seeing anything else. I was so fixated on that task that the icons of lips, and fires, and hearts - so many hearts - swept from right to left across the screen without much notice from me for a few seconds.

But slowly, a cool wave of realization was creeping over me. A new tightness began to ball up inside my chest, squeezing my heart to a dead stop.

My fingers paused over the screen, my eyes scanning and jiggling as fast as my mind was working, blurred by too much adrenaline, too much frantic excitement.

DeBauch, one of the applications said, beneath its steamy heart, vaguely reminiscent of an ass.

I stared at it.

I moved slowly, my eyes in state of rigid shock now, my brain playing catch-up.

Another heart icon. *Lust*, it said.

Lust.

My mouth hung open.

And then, just as I was starting to awaken and think about moving, about opening one of those apps, just as I was finally about to get what I had somewhat fantasized about, my worst nightmare and my ultimate dream -

The screen went black.

I was locked out again.

Shaking, I entered codes until the screen displayed a message informing me that I was locked out for 24 hours.

I set the phone down, my mind racing.

Shit.

Shit.

Now I had several problems.

One, that there was literally *nothing* I wanted more than to get back into Jen's phone.

And then there was the fact that my *wife* seemed to be active on *dating apps*.

My heart turned icy cold and then boiled away inside my chest, in just seconds, just thinking about it.

Fuck.

Fuck.

I had a goddam hard-on. This was the other thing I couldn't believe. I mean, what kind of man actually gets turned on thinking that his wife might be cheating on him?

I was also fucking furious.

My rational voice tried to cut through my emotions.

There was nothing about any of this that necessarily meant that Jen was having an affair.

I snorted aloud. "What else could it be?" I said defiantly, aloud, to my voice of reason.

There was also the problem of the phone. I had broken into the phone and now Jen would know that. She would know I had looked for it, she would know I had dug it out from under her pillow, and she would know that I had tried to break into it.

And what the fuck was I going to say about that?

And also, what did it matter? My wife was using dating apps.

Trashy, booty-call apps. I mean, *DeBauch*?

There could be another explanation.

I stood up, leaving the phone, and headed for the kitchen to make myself a drink.

Chapter 3

DR. HELLER

"I have my best ideas when I'm drunk," I explained to Dr. Heller.

She frowned over her notepad. It was an impartial frown, the kind, I supposed, she was supposed to use.

Maybe it wasn't even a frown at all.

She adjusted her glasses.

"So what happened when Jen came home?"

I rubbed my forehead with the back of my thumb and made a face.

"Chris. Are you using humor to avoid discussing something?"

I shrugged. "It's sort of my schtick," I said.

I was extremely uncomfortable. On the one hand, my insurance was half of a shit-ton of money to see this woman, who had been recommended by a friend of a friend, to another friend, who had a completely different problem than mine, and who was well and altogether out of my PPO. Whatever my problem was, I sensed that actually telling her the truth was the whole point of therapy.

On the other hand, it wasn't much fun.

"Okay," I said. I held up my hands. I took a deep breath. My stomach was really twisted up. "I...came up with a good excuse. For the phone. While I was drinking, that is."

She nodded. "And what was that?"

I shrugged. "I just said that I needed to update something. I found her phone and I needed to update something, but I had locked myself out."

Heller's face was impassive. "And do you think she believed you?"

I stared at the wall, recalling Jen's face. I had scrutinized her expression as I told her that I had tried to break into her phone. I had hoped to see some trickle of panic creep over her lips and make them quiver, or the shade of her skin to go pale. I had half-hoped for her to start to cry, and confess her terrible misdeeds. The other half of me had hoped that some kind of devious, mysterious expression would come over, and she would half-narrow her eyes and say, seductively, "Oh. And what did you find?"

But Jen had done none of these things. Jen had narrowed her eyes (sans seduction), and sighed.

“Shit,” she had said. “When does... how do I unlock it? It was such a pain in the ass not having a phone today.”

I had waited, patiently, as though she were prey and I had built her a trap.

I was hoping for her to say she really needed something on there.

I was hoping to watch her squirm as she thought about her lovers, all the men she was leaving in the lurch by not having her phone.

Then I thought: *or maybe there was just one.*

Maybe the apps were old, and she had already found her perfect lover.

I burned with all the possibilities and all the jealousy that each one of them produced.

Back in Heller's office, recounting the story, I lied.

“I think...she probable believed me.”

I mean, that much was true.

I was omitting, of course, that *after* Jen tossed her phone on the bed, she sighed again. “Dammit,” she cursed. Then she folded her arms.

“You could use my phone,” I had suggested. “Tomorrow, I mean. I'm working from home.” (Lie). “And I'll unlock it and run your updates.”

Jen had looked confused for a moment. “What updates?” she had said, vaguely, and the whole idiotic scheme was almost blown. But she was tired, and she shook her head, and the fact that running updates on a phone was probably the most nonsensical and moronic of things, she shrugged and stomped off to the bathroom. “God, whatever. I have such a headache. Can you fix it by Thursday? Jesus, this whole thing is such a mess, that stats guy is the biggest idiot, we have to find someone else, I can't understand a goddam word he says, you know? Like, *when* have you ever met someone from Sweden who spoke shitty English? He's got to be, like, the *only* person in that country...” She had turned on the water and kept talking.

Back in the present.

Dr. Heller stared at me through my silent reverie. “Let me ask you a question, and I want you to think very hard about it: why do you think you lied to your wife about the phone?”

I didn't hesitate, or give it much thought at all. “I didn't want to get caught.”

I mean, *Jesus*. Why the fuck would anybody lie about anything?

“Okay. Let's explore that. What do you think would happen if you were 'caught,' Chris? What is it she would have 'caught' you doing?”

Oh, Dr. Heller. Such a smarty-pants. I looked at the ceiling. I sighed.

“Spying on her, I guess.”

Dr. Heller lay her notepad down on her lap and looked at me plainly. I knew she was doing that, even though I couldn't see her eyes. The woman had a way of quite suddenly boring through you like a laser cutter. Surgically. Ruthlessly.

“I think this is the most shallow answer to the question that you can think of, Chris. I think there is something deeper there. There is another thing that you're doing, and I think *that* is this thing that you don't want to be caught doing.”

I should have been a psychologist, I thought. Just tellin' people obvious things about themselves in cryptic, backhanded ways, and then taking their fucking money.

Terrific racket.

“Uh... *no*,” I corrected her. “I don't want to get caught spying on her.”

Heller tilted her head, which made her perceptive face look a little hawkish.

“I suppose my question would be: why?”

“I don't want her to yell at me,” I offered.

Heller gave me a small smile, of disappointment. She reserved it for moments when I was being a smart-ass. “Why are you *spying* on her, is what I meant. I think that's the most interesting question, and the one you should think about this week,” she raised her arm and shook the loose gold watch she wore, “because we are very nearly out of time. I've moved your next week's appointment, make sure to get a reminder card from Anna.”

*

So there was not much time to tell Dr. Heller the rest of the story.

That I had waited for Jen while she took her shower, with the idea of her phone, and the secrets it kept, burning in my mind. That she had come into the office to say goodnight to me. That she was wearing a short terry-cloth robe, one that revealed her long, slender thighs. It was crossed loosely

over her small breasts. Her toasted almond skin was everywhere, glowing pink from her signature ultra-hot shower. Her hair was wet, and dampness clung to her skin like sweat. When I spun around in my office chair to look at her, a drop of glistening water had slid down her inner thigh, licking her deliciously along the length of her lean muscle.

I had rolled over to her and placed my hands on her sculpted thighs. I pulled her gently toward me, driven by the excitement from earlier, the excitement of breaking into her phone, of nearly finding evidence of something I seemed to *want* to find. Driven also by the fact that my wife, who nearly always wore some kind of hasty outfit – a sweatshirt and a pair of jeans, which looked good but did no justice to her figure – was wearing a skimpy robe. My hands moved up her thigh.

“I’m sorry I was cranky,” she said, ruffling my hair.

I pulled her closer, and she stumbled a little with the awkward motion and her lean belly bumped into me. Feeling particularly aroused, I bit into the terrycloth belt and tugged a little. The robe parted, and a little more of her hot, damp skin came into view: the small curve of her breasts, almost to her dark nipples. A sliver of her flawless abdomen.

My hands moved along the back of her thigh. As I came closer to the center of her legs, my fingers felt the heat of her body radiating from the inside out. It was nearly 11:00, and Jen was obviously tired, so the rejection that was imminent came as no surprise to me. She ruffled my hair playfully and wriggled a little. “I’m just really tired, really annoyed by all these problems...” she said.

The tip of my middle finger pushed onward, and brushed over her damp curls.

“Chris,” she said, pushing my head away.

The robe opened a little more.

She smelled fresh, like the expensive bar of soap she used, strangely enough labeled as lettuce soap. The scent was neither feminine nor masculine, just clean. Underneath it, the tones of her skin – sweet – and her pussy (I probably imagined this) drifted into my nose and stirred me to slide further up her leg. A drop of water sprung loose from her bush and ran down my finger, while the tip of my index finger sank into silky folds.

Wet.

Wet, but slippery.

Not shower-wet.

Aroused wet.

Jen pushed away, and yawned. "I'm pretty tired," she said. "Sorry."

My head spun with possibilities. "Sven was that good, huh?"

She rolled her eyes. "Oh god. *That* guy. 'You heev hahbenuhn angelahn yadder, no?'" She rubbed her eyes. "I have to go to bed."

She was moving away from me.

It took me a moment to bring myself back down to reality. The (fully anticipated) reality that I was not going to convince her to have sex with me. I rubbed my fingers together, feeling the slick moisture on them, wondering why she was so wet and yet so unwilling.

The possibilities were delicious. Even more so because I knew she held some kind of secret now, and I had proof.

Proof.

With a start, I remembered the phone.

I rolled back to the table, trying to keep calm. "The offer still stands, you know," I said, in my wise-crack tone. "I can regression you binarily." My voice was shaky with excitement, less now the excitement of possible sex and more the excitement of breaking into her phone and her dirty secrets.

Jen gave me a light laugh. "Okay," she said, in a husky dork-voice she used to turn me down for sex.

I waited. Just a second. One second for believability.

A second, while my heart seemed to flutter a thousand times and my whole body went cold.

"Oh Jen?" I said, spinning around. "Before you go, gimme the code to your phone."

She stopped in the hall. It seemed like an eternity, the whole of which I enjoyed in immense, pleasurable pain. Did she pause too long? Was she pausing with some kind of fear... fear of being caught? Did she just realize that her apps menu was peppered with dating apps, and did she stop cold because she knew what was in them? My heart beat slowly but hard, thumping in my chest. I expected her to make an excuse, say she would just wait for it to unlock, try to discourage me from opening it and her secrets.

"Uh..." she said, instead. "It's... here, let me see it, I can't remember unless I look at it."

She came back, and stood next to me. My hands went back to her thighs, trying one more time to convince her. She squirmed away and put the phone back in my hand. “731731.”

Ah, yes.

She gave me a peck on the cheek, and scurried away. “Sorry I'm so tired,” she said. And then she yawned, a yawn that almost seemed forced. Like a fake cough into the phone while calling in sick for work.

But now that I could unlock her phone, I didn't care so much.

I spun back around to stare at the screen of my computer, imagining what it was that I would find on Jen's phone, just as soon as the lock-down timeframe passed and I could dig into her apps.

Chapter 4

UNLOCKED

When I got home from Heller's appointment, I had two full hours to wait until the phone allowed me to unlock it. Two hours to consider the treacherous possibilities that I would uncover. Two hours to imagine that my wife Jen was out screwing around on me.

Two hours, of course, that *could* have also been used pondering Dr Heller's very apt question.

Why *was* I spying on my wife?

But that isn't what I dedicated my time to.

After all, the answer was in there somewhere, and I saw a glimpse of it now and then. Just because I might not be able to articulate it precisely didn't mean I didn't understand myself, or what I was doing, or why I wanted to break into Jen's phone.

I dedicated my time instead to imagining that Jen was actually never even working late when she said she was. Instead, she was out prowling the town, getting messages from *Tinder* hopefuls and fucking in the bathrooms of bars and in disgusting college dorms and apartments. She was out seeking things I couldn't give to her: youth, a hard fuck, ropes and whips, an athletic endurance. A big, huge cock.

I worked myself up, picturing Jen pressed against the wall by a hefty, muscular man – a linebacker, perhaps – with her legs spread open and his thick meat filling her until she squealed in delight. Jen giving head on a crumb-covered couch, after responding to an invite to “Netflix and Chill.” Her latest conqueror’s hand on her dark hair, the slurp of her mouth just a decibel above the dampened sound of some terribly unwatchable movie. Her mouth filling up with cum.

I jerked off in the shower. Then I waited, scarcely able to do anything but fidget with the mouse next to my computer.

Half of me, of course, was hoping and practically praying that my eyes had deceived me. That my own perverse fantasies had somehow distorted what I had seen, and that when I finally gained access to her phone I would see nothing of the sort. *DeBauch* had actually been *DeVries* or

some shit. The hearts were all actually health-monitoring apps. The one I thought looked like an ass was maybe some political satire app.

And, in fact, it made more sense. Why else would Jen just give me access to her phone?

But the other half of me was hard at work creating a dark fantasy. Spinning all of it up into an out-of-control, orgied, frenzy. Creating dirtier and dirtier scenarios involving my wife.

After all, I'd been living off of these scraps, this idea that she was fucking Dr. Emery, who was such a prick that I really had to stretch my imagination to be turned on by it.

Okay, that's an exaggeration, but ideally, if my wife was fucking someone else, Emery was not the... exact type I had in mind.

These dating apps opened all kinds of delicious possibilities.

I waited through the eternal minutes.

At 7:17pm, I was able to open the phone at last.

I swept my fingers over the screen, and stared at the icons that slid across it. Now even more of them stood out, drawing my eyes directly to them. All the matchmaking and dating apps, there among her maps and games and calculators:

Plenty of Fish, DeBauch, Tinder, Once...

They were so numerous that my vision began to blur them together. I swept through the apps screens over and over, in seemingly endless circles. After countless swipes, I realized I wasn't breathing when my body forced a tremendous exhale from my tight chest.

Well.

This was what I wanted to find, wasn't it?

It was both my greatest fear and the thing I had secretly hoped for.

I gave the screen another voyeuristic perusal, looking over the many, many apps... so many... savoring them.

I wasn't familiar with most of them, but I knew what they were when I saw them..

Then I set the phone down.

I didn't know what half of the apps were for, other than dating. If they were trashy, hook-up oriented apps, like *Tinder*, which I only knew about because a guy at the office talked about it all the time. Or *Plenty of Fish*,

which he also wrote a whole blog about, in unimaginably callous and juvenile detail. (Posts like: “How To Guarantee A Good Lay From A Twenty-Year Old on *POF*”)

My heart felt like someone had put it in a vice, and my stomach gave me a warning twist, a faint bile taste at the back of my throat to warn me it intended to rebel.

But with shaking hands, and a mind-set that could best be described as insane, I did quite the opposite of what I'm sure my shrink, Dr. Heller, would have advised me to do:

I did not sit there thinking of ways to talk to my wife.

I delved into her phone.

And her apps.

And her profiles.

*

In the hours between Jen's arrival and my discovery of her dating apps, I had discovered a lot of very disturbing things about my wife.

Disturbing.

Arousing.

Fascinating.

Awful.

I had started with *Tinder*.

I went on a high and then on a strange low: her profile was barely used.

Her profile picture was a woman who looked like her, so much so that I didn't immediately recognize that it wasn't. The picture she had used – and who knows where she had gotten it from? – was of a pretty girl with obviously similar heritage, doll-like features and brown eyes – but it was definitely not Jen.

I furrowed my brow, so much that I eventually gave myself a headache.

What the hell would she be using a dating app with the wrong picture for?

But a similar picture.

I explored a little, my curiosity piqued. Profiles of good-looking guys popped up. I was prompted to like or dislike them.

Enraged, I disliked them all, until I had the idea to like one of them. The app prompted me with a little “i,” which I didn't hesitate to press, and I found out that the man in the picture – a dark-haired jock-ish looking guy who also seemed quite young – was only a mile away.

I quickly closed the app, fearing some sort of imminent connection.

Next up was *Plenty Of Fish*... equally horrifying and equally mystifying.

First of all, Jen's profile picture on this app was *really her*. A photo I had never seen before...and she looked quite different, but it was definitely her. Her hair was down, she had put some makeup on, she looked much more like a 22-year old sorority princess than the 28-year old sociology postdoctoral fellow that she was.

But in the POF profile she had a false name, and nothing about her profile seemed particularly true or real about her. She even claimed to like horses, which I had on very good authority she disliked intensely due to a number of bad experiences with them.

I squinted.

My heart dropped and soared. *What the fuck was my wife doing?* I felt rage and infuriation fill my arteries.

But other feelings were mixed in there, too.

I have to be fair: the idea that Jen was posing as a 22-year old bimbo, and maybe even acting on that profile, going out to hook up with guys like the profile of “Jake” - muscular, young, athletic guys with thick necks and square jaws, who looked like they would have meaty cocks they could ram into her while holding her up against a wall...well, the idea didn't *only* make me angry.

It also wound me up.

I got hard, just looking at the profiles on those two apps.

But there was another, disappointing curiosity here: these apps, too, seemed largely unused.

Largely unused.

I fumbled around, looking for any messages that had been exchanged between her and some other guy.

There seemed to be none.

But that didn't mean there aren't any, I reassured myself.

She could have deleted them.

I didn't stop there.

I went through app after app, some of which I had never heard of, some of which I couldn't navigate and had to look up on the internet. *Once*, for example, was one I had never even heard of. It turned out to be more awful than I had imagined: the app sent a match to you (or better stated, to my wife) only once a day. The romantic quality of the app sickened me much more than the others that seemed geared to sexual encounters, mostly meaningless.

Especially wrenching about *Once* was that, while the profile was a fake name and a photo that seemed eerily *like* Jen but was not, the profile information was *very much* like her.

Very much more truthful.

I tried very hard to think through possibilities of what she was doing. The hot-coal pain of the idea of Jen cheating on me was also arousing, though. It clouded my ability to think rationally.

Perhaps she enjoyed pretending to be someone else.

A lot of different someone elses.

She was bored, *I bored her*, and she sought her entertainment elsewhere.

With other men.

But she obviously didn't want her real self to appear in these apps. Hence the lies, the pseudonyms.

But *why* only on some of the apps and not on others?

For a moment, my heart soared: at least she still loved me enough to be herself for me.

Then my mood plummeted.

She was just trying not to get caught.

After all, why does anyone lie about anything?

Was it really possible? Was my wife really lying to me when she stayed out late to “work?”

I envisioned it with excruciating detail: Jen with cocktail dresses stashed away at her office. Closing the door and locking it against the

prowling janitors while she changed into a sexy black dress. Pulled silken stockings up to her thigh.

Shimmied into black silk lingerie I had never seen...

Jen with a locker at the rec center of the university. Peeling her damp skirts and rumpled shirts away, stepping out of her high heels, peeling away her dirty, stained panties. Taking a shower before she climbed back into her jeans and sweatshirts and came home, to her husband.

Jen, posing as "Jayla," the youngish, bimbo profile from her *Tinder* account. Giggling, clubbing, fucking in a bathroom stall.

Jen, as the demure and pretty Janice Hall of *Once*, slipping away to talk politics and have a bagel and a coffee with a man who drove a Lexus.

Jenna, lover of horses, virginal and conservative, letting some creep take her panties off in the back of his car because she still lived with her parents.

Jan, going to hotels and falling to her knees on the plush carpet with her mouth open to take some other man's cock inside...

I wandered through Jen's strange apps aimlessly. Her prolific profiles, her real and non-real photos. Her likes and dislikes as alternate people, all the while imagining my wife as the women she had created, flirting, kissing, fucking the men she had attracted.

There seemed to be no rhyme nor reason to her path through the men of the city: jocks and college kids from apps the ilk of *Tinder*. Older men looking for true love (though notably, only as 'true' as a woman ten years younger could provide) on apps like *TrueMatch*.

Black men, *all black men*, on an app called *Mixd*.

My heart pounded out a special, wild rhythm for that one. I would go back to it, I vowed, as soon as I figured out what she was doing.

And then, my heart beating, I found what I was looking for. What I had wanted to find, and not wanted to find, both with equal parts desperation and desire:

A message.

A response.

In all of this frenzied, crazy, apparently promiscuous searching, my dear Jen had finally messaged someone.

Or forgotten to delete it.

I found it in the dating application labeled *DeBauch*, which took me a few beats to process as “debauchery.”

“Stupid,” I muttered. I'm in marketing, and if there's one thing I can't stand it's a stupid brand name.

I dug into the app.

As I read the company slogan, my heart took another plunge to the floor.

A dating application for *married* people.

And it was then that I noticed that *DB* had numerous alerts along the top of her phone.

I opened them, one by one, my horror mounting, my cock twitching in disbelieving arousal.

I'm Matt. I saw your profile on DB You seem interesting. Want to meet up at Funky Stir?

And:

I'd never admit to a secret like that

from some loser named Mike Trenton.

I scanned the messages, some of them clearly a continuation of a longer conversation. *I'm sorry I missed you; don't worry I have a second phone...*

A curtain of red fell over my eyes.

My blood pressure was so high I felt I had maybe suffered a stroke.

I kept swiping, almost robotically, my entire body numb with shock.

And, well...

Mildly aroused.

A lot aroused.

Alternating between “a lot aroused” and “curtain of rage.”

Technically speaking, there was nothing specifically incriminating from Jen.

In her messages on *DB*, she claimed to be using (but obviously was not) have a second phone. There was no indication that she had actually met

up with anyone. No, “last night was amazing,” texts.

But poring over the texts that *were* there, I realized that I was reading what I wanted to read into them. Finding any sliver of proof, any way to contort what I was seeing, into proof of a full-fledged affair (and by that, I mean *sexual affair*. Dirty, hole-gaping sexual affair).

Jen was late again, which gave me plenty of time to look through her phone. Reading the same texts over and over. Fantasizing.

I had to jerk off again, I got so riled imagining this Mike Trenton guy (whose profile I investigated thoroughly) luring my wife back to his apartment, where he showed her his pale, thick cock, and his pink hairy balls.

Or maybe it was Jen. Jen who instigated, climbing over onto his lap in the car, taking hold of the reins in that awkward moment at the end of a date, where he was deciding whether or not to kiss her. Jen's thin body fitting easily between him and the steering wheel, her hips and ass moving in a rolling, curved wave as she rode his cock.

Or maybe, even though there was no indication of it, maybe some of those ebony-skinned men from *Mixd* had filled her with their purple snakes...

I showered, and tossed my clothes into the hamper near the dresser. Standing there with a towel in my hand, drying my hair, some scene from a movie tiptoed through my mind. A husband, suspicious of his wife, opening her dresser drawers and looking through her things...

That was the extent of my memory of the scene.

Whatever had happened after that, in that movie, was a mystery to me.

But the idea was enough to make me drop the towel. And then, looking both directions before grasping the handles – as though someone would catch me in the act, or our cat, Fritters, would stare at me in disdain – I pulled open Jen's underwear drawer.

Okay.

I was never really expecting to find anything in there. It was more the act of digging through it in anticipation that I had been looking forward to.

It was a vague idea that a snippet of a movie had planted in my head.

The mood inspired by the sexy dating apps on her phone, the circumstantial evidence that hinted at something I loved to fantasize about

but didn't want to be real.

Not really, anyway.

Inside Jen's underwear drawer, though, was an unmistakably damning body of evidence.

I held them up by the handful: silky, embroidered panties; panties made of a see-through material; red panties; expensive white silky panties. Thongs.

And then the kicker:

A whole lingerie-looking getup, bra and all, connected together by straps that hinted at bondage.

I moved backward, until the bed kicked me behind my knees and I sat down, stunned, with handfuls of lingerie in my hands.

Now my respiration had gone haywire.

So it was true.

I mean: it had to be true, right? Apps were one thing, apps with no messages. Apps said maybe she was thinking about something. Apps said we needed to have a talk, apps were just...a doorway.

But *lingerie*?

I tried to steady my breath.

Okay.

Okay:

Jen *did*, when she bought underwear anyway, buy silky and sexy things. Well, half of them were silky and sexy. She bought them and wore them once and then I never saw them again.

So this wasn't necessarily proof of anything.

But lingerie? Little lingerie getups like this?

Never. Never in all our years of marriage.

Still.

It could just be a coincidence. A lawyer would say that. This was all circumstantial as fuck.

No, you stupid fuck. A lawyer would tell you you're a fucking idiot, and your wife is having an affair, or two, or ten, right under your nose.

Chapter 5

DISCUSSION

Jen came home what seemed like nanoseconds later.

(It wasn't.

It was very late.)

I had gone back to the computer in the office, googling things like an idiot. “How to tell if your wife is having an affair;” “What does it mean if your wife buys lingerie;” all of the dating apps and their reputations; hotwife porn videos; and, for a brief moment and in an act of strange respite, re-roofing prices.

By the time I heard the door click in the front of the house, a light suddenly flooded the kitchen and crept down the hallway, it had grown utterly dark around me. I was sitting, contorted into one of those obsessive positions before a computer screen, when obsession with a task crowds out your kinetic sensibilities and you crouch at the edge of the chair with your spine pretzeled and the blood flow cut off to one hand. Only the blue glow of the screen illuminated the house until Jen flicked on the light in the kitchen.

I turned the phone off and shook my body out of the terrible position it was in.

Feeling like an adolescent getting caught by my parents with a girl in my room, I stashed the phone under some papers. My heart started pounding and I dashed into the bedroom and kicked off my pants and shirt. I lay down in bed, realizing that:

1) the act was unconvincing, because my heart was beating so fast I needed to gulp air and

2) it was utterly stupid. What, after all, did I think Jen was going to think I had done? Stayed up late to read a book, in my own house, like I always did? Perused some porn on the internet, which she knew I did anyway (though she *didn't* know exactly what kind of porn. The search terms I used. The way that “wife” made up a large portion of the searches.)

I speed-walked into the bedroom and climbed into bed: I was still wearing boxers and a dirty shirt I had numbly fished out of the hamper after

finding Jen's underwear.

Shaking with the same silly, just-caught nerves, I took a book from the night table and opened it to a random page.

I mean, *fucking ridiculous*.

She was the one who caught, after all.

I heard the cupboards in the kitchen slamming – Jen was not one to be quiet with doors, nor cupboards or cars or anything she could slam closed.

I changed my mind abruptly. About pretending to be asleep or reading.

I'm not sure why. A surge of testosterone went through me, or adrenaline, or something.

I rose and walked with a surprising amount of calm into the kitchen.

Jen was peering into the fridge. Her hair was in a ponytail. She looked tired. A gray sweatshirt slid off one shoulder, exposing the shape of her collarbone. It was sexy, but the rest of her outfit was a shapeless and formless as ever.

“Oh,” she said, looking up at me. “You're still up.”

I nodded.

I was here to accuse her, and I was filled with jealous rage that she had done... whatever she had done. I was also so turned on by my musings, by Jen's lies and profiles, and the fantasies I had spun up about them, that my cock was throbbing against the zipper of my pants.

She sighed and let the fridge swing shut. “I can't even... you have any dinner?”

I shook my head.

She looked at the clock. “Ugh. Too late to order.”

“I fixed your phone,” I said. The statement came out of nowhere.

I studied her intently as the words reached her. She pushed a fallen clump of hair from her face, long bangs that were too short to be retained by long in her ponytail. Her eyes moved listlessly around the kitchen, searching for something. “Uh-huh,” she said, vaguely. “No snacks either?” She picked up a box of cereal, and dropped it when she recognized it was empty.

Then she opened the fridge again.

I moved closer to her. I sniffed at the air, as deeply as I dared without revealing what I was doing and looking like a creep. Did she smell

different?

My nose was seeking some incriminating sexual flavor, and instead picked up the scent of cigarettes.

“Did you smoke or something?” I said.

Jen glared at me over the edge of the fridge. “No.”

Then she sniffed herself. “Oh God. Gross.” She reached in to the fridge and took out a half-empty bottle of wine and shook it. “Any idea how long this has been here?” Then, as though my comment had just made its way to her brain, she sniffed her sweatshirt. “Yeah. That's Andy. He smokes all the way back to the office. It's pretty nasty.” She frowned and went to the counter with the wine. Distractedly she said, “I'll have to get him to stop. So gross...”

I was only half-listening. Barely even thinking about what she was saying, except for the ways it might be a lie. Maybe Andy was real, but didn't it seem unusual that another man's cigarettes, out in the open air, would leave such a scent on her sweatshirt?

I went behind her and slid my hands under her sweatshirt. Her soft skin rippled beneath my fingertips as I slid them along her ribs. My fingers were seeking the fabric of her bra, hoping to find something amiss about it. Hoping to find the feel of new lace, the smooth bumps of fine satin that would reveal another piece of her treachery.

Or hoping to find the same old bra, a comfortable one with no fanfare and no frills. Proof that all of this was my imagination.

She giggled and squirmed away. “Stop it. I'm trying to pour wine, here.”

I inhaled the scent of her neck. Low clean tones of her soap, her usual soap and nothing more, were buried under the scent of her body, and an overlay of what reminded me of a library, a musty, papery, bookish smell.

“Why so late?” I asked, setting a wine glass down to indicate I would like some, too.

She harrumphed. “Just trying to make my hourly wage as ridiculous as possible,” she quipped, and tipped the wine glass back into her throat without pouring me any first. “What are you doing back there in the dark?”

I judged her voice, her tone, the way she was standing as she said it. She was so very casual, so unworried. I watched her hand as she poured the

wine: it didn't tremble, like mine would have, if I had been up to the things my wife was obviously up to.

Could she really be this grand of a liar? This careful to cover up all evidence of what she was doing?

And then be so stupid as to give me access to her phone?

I pressed up against her to take the wine glass, and then I backed away. She turned around to face me.

Her expression was expectant.

Oh. Yes.

What was I doing there in the dark?

I took a sip of the wine.

All of the thoughts about Jen and her apps and her late nights collided in my head. My brain felt soupy. My heart was pulled in two directions, each of them excruciating and exhilarating.

"I updated your phone," I repeated. My mouth felt numb.

"You said," she said, laughing a little. If anything about the phone made her feel even the slightest bit guilty, she didn't reveal it. Not even a flicker in her eyes. Nothing.

She tipped her chin down and looked into my eyes. "And....that's *all* you did?"

"Uh-huh," I said.

Now my voice was taking on a challenging tone to it.

Jen set her wine down. "O-kay. I guess Chris has something to say. What have I done now?" She was annoyed, and because I was wildly off-track, it excited me that she had the audacity to feign irritation in her voice. It fueled my fantasies and my nightmares: she was on the defensive, misdirecting, because she knew she was in trouble. "Did I forget to use some top-secret anti-virus somethingly-jiggly? Did I leave my IP-something exposed to something?" She turned, smiling, and poured herself some more wine.

Was she taking this as a *joke*?

I felt fury percolate and bubble over inside of me.

"You have a lot of apps on there," I said, carefully. "Using a lot of *personal information*."

I was close to her body when I said this, and I distinctly felt a shudder go through her. Her muscles went tense and seemed to freeze in place.

But she changed back to her relaxed expression so quickly, so easily, so convincingly, that I doubted I had felt her flinch at all within seconds. “Oh, shit,” she said. “I forgot to tell you about all those,” she said. She was smiling and she took another sip of her wine. The wine glass was steady in her hands; she could have performed surgery then, no problem. “You can just delete most of them.”

My insides went cool again.

“I... what?”

The “what?” was less about the request to delete them than the fact that my wife did not seem to care in the least that I had found her apps.

She shook her head. “I need to do it anyway, probably. Emery'd have a shitfit about it.”

I stared at her. My mouth was open.

Was she actually saying what I thought she was saying? Was her actual first concern about that prick Dave, and what *he* would say about her use of dating apps, as opposed to her *husband*?

She looked over at me as she turned back to face the kitchen and lean on the counter. She had her lips on the glass and it made her next words wet and echoed: “What?” she said with a snort. She swished the wine and took another sip. “It's unethical, I know, but it's so fucking hard to get data you can use any other way.”

I narrowed my eyes.

I know. It's probably obvious to you, by now, what was going on. But for me it was a big stretch to get to that obvious truth. In part because I was raging with anger, and it's hard to shift from that suddenly. Also, I like to be right, like anyone does, and the mounting evidence for a completely different theory just wasn't making it past the gates.

My mind was still charging ahead. Unable to believe the words coming from her mouth. Her casual demeanor.

“Unethical?” I said, numbly.

She set her wine glass down on the counter and gave me the look she gives me when I ask a question about something she believes I am supposed to know about. This is usually some fact about climate change or frogs or university policy, and something I *don't* feel I should know. “Of *course* it's unethical.”

I stared at her. What was she saying? What the fuck was my wife saying?

Of course it *was* unethical, to cheat on your husband.

But why the fuck was she giving me that look and staring at me like I had two heads for?

I was the one who had caught *her*, after all.

“Anyway,” she said, taking her wine over to the island to get on a bar stool. She half-rolled her eyes as she moved. “Could you just delete them all, or is that like, really time consuming?”

Delete them all?

“Just delete them all?” I said.

She looked back at me. “Well, not if it's going to take you forever, I can do it. I just thought you were some kind of wizard.”

She turned back to her wine.

“So you got what you needed?” I said incredulously.

She shrugged. “I mean, not really.”

I stared at her head.

She looked back at me.

At first, her eyes registered confusion. But then they seemed to brighten with recognition.

She blew wine out of her nose and covered her face with a tremendous, and utterly unexpected chortle. “Oh my fucking God,” she said. “Don't tell me you thought those were...?” She waved her hand frantically. “Oh God. My nose burns. Jesus.”

She continued squinting and waving her hand in front of her face. She was smiling, and the first sentiment I felt was an almost violent rage. A desire to slap her. How could she fucking laugh, the little bitch?

And then, slowly, it dawned on me. The pieces started to come together... but not all together.

Jen sucked in her breath. “Those are just for... well, not really research, because I can't use the data, but just...yeah, research. Basically. Oh my God. What did you think?” She grabbed a napkin and wiped her nose. Then she took another sip of wine, and then something made her laugh again. Meanwhile, I was staring in disbelief, torn apart by all of the emotions that had just gone belly-up and those that were re-ignited by this sudden twist.

Which could all still be a lie, my suspicious, tin-foil hat mind reminded me.

A careful, elaborate lie.

My eyes narrowed.

Jen looked at me incredulously, tears of laughter coming to her eyes. “Oh, fuck, Chris, what the hell were you actually thinking? My wife's just gone completely nuts and started fishing for every fucking guy in the tri-state area? I just, overnight, turned into some hu-gonjo slut.”

She made a noise.

Sipped her wine.

I had to give her something: if she *was* putting on an act, she was a world-class actress. She hadn't missed a beat. She hadn't been nervous for a second.

Except that small second.

That stiffening of her spine.

That moment of shock when I talked about the apps.

Jen was looking at me now. Peering at me, actually, Tipping her head sideways. “Oh Jesus, Chris, you *are* serious. Really? Really?”

She took another sip of her wine.

“And why would I fucking give you my phone?” she asked the general audience of the kitchen appliances. She snorted again.

Then she looked back to me. “You shit. Oh my god, I'm so stupid...that's why you wanted it, isn't it?”

She looked confused now more than anything. “Updates my ass.” She started shaking her head. “What in the hell? What the hell even got you... I don't know... digging into my stuff to begin with?”

The realization of how wrong I was was falling over me slowly. Dripping over me.

Why *had* I been digging into my wife's phone?

I hadn't thought of a good excuse for that. I had marched forward, because I had allowed myself to be convinced that she was hiding something from me, that she would be caught, that she would be the liar and never think to ask about how it came about that I looked into her phone. I hadn't expected this outcome at all.

Hence, I had no plan.

And the truth? Well, that wasn't going to get me very far, was it?

I have this sort of private fantasy, honey, that you are fucking other men. I enjoy thinking about it, I like to imagine it in high-definition, glorious detail. And so when a shred of evidence came my way, I allowed myself to indulge in what you scientists would call a confirmation bias, and let my imagination run away to some really dirty places...

“Chris?” she repeated.

My thoughts, drifting along as they were, stopped cold.

“What about that app, DB, DeBauch-ery? You have messages on there,” I said, accusatorily.

Jen opened her mouth.

Oh, now she was indignant.

Now she was pissed.

“I can *not*!” she said.

(As in: “I can *not* believe what a shit you are.”)

But she *did* have messages.

She had exchanged messages.

I had seen them.

“I saw your messages,” I said.

She folded her arms over her chest. “Uh huh.”

I opened my eyes wider to indicate she needed to explain further.

“Oh for fuck's sake. Get my phone. Let's just go through it together, shall we?”

I stormed off in the direction of the office while she got up and poured herself another glass of wine. “I cannot fucking believe this shit,” she muttered, in a voice that was supposed to be “under her breath,” but was definitely audible enough for me to hear.

I stormed to the office, and dug under the papers for the phone. All of the competing feelings inside of me were now brought front and center – the feelings I had tried to submerge, the hidden feelings I had tried to keep stashed. The effect was both intoxicating and sickening. I felt like I was moving in slow motion.

I came back with the phone in my hand, my blood pressure so high I could hear my pulse, watery and low, in my head.

Jen opened the phone, expertly, and swept her fingers over it. “Okay,” she said. “This one? DeBauch...God, what a stupid name...is that the one

you're talking about?" Her voice was pretty high-pitched now. She looked up from the phone and glared at me. "What did you see, exactly?"

"You... have messages. Messages in there." I pointed at the phone, and then I suddenly got mad again, feeling indignant. What the fuck was I simpering about? I wasn't the one who had flirted with someone else on online dating apps.

"Yeah," I said, agreeing with myself. "What the fuck, Jen? You're the one sending messages to guys, you're the one with a hundred profiles on fucking *dating apps*. So don't get snotty with me about it. You owe me an explanation."

Jen's eyes went black with rage. "And I fucking gave you one!" she snapped. "Didn't I? This is all just shit I'm doing for.. for this stupid project. *God!*" She threw her hands up in exasperation and growled the last word. "What the hell is so hard to understand about that?"

"Right. For research. Sure. Tell me how *that* works, Jen."

Her eyes were furious as she stared at me, her mouth open.

Then I thought I saw a flicker of amusement.

She twisted the phone in her hand. "You total ass. This is all happening because *you* haven't been *listening* to a word I fucking say about my research."

This particular statement pierced through the blind rage I was experiencing.

Another thing about Jen: she's like a high-powered attorney once she decides she's right about something and you're going to be prosecuted for it.

Crucified is more the word. As an academic, she's pretty quick to gather up evidence and present it to you, along with your ass. But right now there was another kind of storm brewing in her mind.

"No?" she said. "Do you deny it?"

"Straw man!" I yelled helplessly. It was the only logical fallacy I could remember the name of, and it worked half the time.

"Wrong fallacy," Jen said, calmly and coolly. "So let me ask you something. What is it I'm researching, Chris?"

The hammer came down.

I was in a corner now. It was true, this was not a conversation about her research, but it obviously had *something to do with it*, or she wouldn't have had that smug little grin on her face.

I grasped at straws inside my mind. “This is about why my wife is messaging men on a dating app, Jen,” I said, but my bluster was gone. Something about the smugness of her smile was making me feel a little less certain of myself. That, and the fact that I couldn't remember what the fuck she was researching.

Jen twisted the phone playfully. “Huh,” she said. “All this time, and I've told you about my research how many times, and you can't think of it at all?”

I opened my mouth. “It's... look, I can't describe it, Jen, in exact detail. But that isn't what we're talking about -”

Jen let out a sharp laugh. “Okay, enough. Stop it. Here, let me give you a clue: There is a *reason* that I am talking about my research, a propos of this conversation about *dating apps*. ”

“Dating apps” was delivered to me with an acidic hiss and a venomous look.

Oh yes.

Now I remembered.

Shit.

Jen exploded. She held her arms up to either side of her. She was smiling, but she was pretty pissed.

“How could you sit there and listen to me all this time, and not hear a word I was saying? You're such an *ass*. ”

It was all coming back to me now. The numerous nights that Jen had discussed her research with me.

The numerous times I had zoned out as she went into great detail explaining statistical tools I knew nothing about and did not understand, or into great detail about the ethical guidelines and the changes that had been made to them as a result of...

Whatever. I did not remember the details, only that she had given them to me and I had zoned out.

But I had certainly listened long enough to know that the *topic* of Jen's research, generally speaking, in broad terms, was something to do with dating apps.

Still. I could barely see why that meant she had to personally use them.

And then I remembered the new underwear I had found in her drawers.

So all this stuff went through my mind like an arrow – well, shrapnel is maybe a better word – and I blurted out, incoherently:

“But what about all your new underwear?!”

Jen narrowed her eyes.

There was a long pause while she stared at me in utter disbelief. “*Seriously?*” she said, finally. She shook her head. “I bought some new underwear. Do you ever do that, Chris? Think: ‘oh, I don’t want to wear five-year-old underwear?’ and buy some new?”

She stood up again and walked over to the still-empty wine glass to pour some for me. She handed it to me as if it were a medication I needed to take. Wordlessly.

Like, *drink the fucking wine Chris, before I’ll say another word to you.*

I gulped my wine, and she finished hers, staring at me suspiciously.

“I didn’t forget your research,” I said, and I felt like I was flailing again. “I mean... I did, I forgot it while I was.. looking at these, but I mean... I didn’t... I remember it now. It’s not like I was never listening.”

Jen folded her arms. “How in the hell could it *not* have jogged your memory a little, when you saw *Tinder* on my phone? I mean, *Tinder*? Chris? Seriously?”

“You’re still flirting on that other one..that...what is it? *DeBauch*. That isn’t *Tinder*. That’s an app for married people.”

My voice ended up sounding more hurt than I meant for it to.

Jen’s face softened. “It’s just research,” she said. “I am *sure* I mentioned it.”

Her voice went very soft, very low, and I caught the red flush on her face.

The feeling that went through me was weird. I had been feeling a slow spiral of disappointment since the moment it had dawned on me that this was all part of Jen’s research. Like a deflating balloon.

And now, now that my wife was looking down at the floor and blushing with her inability to tell even – perhaps? - the whitest of lies, I felt...

Hopeful.

Hopeful that maybe there was a chance that her explanation was not as airtight as it seemed. That she *had actually been up to something*.

Fuck.

What a demented man I was.

“You didn't mention it,” I said, suddenly brave. “You didn't mention it at all.”

Jen looked at the floor for a moment longer. Then her eyes snapped up to look at me. “No, it's true. It was... like I said, super-unethical. I was trying to speed something up, take shortcuts, I don't know... I backed out of it after I did it and -”

“How long ago was that?” I snapped.

But I wasn't snapping like an angry dog. I was a hungry dog. I wanted to hear her confession, a confession that she maybe had started this all out as research, and then gotten carried away...

Jen rolled her eyes. “Okay... a while. It's just...” her voice trailed off.

And then she suddenly looked at me with another flash of anger.

“And what's all this about my new underwear? I mean, what is *that*? Why are you digging though all of my stuff anyway?!”

My mind raced.

“Don't try to change the subject,” I said sternly.

“Oh, I think that *is* the subject. I think it's very much the fucking subject.”

“You and your dating apps are the subject!”

“Explained. Now what are you doing going through my underwear?”

I lifted my hands and let them collapse in exasperation.

“And why... like, you did this last night, didn't you? So why the...”

Jen was thinking.

I could see her circling the truth – whatever that was – like a hawk. Coming lower and lower, her vision getting clearer all the time. She had, in this time, poured us both another glass of wine.

And then she looked to the side, swirled her glass, and said, in a very low voice:

“Does this have anything to do with your porn?”

My entire body stopped moving. Like I had been hit with a cryogenic freeze. My heart stopped, my breath stopped, my brain even froze up. I was just there: unmoving, unthinking Chris.

And then my ice-cold, adrenaline-infused heart began to knock at my chest.

“Huh?” I said, stupidly.

Jen took another large swig of wine. “Man,” she said. “I’m a little tipsy. So that’s why I can ask you straight-up. I’ve sort of... come across some of your porn sites. And I was like, what the hell is this? So then, I did some research.” She smiled at my stunned expression. “You know me. I *love* research.”

My mouth flapped a few times.

“What.. what are you talking about?” I said.

Jen gave me a strange shrug. “Watching naughty wives, or whatever. *Hotwives*. You know? I found it on your computer.”

I was slowly shaking my head.

“I never said anything about it because I figured, like... it’s your business,” she continued, as though we were talking about some misplaced shoes.

“What?!” I whisper-yelled.

“I wasn’t snooping,” Jen was quick to say. “I just... okay, the *first* time I wasn’t snooping.”

I drank a big gulp of the wine she had poured me.

Then another.

We looked at each other across the counter.

And then we laughed.

“Truce?” Jen said. “About the snooping, anyway?”

I nodded.

Cautiously.

I was still pretty shocked by my wife at this point. Nothing about the way she was behaving was predictable.

Yet, I realized at the same time, I had never really bothered to predict what she would do if she ever found out about my fantasy. So could I even say this was unexpected? I had never thought this far ahead.

“So... you thought I was cheating on you. Because of the apps and the underwear.”

I nodded. It seemed pretty silly now.

Jen snorted and sort of rolled her eyes. “I’d like to think you think I’m smarter than that,” she said, just before swallowing another swig of wine.

She set the glass down. "And you kind of liked it?"

I nodded again.

"Because of the... porn, or whatever."

Again, I nodded.

"Huh," Jen said.

She was pretty lit. Her cheeks had an unusual flush to them, and her dark eyes were consumed by her dilated pupils, giving her a half-vacant, half-juvenile appearance, especially in the dim light of the living room. A smile played across her lips.

It was an unexpected reaction. Again. I looked at her, more confused than anything.

She swirled her wine again. Then she gave the wine an almost surprised look. "Wow," she said. "I've had a *lot*."

This was an opportunity, I realized. An opportunity to get out of this conversation with my dignity intact, and hopefully after that Jen would go to bed, sleep on it, and not want to bring it up again. I stood up. "Well," I said, "we should probably get to bed."

"No, hang on," Jen said quickly. Her voice was silly, friendly. She tugged on my arm. "No, you can't just... say all that and then..."

Man, she was really loaded. She moved her hand along my arm, though, sending a shiver traveling down my forearm and directly to my spine, where it quivered through the length of my body. The arousal that I had been feeling all night intensified, and I sank back onto the stool.

Jen took out her phone. She held it between her four fingers and her thumb, and spun it carelessly. "So... you're saying it's kind of a turn-on? Like, if you thought it was real?"

Her words sent what felt like liquid nitrogen through my veins. I froze. My heart stopped.

I mean:

This was the conversation I always wanted to have.

She started walking into the living room. She looked behind her to beckon me to follow her. I did.

Jen's sweatshirt was draped seductively off the shoulder. I stared at her skin, unable to formulate a response.

She stopped twirling the phone. "Is it my profiles you liked?"

She collapsed on the couch.

Her question was serious. She was looking at me. Looking at me not with her inquisitive scientific face, which is what I might have expected, but a different kind curiosity.

“Chris?”

I willed my mouth to move. After all, I had to say *something*.

“I, uh... well, it's... yeah, it's kind of hot. You know, your pictures are... hot. And it was sort of...”

I sounded, I realized, a bit like a moron. I sank onto the smaller couch.

“Huh,” Jen repeated.

“Okay,” I said, rubbing my palms over my knees. “Well, then, I'm -” I was going to make another dash for bed, but Jen leaned toward me and put her arm on mine.

“Do you mind if I confess something?” she said. Her eyes were wet and excited, dark and dilated and sexual. She sucked in her breath, while I thought to myself about whether I *minded* if my wife confessed something while we were on the topic of my getting turned on by her dating apps.

She looked over at me. She had a smile on her face that told me she was going to “confess” no matter what. “Okay... don't get mad. At least, I hope you don't get mad, but I figure since you said all this... whatever it is... anyway, okay, here goes:”

She sucked in her breath again, while I imagined myself jumping on top of the lid of my head to keep my impatience from boiling over, grabbing her, and shaking her while screaming: “What?! What, dammit?! Just spit it out!”

“Okay...” she said, and another long, torturous pause.

“I kind of, like, it sort of... turned me on, you know, too? Like, not so much thinking about cheating on you, or anything like that, but just...thinking about like, I don't know, having to go out and flirt with some guy... She stopped, and looked away. Then she added, “In the name of science, of course.”

“Of course,” I said. My voice was low.

I put a hand on her knee.

It would have been possible to cut through the tension in the air that night. The energy between us.

Or maybe I'm imagining things. It's how it felt for me, though. I was nervous, sweating on my palms, and my chest felt tight as I managed to get out a question:

“What, uh, what would you...imagine?”

She tipped her head back against the couch. “Oh, my God, no, that's a secret.”

“Come on.”

She shook her head.

I moved my hand up her knee, inward toward her thin inner thigh. The jeans she was wearing were a thick material, and it was hard to know if I was sending any kind of signal through them.

But then she gave a light gasp. More of a puff of air, a little high-pitched with excitement as it escaped her lips. I moved a little closer to the center of her legs. “Come on, I'm game. Just for fun,” I said. “Here, show me one guy you thought about, tell me about him a little, and then I'll drop it. Promise.”

She looked at me.

“But I didn't actually like, think about it,” she said defensively. “Not doing it. Not for *real*. So... because you aren't, like, actually serious, right? It's just fantasy?”

But even as she said this, I could see from her face that she was torn by the same ambivalent feelings that I was. Or at least, I hoped that's what I saw. Even as she formed her doll-faced features into an expression of demure worry, with just a hint of trepidation, I could see the gleam of interest in her eyes.

Genuine interest.

Not only that, she leaned toward me, and her own hand made its way to my groin, where she found my very erect cock.

Her eyebrows raised, just slightly, and her eyes held mine. There was a kind of complicit smile between us in that moment. Still, we were circling the issue, neither one of really certain the other wasn't just joking. “Sure,” I breathed. “Just fantasy.”

Her hand was still on my cock, and her face was still contorted into her expression of mild concern. “Okay,” she whispered, and lowered her eyes as though she felt contrite. “I liked this profile.”

Her words sent a shudder through me. The shudder of excitement surged in my cock, and she must have felt it, recognized that it was the result of her words. My own secret was unraveling, and surely she knew that.

It took me a second to realize that she had lowered her eyes to look at her screen.

She held the phone up, screen toward me, after swiping through it with an easy expertise that betrayed a lot more usage than she seemed willing to admit. The practiced, minute movements of someone who got on an app often. Searching. Another shudder went through me as I looked at the screen.

“Sam,” I said, dryly, staring at the picture and reading the name.

The guy looking back at me was in his late twenties at most. Like Jen. A manly smattering of stubble graced his jaw. He had a shock of dark hair, long-ish and very stylish. He was fit, posing while on some kind of mountaineering expedition, an ax in his very muscled-looking hand. Wiry forearms and biceps were evident beneath his shirt.

Okay, so: I'm not a super-athletic guy, but I do okay. I was always a little thinner than most guys, which has served me well because now I'm not fat and I don't have a pot-belly. Still, one thing I've always felt a little intimidated by is the sort of muscled, upper-body fitness that a guy like “Sam” has. The jealousy of it rippled through my body, burning and arousing and horrible all at the same time. “Nice biceps,” I said, trying to keep my voice as even as possible.

It was a delicate game, eliciting a certain reaction in Jen, once that was based on the pleasure of jealousy, without revealing my actual jealousy or hinting at exactly what kind of jealousy I felt. “Is that what you liked about him?”

But for all my efforts at maintaining a calm voice, I knew that the physical response I was having was betraying me. The response to thinking of Jen running her hands over “Sam's” biceps, the idea of her enjoying the hard feel of them, taking pleasure in the shape of his body under her palm, was snaking through me, and I knew Jen could feel it under her hand, which she had slowly begun to rub over the shape of my cock.

In her eyes, something flickered. “I, uh... yeah, that's one of the things I liked about him.” She changed her sentence, which had surely begun as

something else. “His biceps.”

“Because he seems like a really strong guy,” I said.

“Yeah. It's sexy,” she admitted.

I began to unbutton her jeans. She didn't resist at all, and when it started to take too long, she squirmed out of them. While she did that, and we looked at each other in a sort of state of disbelief – after all, this was totally new and strange territory and not the kind of thing we ever did, at all – I took my own pants and underwear off.

Jen's panties, I noticed, were from the new set she had purchased. Even though we had already talked about, and she had dismissed my suspicions with an easy explanation, I stared at her panties and couldn't help feeling another wave of jealous fantasy rolling over me. The transparent material was so unlike her, so impractical. An intricate, delicate lace lined the top, and the -

I sucked in my breath. Through the transparent material, I had a nice view of the triangle of hair on her mound.

And it was neatly trimmed, bare except for a trim v-shape just above her slit.

I felt like I was getting slammed in the head with a hammer. The room spun.

What was that about?

Just yesterday, my mind whispered, she was not this well-groomed. Remember her curls in your hands?

The sight of her trim bush sent suspicion and jealousy careening through me again.

But instead of angering me, it turned me on more than anything.

In fact, I recognized: I had almost *wanted* my jealousy reignited.

At least for this little role-play, at least while we fucked.

I dropped to my knees on the couch and slid her panties off with my hands. I left them at her ankles, and used one hand to push her legs apart, gently, staring at her trimmed bush and the glistening slit that blossomed open as she spread her legs. She was wet, excited, and the scent of her cunt made me wild as it assailed my nostrils. With my other hand I felt the panties: soaked through, sodden with her excitement.

She, like me, could not hide the fact that whatever it was we were thinking, however fantastical or realistic we wanted it to be – it was driving

both of us wild.

But I could see with my own eyes now. Her cunt was wet and shone in the light.

I wrapped my hands around her thighs and pulled her closer to me. “Keep talking,” I said. I ran my tongue along the left outer lip of her pussy, lightly, pleased with the ripple of pleasure that went through her body. I did the same to other side, teasing her. To my surprise, she opened her legs wider, inviting me in.

Jen was a fun time in bed, but she wasn't really big into oral sex, giving or receiving. She usually squirmed away from my mouth, and if she gave me head, she was always very willing to put an end to it and seemed to do it out of duty more than anything. But now she was parting her legs wide and applying a gentle pressure on the back of my neck to draw me forward to her soaked lips.

And then there was the other day, in the shower...

What was going on with her? A feeble voice wondered.

But my libido took over my mouth, pressing forward, prying at the “story” I wanted to hear from her.

“Did you ever get in touch with this guy?” I asked.

Jen was looking down at me. “Uh..I...” again something flickered in her eyes. “Yeah, I was in touch with him a lot.”

She was lying, and it was obvious, but it still cut through my gut.

“And you met him?” I lapped at the wet center of her gash, where her small, neat clit was fat and swollen and begging to be sucked into my mouth. But first I hoped to draw a little bit of dirty talk from Jen.

She shook her head.

I slid my tongue into the damp crease between her folds and then crossed over her clit, briefly sucking her button up inside my mouth, giving her a taste of what I could do if she only relented, or understood what I wanted her to say.

To pretend.

Jen closed her eyes, and opened her mouth.

I pulled away, brushing my lips over her engorged sex, my cock pulsing each time she shuddered with pleasure and moved her body toward my mouth. I let my hot breath drive her wild, but I held her by her thighs just centimeters from my mouth. “Tell me about meeting him,” I said.

Jen's eyes opened, and she looked confused for a brief second. Or hesitant, like she couldn't believe what I was asking. Her mouth started to form the word, "what?" But then a look of boldness, of curiosity and interest, washed her confusion away.

A very sexy look came over her face at that point. A sort of hesitant determination. "Yeah, I met him," she said.

"And?" I let the blade of my tongue slide over her slippery clit. Her thighs shook in my hands. I drew away, trying to extract just the tiniest bit of fantasy from her, even though I was driven so wild by this time that I could barely stand it. "Was he as hot as his picture?"

"Yeah," Jen breathed, and even though it was plain and without detail, so far from what I wanted her to say, I rewarded her by sucking her clit into my mouth and rubbing the tip of my tongue over the rough knob of hypersensitive skin in the center. She moaned, and pressed her hips toward me.

I treated her to a rhythmic pulsing, and was pleased when she began to nearly hyperventilate, coming closer and closer to the edge.

Then I slowed the motion of my tongue, and disappointment moved frantically over her face. "What do you want...me to say?" she said.

"Did he have a big cock?"

She looked a little alarmed, but she was desperate, so she purred: "He did. I..."

I drew away from her clit, which was pulsing in my mouth. She mewled, and then dove right in:

"I put my hand on it."

I drew her clit back into my mouth and laboriously swept my tongue over the center. Jen moaned and tried to push herself into my mouth further, hungry now.

"I felt it through his jeans..." she began, and I released her clit and licked at it in short spurts.

"Oh god...okay...and then I got wild..."

I sucked her back into my mouth.

"... and I slid my hand into his pants. And I just grabbed it..."

I looked up at her face. She was flushed, sweating along her hairline, and a single bead of sweat had formed on her upper lip. Her eyes were wild. Her pussy was gushing with excitement, and her body was tense with need. "Tell me more," I said.

“I grabbed it, and I liked it. It was so big, so thick... I wanted to... I wanted to...”

By now I had begun sucking on her clit in earnest, and I felt her breath stop in her chest and her whole body rattle with a very sudden and intense orgasm. Her voice was caught in her throat with a squeak, and then she yelled as she grabbed my hair and pulled. Her already sopping cunt seemed to melt in my mouth, turning to heated liquid, dribbling down my chin.

“Oh fuck,” Jen said.

I stood up and shimmied out of my pants. Jen remained as she was, splayed on the couch, her legs spread and her eyes half-closed, her thighs still quivering with the last shudders of her orgasm.

I was planning to sink into her pussy, and I was starting to kneel again to get in to her hot, liquid center, when she surprised me by sitting up suddenly. She grabbed my cock and squeezed it.

Then she pulled me toward her, leaning in, and suddenly her mouth was surrounding my prick. She sucked a little on the end of my cock. I stared in shock – like I said, oral, either way, wasn't really Jen's thing.

She surprised me even further by leaning her head back, and holding my cock in her hand, stroking me slowly, with the very tip of my dick resting on her lower lip. A bead of precum dripped down and smeared over her lip as she moved the ridge of my head slowly across it. The crown of my cock grazed the smooth ridge of her upper teeth. I shuddered.

“I wanted to suck on it,” she said. “I don't really know what came over me.”

My eyes went wide, and my cock squeezed out another pearl of hot precum. The meat of my dick flexed violently in her hand, and then again when a look of pleasure came over her face because of my reaction.

“I wanted to suck it, just like this,” she said.

She took me into her mouth, and I sucked in my breath, trying desperately to keep myself from exploding in her mouth right then and there. Her lips kept going, deeper, deeper, all the way to the base of my cock.

She swallowed me whole, and then she moved her mouth back up the length of my shaft.

Again.

I grasped the back of her head as she started to move faster. I knew she didn't like it when I came in her mouth, and though it was rare for her to suck my cock, we had worked out a sort of silent, awkward maneuver for her to pull away just when I came. I pulled on her hair, trying to push her away, because I could feel myself tipping over the edge.

But I was met with an opposite resistance, and Jen pushed down deep, sucking me hard, just as I went over the edge. "Jen, I...fuck..."

I never finished whatever it was I had intended to say. My cock exploded in her mouth, and I felt the load of hot cum fill her cheeks and swirl around my cock.

She kept sucking, and the liquid disappeared, sucked into her throat.

She swallowed my cum.

Then she slid away, sucking up all of the cum that coated my shaft as she did.

She released the crown of my dick with a puckered pop, and let herself fall back against the couch. She had a smile on her face, the kind of smile I had never seen before. A very sexual, pleased, smile. I was panting, stunned, with my still-hard cock pointed straight in front of me.

"Whoa," I said, to fill the silence.

Jen suddenly covered her face with her hands. "Oh my god," she said. "I can't believe we just did that."

I crawled onto the sofa next to her. "Why not?" I said. "That was really hot."

She dropped her hands and looked at me. The look of slight disbelief was back on her face. "Really?" she said.

I tipped my head sideways. "Seriously?" I asked.

She laughed. "No, I mean, it was hot... but you mean, like... I don't know, it's just so... I mean, you know I was only pretending, right?"

"Of course," I said.

"And that I wouldn't ever like.. actually..." Her voice drifted off, and she looked in front of her. Her eyes became a little distant. A little vacant. Her expression changed.

It was the change in her expression that pushed a lot of things back into my mind.

Sure, Jen had provided an explanation for practically everything I had been suspicious of.

But things like her new underwear still irked me.

I looked down at the appealingly shaved v-shape of her neatly trimmed bush.

Now... it wasn't as if she never did anything about her pubic hair. She was prone to trim it up, or go get a wax for the summer, or at some strange, seemingly- random point in time, get waxed for no reason at all. But she would do this and then go six months without giving it another thought. So really there wasn't anything *super* unusual about this.

Except the timing.

Except, when stacked up with all the other things that were plausible and easily explained, it painted a picture of too many coincidences. Too many things that were sexual, and different, all at the same time.

I touched the silky, trimmed hair that remained above her gash. "This is new," I said.

She looked at my fingers. "Oh yeah," she said. "That."

And then there was a pause.

Depending on what I felt like when I remembered it, the pause was either extremely long or very brief. When I wanted to think about my wife cheating on me, hiding secrets, and being a whore with all of her dating app men, I remembered the pause as very long. A liar's pause, a moment she hadn't anticipated. A cover-up she had forgotten to create.

But then, when I am in a mood in which I am disinclined to think of my wife as a cheating whore, the pause was brief. More like the pause of someone who had a question put to them out of the blue.

She turned to me and smiled.

The smile seemed genuine, but I was starting to think that my judgment meant nothing. She drew a hand up next to her cheek and dragged the back of her palm lazily upward along her face as she stretched. "I got all that new underwear and it was like, 'whoa,' better do something about that."

I nodded, biting my lower lip. "Mmhmm," I said. "So that's not for your new boyfriends?"

She rolled her eyes, and stood up. She slid her panties up and over her hips. The back of the fabric was totally transparent, and cast only a sexy black mesh over her tight ass. "I told you," she said, bending over to pick up her jeans and sweatshirt, giving me a nice view of her very wet, trimmed cunt through the material of her panties. "I only have the one."

Another shudder went through me, and incredibly, I felt my cock coming back to life.

Jen stood up and shook her hair out behind her. “Man,” she said, changing the subject. “I am hosed. I have to go to bed.”

She pressed her fingers to her lips and blew me a kiss, without fully turning or meeting my eyes.

There are a lot of ways, of course, to interpret all of this. None of them are 100% convincing in their own right.

And sitting on the couch, another hard-on gathering in my dick, I wasn't entirely sure I wanted to be convinced of one thing or the other.

Chapter 6

NEW DRESS

I felt like something had genuinely changed in our relationship the next morning.

I could have viewed the change as a change for the better, if I wanted to see it that way. Jen was in a chipper mood, and an affectionate mood. This was much different than her usual cold, distanced, and crabby morning self. Only after a cup of coffee did I normally dare talk to her, and it had become a general fact of life that I wasn't going to feel any physical affection before 11am. It had been like that for years now, which had never worried me all that much.

After all, every married man I knew had a similar experience.

But the morning after our foray into my fantasy, Jen greeted me in an oversized shirt and stood on her tiptoes to kiss me on the cheek, before she even found a mug for her coffee. “Hey,” she said, and her voice was deep with sleep and what seemed to be a hangover. She moved to the other side of me, dragging her hand over my shoulder blades as she did.

“What time do you get *up*?” she said, ending her sentence with a yawn.

There was something fun about the way she was saying this. Almost like we were new lovers, and it was a question she didn't know the answer to. I felt the hum of nostalgia inside of me, a resuscitation of the feeling we had between us right after the first night we slept together and realized we were very serious about each other. The hum of attraction and newness and uncertainty, the cool feeling of it in my chest.

As she leaned against the counter and reached up to grab a coffee mug from a tall shelf where they were kept, her shirt pressed tight against her figure and her hard nipples showed through the thin white fabric. The back of the shirt rode halfway up her rear, and it appeared that she was wearing no panties.

Compulsively, I reached out and put a hand on her ass. I ran my palm up and over the firm round shape of her buttocks, and discovered that my

assumption about the panties had been correct. Her skin was smooth and firm, and fit into my cupped palm nicely.

Instead of becoming annoyed, which is what I would have told a bookie to put the odds on if I had been describing this scene just ten hours before, Jen just dropped onto her heels and left her bottom in my hand. I let my pinkie finger slide along the valley between her asscheeks, and when it nearly reached her pussy, I felt a slick moisture.

I was already dressed for leaving the house – that was, after all, the reason for Jen's question. It was only 6:30 and I had clearly been up for a while. I liked to leave early and beat traffic, so I should have been out the door already.

Jen turned around, and my fingers fell to my side. She brought the mug to her lips and sipped her coffee. Her eyes smiled over the rim of the mug at me. “So,” she said.

“So,” I answered.

We laughed lightly.

“You want to catch dinner tonight, maybe go out?” I said, caught up in the new flirtatiousness between us.

Jen's face brightened. “Yeah!” she said, very quickly. “That sounds great. I even have a new dress.”

She twisted from side to side as she said this, and grinned coquettishly at me as she did. She looked very cute: her eyelashes were floppy and straight, giving her a juvenile and sleepy appearance, and her brightness was infectious.

“Okay,” I said, happily, imagining Jen in a sexy black dress and the two of us on a date like the ones we used to go on, excited and interested, dressed up, and circling the real reason for going out – to have sex.

It wasn't until after I kissed her, and closed the door of the car behind me, the smug grin still plastered to my face, that a dark but obvious thought crept into my mind. As I backed out of the driveway it began to dig into my psyche. By the time I was accelerating onto the freeway I felt good and disturbed.

New dress.

Jen's new dress.

Jen who was the queen of jeans and sweatshirts.

What in the fuck would she have already bought a new dress for?
Or a dress at all, for that matter?

When you added it to the sexy panties, the trimmed bush, the excited sex, the late nights, the dating apps, the way she had thrown herself into talking about another man's cock and swallowing my cum after she did...

Another shiver went through me, and I felt like I cracked in two again.

It was horrible, the only conclusion I could logically come to.

And it was fucking insanely hot.

Chapter 7

BROWNHOUSE

There was nothing to do, really, but go along with it. I made a reservation at *La Terrasse*, a classic French restaurant that was cozy, but somehow still very sexy. It was situated on a hilled part of town overlooking the city, with an enclosed patio replete with all of the typical romantic date trappings: hanging lights, small tables, a view of the glittering city. We had gone there a few times when we dated, then less after we married, and not at all for years now. She had always gushed about it.

I sent Jen a text, and she sent back a message:

[Jen]: *Perfect. So excited*

And then I tried very hard to dive into my work, and keep my mind on the meetings and the pitches that were coming my way, and not the various suspicions and facts, ideas and fantasies and nightmares that I was having about my wife.

I was putting things away into my briefcase, envisioning the evening's date, Jen's dress, the great sex we almost certainly have, when I got her text.

[Jen]: *I'm going to be late. Im so sorry. I dont think theres any way to get out of here and up there before 7...I forgot abt office hours*

I squinted at her message.

[Me]: *Office hours? At night?*

There was a long pause, while my mind went to dark and paranoid places. It seemed like an eternity while I waited for Jen's text. I stared out the window of my office.

Was I being a fool? It seemed so. Most of the evidence pointed to my wife, Jen, playing me for some kind of fool.

I mean, what kind of guy finds dating apps on his wife's phone, and then accepts that she's just doing research?

She is a postdoc fellow in a sociology department.

There were all the other things.

All the other little things.

And here I was, inviting her out on a date.

And here she was, canceling on me. With a pretty lame excuse.

And here I was, trying to make excuses for her, because when I thought of her, I felt warm and fuzzy like I used to. Because I had liked it so much when she placed her hand on my back this morning.

And the way she had sucked my cock the night before.

And the way she had talked to me about holding another man's cock in her hand.

My phone rumbled on the desk.

[Jen]: *No...the office hrs were earlier and people actually came so I didnt get papers graded and I need 2 hand some stuff off to my TA by tom. am... can u change reservation?*

She knew, as well as I did, that *La Terrasse* was adorable but no longer the kind of trendy, crowded restaurant where a reservation couldn't be easily changed on a Thursday night. I probably hadn't even needed a reservation to begin with. The temptation to say it couldn't be changed was strong, but I didn't want to come off like the jackass that I was, in the event that my paranoia really was just paranoia.

[Me]: *K let me check*

I tossed the phone onto the table and collapsed in the chair. I spun myself around a few times for good measure.

Without actually calling *La Terrasse*, I typed to Jen:

[Me]: *They can do 730. Ill come and pick you up?*

And then another terrible minute as I waited for her to respond.

The idea made no sense. It would take far more time for me to fetch her than for her to take the subway. I felt a flush of embarrassment at my poorly-hatched ploy. She would see right through it, see that all I wanted to do was have an excuse to come and park in the university parking lot and wait for her like a vulture, catch her with someone. Or perhaps ruin her plans of going out somewhere and not working at the university at all.

Two messages came in quick succession.

[Jen]: *OK perfect*

[Jen]: *wait that will prob be slower right? U go for 730 and ill just hop over on train gives me more time to work*

Defeated, I typed:

[Me]: *Duh. OK, see you there.*

I tapped the phone against my lips.

Fuck.

Was I getting played, here?

No, really?

I mean... there was nothing about what Jen had just sent me that should arouse suspicion.

She was right: my coming to get her saved no one any time at all. I would have to go across the city, and we would have to leave the university much earlier than if she took the train. That's why we started going to that place to begin with.

There was nothing suspicious about her pointing out the obvious. And how was she going to go on a date between 4 and 730?

Why was I being like this?

*

In what was a scene of almost unbearable predictability, I arrived at the restaurant early, and the minutes ticked away. Jen was late.

I resolved not to send her any kind of message until 7:45. The willpower required to refrain from doing this made me break out in a sweat under my collar. I scratched the back of my neck and looked compulsively at my phone about 100 times. It felt like time had pretty much stopped.

Somehow I managed to hold off until 7:46. Then I pressed “send” on my already typed message.

[Me]: *you running late?*

You running late? Just a casual question. Not the question of slightly-obsessed husband who couldn't help but freak out if his wife was 15 minutes late.

Ten minutes went by. I downed a glass of wine.

It's hard to look cool if you are a well-dressed man sitting alone at a restaurant, obviously waiting for someone. When I see women in the same situation, I feel sorry for them, or I feel like the guy who stood them up is an idiot.

When I see *men* like me, my first thought is that they must be a fucking twat.

[Jen]: *sorry. Lost track of time. Just got dressed*

I looked blankly at her message.

What the hell did that mean?

Then she sent me a picture.

I stared at it.

It was Jen, all right. Her straight dark chocolate hair. Her pretty eyes. Her mocha skin. She was making a duck-face, though, and doing so very deliberately and in a satirical way: she hated that shit.

It wasn't all *that* making me stare.

She had taken the photo holding the phone up, so she had captured most of her body.

Most of her dress.

The new dress.

The new dress that had been purchased for no apparent reason.

And what, I wondered, would the reason be, when I confronted her about it? She certainly couldn't claim that this low-scooped black cocktail dress, that barely covered the edges of her nipples, and which clung to her lithe figure, was for some kind of official function.

It was a very, very... non-academic dress.

And she looked very, very hot in it.

I typed:

[Me]: *oh good i was beginning to wonder if youd run off with dave*

My heart felt like it went plummeting through my feet when I opened the attachment she'd sent me as a reply. The kind of good plummet, like a roller-coaster. Nausea-inducing but exciting. The kind of thing you wouldn't mind doing over and over again.

She had taken another photo of herself, but this time, she had aimed the camera at her face.

She was winking.

Smiling.

For a moment I was amused.

Of course that was a joke.

[Me]: *okay sneaky see you soon*

Jen sent the same photo to me again.

I set the phone on the table and clasped my hands together. I made a big show, for anyone who might be watching, of smiling smugly. *The woman I was waiting for*, my smile was meant to say, *will be here soon. I am not a twat.*

But then a cold feeling came over me, and with it a frown I could not contain. I tilted the phone toward me.

I opened my messages and looked at the picture again.

The background.

The background.

In the background was what looked like a restaurant. Not an office.

And what's more, there was the blurry form of a man in the background. A masculine shape.

Definitely another man.

I set the phone down and tried very hard, and very unsuccessfully, not to think about it, or open the picture over and over again, fantasizing about all the sick things that guy could have done to my wife before she put on that dress.

Or after.

*

When Jen arrived, the restaurant had only ten or so people scattered among the tables. Still, she stirred them with her presence.

It had been a long, long time since I had seen Jen in anything but her baggy pants, or an occasional suit – usually something sort of dated that didn't fit very well or accentuate any of her great features. The cocktail dress elevated her appearance to the one that I had always known about and kept as a secret. But I have to say, I didn't mind the way she sent a palpable shiver through the room. Her lean legs looked even longer, a trick of the swishing, short cut of the skirt. A shadow, hardly ever seen in the light of day, outlined the curve of her breasts. Her hair was down, shiny and mahogany-colored in the hanging lights of *La Terrasse*.

"Hey," she said, collapsing into the chair a waiter hurried behind her to pull out. She had crossed the room after smiling at me, and he had barely made it to her in time. "I made it."

I shrugged. "Sort of." I was pretty bitter, having imagined our romantic date, after making that connection with Jen the night before. And even though I had spent a good long time with my chin in my hand, contemplating the spectacular view of the city and ruminating on how it didn't make much sense to connect with my wife via a fantasy that involved her fucking another guy, and then get mad that she wasn't following up on that connection the way I wanted her to, because she seemed to be fucking another guy... I still felt angry.

Common sense was not my priority at this point.

But I quickly changed my tune, because I knew if there was one thing Jen hated, it was a guy who pouted. "You look stunning," I said.

I could hear an undertone of suspicion, or jealousy, or something similar to those, in my own voice, and I wondered if Jen could hear it, too. I mean: why did she have this dress? One couldn't help but let suspicion linger. It was the kind of dress that someone bought to tease, to flirt, to seduce.

And Jen claimed to be doing none of those things.

She was looking out of the window. To my compliment she only smiled. Her face seemed flushed, and she had a distant look in her eyes. It's a cliched description, but that's how it looked. She seemed miles away all of the sudden. Her fingers drifted over her skin, down the curve of her collarbone, and toward the swell of her breasts, before they fluttered open and she looked back at me.

She interlaced her fingers and stretched them across the table. Her mind seemed drawn back into the room very suddenly. "Remember when we used to come here all the time?" she said. Her fingers nearly made it to my elbow, and my skin was burning for the feel of her nails through my shirtsleeves. The waiter appeared, though, with a wine list, and shattered the moment.

We ordered a bottle, and then we started to talk. Pleasant chit-chat, nothing of substance. Jen avoided her whole day – what she had done, where she had been, how she had gotten caught up in this grading mess.

And I burned with suspicion across the table.

Was that normal, after all? If she had been suddenly inundated with work, as she claimed, wouldn't she have complained about it ordinarily? Instead, she was talking in abstracts, talking about plans for the future...

"So, what ended up happening again, with the grading?" I said, abruptly.

I must have cut her off in mid-sentence. Jen's mouth dropped open. "I told you," she said. Her tone was a mixture between annoyance and amusement.

She jutted her chin, just ever-so-slightly, and placed her fingertips beneath it. Almost like she was going to give me some Jersey-mafia flip-off, but her fingers stayed where they were, fluttering a little next to the creamy brown of her throat. "Why? Did you think I was doing something else?"

These weren't fighting words. They were an invitation.

I leaned back in my chair. Something I would never admit to her, not ever, is that I felt a little relieved as she seemed to wink at me, her fingers rubbing her own skin lightly, her mouth turned up in the tiniest smile. Relief that she wasn't just abandoning the whole game. Relief that she wasn't calling me out on being the slightly crazy person I was being.

Relief that she (probably) wasn't actually cheating on me.

"The thought occurred to me," I said, taking a sip of my wine.

I'd had, quite a bit, I realized, as the warmth of the alcohol seemed to bounce from my throat back up to my head, wrapping me up in a light fog. I was high now, happy. Sure, something nagged at me a little bit (the dress, the annoying fact that I could be made so happy with just one word from my wife, pulled from my despairing paranoia to this new happy high) but I no longer felt like indulging that side of my thinking. Jen looked stunning, her fingers were playing on her flushed skin in the dim light, the city was starting to sparkle...

"I *have* been a little naughty," Jen said, and for a moment I was so stunned I felt sure it was a hallucination.

She was smiling. She looked down, as though maybe she wanted to check on something in her purse. But instead her hands went across the table, toward me.

I took them, and brought her fingers to my lips. "Oh yeah?"

I liked the way the contact of my mouth seemed to ripple through her.

And what could her secret be? It seemed like an eternity while she made me wait for it. The word "naughty" was sizzling through me, cutting right down through my body, igniting my spine, spreading through my chest, drilling down into my core. My cock twitched. What kind of "naughty" had Jen been?

She brought her thumb back to her upper teeth and grinned again.

Then she took out her phone, and set it on the table, looking at it as though it might have the notes to a small presentation she needed to give. "Well, it's two things, actually," she said. She swiped at the screen, and brought something up, and then spun it around so I could see it.

Whatever was displayed was incomprehensible to me, though I knew it was one of her dating apps. A knife of pain and a stab of pleasure went through me at the same time. I sucked in my breath, not really sure what my

question should be. What was I looking at? It seemed to be a map, with no legend, and hundreds of confusing symbols.

“I activated my *Lust* profile again,” she said, noting my confusion. Her voice dropped. “I thought it might be fun. You know, to see what's out there...”

My heart nearly stopped in my chest.

“You mean like... “ I stopped talking. I had no idea what it was I had intended to say.

Jen sat back in her chair and shook her hair out. “I don't know,” she said, smiling. “Like, you had so much fun with just that one profile. Maybe we could... look through some guys together.”

Look through some guys together.

I felt like something molten had been poured straight through me.

Oh, yes, that is precisely what I would like to do. Look for some guys together.

But my voice was caught in my throat.

Jen looked worried all of a sudden. “Or... no. Too far?” She spun the phone back around and started to pick it up.

My hand, acting almost of its own free will, independent of my mind, shot out and I pressed her hand to the table. “No. No. No, I like the idea,” I said quickly. “I just... I don't know what to say.” I looked at her, and finding her face insufficiently consoled, I repeated myself. “I like it. I really... I *really* like your idea.”

Her downturned features brightened.

“Do you want to see?” she said.

Oh, did I want to see. Was she fucking crazy? Did she have any idea, any actual idea, how wild she was driving me right now?

I looked around the restaurant. It seemed very strange, all the sudden, that in this place of all places, I was going to look through the profiles of men my wife thought were hot. That my dark fantasy was going to be unearthed, and that we were going to play a game that I never imagined I would even reveal to her.

And yet here she was. Liking it.

Playing it.

With me.

She spun the phone around again, to face me. “Just press on the profiles you like. Tell me what you think. Which one you like.”

Naturally, the question burning inside of me was: which one I like for what? And the man inside of me was already playing this scenario out, already imagining where this could all lead, already picturing the filthiest end to this story imaginable.

I took the phone.

I pressed on one of the icons that had a heart. “What does this me- ?”

I cut myself off when I felt the round, hard toe mound of Jen's foot against my crotch. My cock was hard, ever since she'd said “look through some guys together,” and she smiled a little when she found the shape of my cock jutting through my pants. She rubbed her toes over the length of my shaft. I closed my eyes, unable to concentrate for a moment.

“Just make sure you don't press twice,” she purred. “Or it will send that guy a message.”

The first profile to pop up was a pretty average-looking guy. Mid-thirties. A bit like me, sandy hair, blue eyes. He was okay-looking. His profile said he liked weight-lifting, and in his picture, at least, whatever was pushing out from beneath his shirt could quite possibly be muscle. A shudder went through me.

But I wanted to see more.

“How do I go back?” I said.

“Never mind,” I added quickly, having found it.

I looked through a few profiles quickly. Greedily. My cock twitched, and I knew Jen could feel it. There was something very vulnerable, very dangerous, about her foot being against my cock while I looked at pictures of other men, other men I wanted her to fuck. But I no longer cared. This by itself was a thick enough slice of the fantasy I had harbored for so long, and that I had never, ever expected to even tell her about, that it didn't matter to me how much risk I was taking.

Like it ever matters to a guy. Just ask Bill Clinton.

“What do the icons mean?” I said, my throat slightly parched. I took another sip of wine, which had miraculously appeared without me even noticing the waiter coming by. I looked up and saw Jen's face. She was watching me with that light smile on her lips, and my cock pulsed against her foot again. This made her smile for real. She rubbed my cock a little

more. "A heart is for a great match, possible true love," she said. "A, um.. lips are for an okay match. And then the one that's a moon, or something like that, good for one night stand. And if there's a star there it's like, I don't know... a great match. Physically."

I looked back at the screen.

There were a lot of hearts.

And a lot of stars with numeral ones in front of them. I widened my eyes, and my cock flexed. Now I could feel the outline of my zipper, the seams of my underwear, and they were rubbing me raw. "How'd you get so many hearts and... one night stands?" I said.

I looked up at her.

She shrugged and slid an ice cube out of her water glass. "Just hot I guess. And likeable."

I smiled. Then I dropped my eyes, unable to take them away for long from the screen full of potential studs for my wife.

I mean... in theory. As a fantasy. Right? She wasn't *actually* into this?

She was holding the ice cube between her fingers, and pressing her lips to it. I couldn't help but picture the satin head of another man's cock sliding over her lips in precisely the same way. Another shudder.

The guy whose profile I had pressed was a dark-skinned guy named Trey. His picture filled the screen. Dark eyes, ripped body. He was wearing no shirt, outdoors, looking very athletic with a basketball on his hip. He also looked incredibly tall.

But already my mind was working ahead to the fantasy. Picturing the loose shorts he was wearing sliding down, his big hands hooked beneath the fabric. His cock springing loose, pointing in front of him. Thick, veined, sticky with sweat and precum. Jen's hands creeping up from his hips to his chest as her dark hair rippled in waves with every bob of her head, forward and back, forward and back, as she knelt at his feet to suck his cock.

Jen leaned forward on the table to get a view of whatever it was on her screen that was making my cock pulse so wildly beneath her foot. "You really like that guy, huh?"

I could feel a light layer of sweat forming on my upper lip. "I... not necessarily.. I just.."

But my voice was a whisper, a betrayal. And I was shaking.

"Shit!" I said. "Shit, shit, I think I just..."

My hand had jerked, my thumb pressed the profile icon twice, and now a line of dots, rolling over, searching, had appeared at the bottom of the screen with the dreaded word “Connecting you to Trey”

I dropped the phone. Jen looked down, confused at first, and then gave a laugh as she picked it up.

She looked back at me.

“I didn't mean to,” I said. “I – shit. Can you -”

Jen smiled. “It's just a messenger. He's probably not even -”

She held up a finger. “Whoop. Oh. Oh my god,” she set the phone down as well. “He's online,” she said, whispering. “Shit. Oh shit...” she laughed.

I stared at her. The waiter brought our salads, and she picked up the phone without taking her eyes off of it. I thanked him, and then looked back at Jen. “Jen,”

She held up her finger.

“Oh my god,” she said. “He's typing something.”

Her foot dropped to the floor, and my cock twitched violently. I watched, my blood boiling, as she smiled and began to type something back.

It felt like she had just abandoned me. Right then and there, with a salad. How could she just type out a message to a hot black guy, right in front of me like this? I was definitely getting taken for a ride. A big, long ride, like an idiot -

“What do you think?” she whispered, ignoring her salad to lean on the table as she pushed the phone toward me.

On the screen was a messenger screen.

[Trey]: *Hey. Ive seen u for a grip on here never online I'm at brownhouse want to hook up*

And then below it, my wife's message. Typed and not sent.

[Me]: *You sure don't waste any time. Not really into the hookup, but you want to meet for drinks, I'm game*

I squinted at the message. My feelings were all over the place.

Jen waved a hand at me. “Everyone says that. You know, that they're not into the hookup. If that's what you're thinking. Girls say that all the time and then they hook up.” She made little, clawed air quotes with her fingers. “You can see how hard it is to do any decent research.”

I blinked at her.

Was this really my wife, sitting across from me and talking to me about how I shouldn't feel bad that her message to some random guy on a dating app was not going to be discouraged by the words “not into hookup.”

Wasn't that the pre-date version of “I hope we can still be friends?”

“Um...” I said. There was also the fact that I both desperately wanted her to send that message, and desperately felt like this might be the worst mistake of my life.

After all, it could all go very, very wrong.

“I was thinking,” Jen said, sliding on her seat, forward, closer to me. Her foot moved up and down the outside of my calf now, sending a strange shiver through my leg and to the outside of my hip. “We could maybe just end it... see what happens. He's at a public place, we could maybe go... you can watch me flirt... and then we go home?” She paused. “Yay? Nay?”

Brownhouse was a brewery, a little gritty but a mostly high-class clientele. It certainly wasn't dangerous, though the area around it was. It was crowded inside, a perfect place to blend in, with my eyes wandering frequently to my wife in the corner, snuggled up against Trey, laughing at what he said, drawing him in with her eyes...

“Um,” I croaked. “I'm, uh...” But to keep my wife from fluttering back to putting the phone away, I reached over and took her hand, awkwardly pushing it onto the plates. “I'm not saying no, I'm just...”

What was I? Nervous? Flabbergasted? I was excited as fuck, that was for sure – I didn't want to lose hold on this momentum with my wife suggesting that she go and meet some guy, flirt with him...

But there was all this other garbage in my head. A sense that it might not be a good idea. The worries, the paranoia, the little niggling details that wouldn't shake out of my head so easily.

Jen sort of frowned. “I mean, we don't have to do it,” she said.

What was in her voice? Disappointment?

“I didn't say that,” I said.

In fact, now that she put the idea of not doing it on the table, I knew that wasn't what I wanted to do. Or not do, rather.

"I vote yay," I said quickly, and it felt like jumping off a cliff. My stomach lurched as if that was, exactly, what I had done. I exhaled and then I held my breath as I watched Jen's face.

She seemed confused, then she smiled. "It's crazy," she said. "But it's just flirting. Just for fun. Just because, I really had fun last night." She smiled. Turning the phone around to me so I could see Trey's ripped body and square jaw, she said, "You're sure this is the one you want?"

Another pleasant shudder shook through me. I nodded.

She smiled. "Just checking." She started to type.

"What are you typing?" I said.

"Just that I'm bringing my husband along and so could he order some nachos," Jen said, smiling.

I was pretty wound up at this point, and so the expression of taking that comment seriously had already washed over my face before I stopped it.

"Joke," Jen said, pressing send.

I felt like the bottom dropped out of the floor just then.

Jen raised her hand and the waiter flew to her aid. She canceled our food orders.

The waiter looked from her to me, and back again. He had a coy grin. He could probably read the sexual energy between us, the naughty excitement.

The order was canceled without further ado.

Jen played with my cock under the table. Her toes were encased in some kind of nylon, which was something I hadn't noticed when she first walked in to the restaurant. The material slid easily over the material of my pants, and she rubbed the pulsing length of my cock with less and less reluctance to be seen as we waited for the bill. I felt sure the waiters could see her leg moving under the table, her foot between my thighs, from where they were standing across the room. But I didn't care. If anything, it added to the thrill.

"He'll wait for me," Jen said, reading a message from her phone.

I paid the bill and we made our way to the car. We weren't talking anymore, just exchanging knowing, thrilling glances. The evening seemed,

against all logic, to have warmed up, though it was early fall. Jen was glittering and bright, and I noticed a pearl necklace for the first time. It fell into her dress, snug against her breasts.

My stomach was in knots, mostly of excitement, as I drove to Brownhouse, which was only a few blocks away. Jen placed her hand on my thigh, and I silently wished she would drop it between my legs and treat me to another delicious massage. At the same time, I didn't want to tip over the edge, or dull the excitement I was feeling.

I parked in a parallel spot about a block away from Brownhouse (and honestly, not much further from *La Terrasse*. Jen had her hand on the door, ready to just get out. Then she laughed. "What... how do we do this?" she giggled. "Am I supposed to go first? Or you?"

I shook my head.

She laughed again. "Okay... I'll go -"

"No wait," I interjected. "Let me go first. I kind of want to see the whole thing."

Jen pushed a strand of loose hair from her face. "Okay. This is so.. cloak and dagger."

She grinned at me.

I opened the door, and started to get out. Then I let my weight fall back into the seat.

"Only flirting," I reminded her.

Jen had taken out a tube of lipstick. It was dark red, and as she slid it over her lips, turning them from cute to luscious, I felt the motion like a knife through my heart. She never wore lipstick. She never wore dark, luscious red lipstick. And why did she have it, tonight of all nights? Just tucked in her purse, in case?

"Just flirting," she purred. "For now."

She looked over at me and batted her eyes.

Her long eyelashes raked through the air and through my chest, digging into my heart. I had another one of those jolts I was having lately: this was *not* my wife. And so I was left to wonder, in equally painful jolts: was this woman buried in there all along, and just now coming out, or had something happened to convert her?

And wasn't she just a little too light-hearted? Too enthusiastic?

And most importantly: did I really want what I thought I wanted for so long?

“Okay,” I reiterated. “So... *really*: just flirting.”

“I know. I was just kidding.” She pursed her lips. “Come on. It’ll be fun. It’s just for fun.”

I rose from the car and ducked to look in at her. “Give me ten minutes?”

She saluted me.

*

Brownhouse was one of a million microbrewery-restaurants that had sprouted up in a revamped industrial area, along with open-concept condos and climbing gyms.

I spotted Trey pretty easily: this area was no longer known for a large black population, although he wasn't the only guy in the bar who was black, at least. He was wearing a gray t-shirt and jeans, and looked a lot like an athletic, affluent... millennial.

Young millennial.

There were, technically speaking, plenty of definitions of 'millennial' that put me within that date range. Or at least a few. But this guy was young.

Jen-young.

He had a casual, classy air about him. And he was *so well-built*.

And he was very, very black.

This particular aspect of his appearance was stirring something inside of me – and I have to say, I wasn't entirely comfortable with it, but there it was. The thought of him fucking my wife, with a huge black cock, was even more enticing than all of the other men I had imagined fucking my wife.

I shuddered and tried to control my face as I watched him, so I didn't like I was some hungry gay man, or a crazy person. I ordered a beer and found a seat at a cluster of tables that seemed to have been pushed aside by the throng of standing, loud, flirting young kids. A low wall was between the tables and the pool tables where Trey was moving with fluid agility to easily sink his stripes.

I could, by turning my ear in their direction and focusing on my beer with my eyes, hear snippets enough of their conversation to piece it together. From what I gathered, the group was shooting pool and occasionally scanning their booty-call dating apps to see if anyone had bitten.

The talk was about average. Guy-talk. A little lewd, heavy on sports, some business jibber-jabber. They all seemed to work at the same place, something in finance.

Great.

I looked at my phone for the time. It seemed like an eternity had passed since I had left Jen in the car. A flashback of her putting on her slutty red lipstick jolted through me. The fat, thick stick of it smearing against her lips like a fat cock...

“Oh shit,” I heard Trey say.

His friends, along with him, looked up in the direction he was staring. Jen was coming through the door.

“Damn,” one of his friends said, punching him on the shoulder. Another let out a low whistle.

“Actually looks like her picture,” one of them said, in a low voice, shaking his head and lining up his shot.

I took a sip of my beer, listening furtively while looking down as though my phone were the most interesting thing in the world. I wanted, desperately, to look up and see how Jen was going to enter the room and approach this group, or what Trey would do, but if I leered too much someone was bound to decide I needed a punch in the face.

Trey solved my problem, though, by setting his stick against the wall and telling his buddies he had to “bounce,” which they all wholeheartedly agreed, he did.

He made his way quickly to Jen, who had a big smile for him as he approached her.

I was in a bad position to spy on them. They were moving toward the bar, leaning in to yell at each other over the loud music. Jen tucked a strand of her hair behind her ear and smiled.

Trey turned his ear toward her. He couldn't hear. She was smiling broadly, and her lips seemed bigger than ever, wetter than ever, as her mouth rounded out the words of whatever she was saying. At that moment,

their profiles were caught in the light, and they seemed to have their best sides facing me: they looked incredible together. Young, well-dressed, dark-skinned and exotic. Thin and fit, their taut limbs aching to be entwined.

Now, to other business: where the fuck was I supposed to go, so that I could see what they were doing? Maybe hear what she was saying? The situation seemed hopeless. The bar was crowded.

I would have to settle for what I could see right here.

I watched them for a while, and after a few minutes it was almost like an out-of-body experience. I lost track of time, of myself, even, incredibly, the very outrageous hard-on that had been plaguing me all evening in spurts. Someone, it must have been me, finished my beer.

But then, just as I was standing up to walk numbly to the bar and squeeze my way in and hopefully overhear more of what they were saying, Trey and my wife were squeezing themselves back toward the pool tables.

People got out of the way for Trey. You might say the sea parted. He led the way, his hand dragging behind him a little, where – I knew- it was closed around my wife's hand. What was she feeling right now, with his smooth ebony skin, his big hand, clamped around hers? Was the heat of his body radiating along her arm, to her spine, sending licks of heat through her to her core? Was she looking at the muscles of his back through his tight gray shirt, thinking about her fingernails digging into his flesh? Were her panties getting wet, just thinking about it?

I watched as Trey introduced my wife to his friends. A nice introduction, including her name. Their eyes grazed on her figure, but they maintained a respectful distance: it was Trey's catch, and they weren't there to horn in on it. But I could tell that my sexy wife was meeting with approval. Resounding approval.

“You play pool?” Trey asked her, thrusting a stick toward her.

Jen didn't play pool. She looked uncertain taking the stick in her hand. My jaw dropped a little and I had to deflect my gaze to my empty beer when she slid her hand up and down the stick. “I'm pretty bad...with this kind of stick,” she said.

My own cock reminded me of its painful degree of readiness by springing against my zipper. Was she fucking serious? *Flirt, not verbally suck this guy's cock.*

Even Trey, who couldn't have been unused to getting his way with girls, was slightly taken aback. He tilted his head back, as though to look at her through nonexistent bifocals. "Uh-huh," he said, and the pleasure was obvious in his voice. "Well," he gave a smile to his friends, who were equally amused by Jen and amazed at their buddy's good luck snagging a hot chick who apparently was also a bit of a trash-talking slut, "I can show you how to do it."

I lifted my glass and tipped it back along with my head in a gesture of disdain. The fucking clichés, man.

Still, it was hot.

When I set my glass down, after managing to coax a tiny drop of beer to my lips, Trey was standing behind my wife with his hands on her hips, his groin and the big piece of meat between his legs crushed up against her ass. He moved her into position, and then they leaned over together.

My cock pulsed painfully again.

Jen's back was pressed against his taut chest, and the way she was bent over, the innuendo was obvious. Surely her ass and the back of her thighs were delivering to her mind a message about the size and scope of the cock against her. I wondered if he was hard, if his cock was twitching to life as he felt the rounded shape of her ass.

His big black fingers slide along the stick and down to Jen's fingers. The dark pads of his fingers traced a very sexual line over the length of her forefinger, edging it into place. For added effect, he moved the stick between her fingers, pulling it in and out. Jen turned her head to smile at him.

A welcoming smile.

An inviting smile.

And suddenly, for everyone in the room, it was almost like watching those two fuck each other anyway.

The stick went back and forth, under Trey's guidance, broadcasting, not just to Jen but everyone around, what it was he was planning on doing to her later. The stick hit the cue ball with a crack, rolled neatly and with just the right amount of force to disperse two striped balls in opposite directions and sink them both.

Jen stood up. "Wow!" she exclaimed.

Trey had a smug grin. Like every man who has made a woman say, “wow!” because of some kind of physical feat.

“Fuck, man, you didn't leave me with much,” Trey buddy grumbled.

Trey and Jen were off to a corner, where Trey sat down on a high stool. His thick, tree-trunk legs parted, and just as naturally as if they had been dating for years, Jen folded herself into him.

Just as naturally as if they had been dating for years.

My heart nearly stopped at the sight of it. Trey's dark hand slid around the back of Jen's dress.

My brain went wild with possibilities. I scanned through my memories:

Had he introduced her to his friends? Like a stranger, or like an old friend? Maybe even a girlfriend?

My mind drew a blank, the memories contorting with my paranoia as fast as I could cull them from my mind.

What *had* happened? Had they looked like two strangers meeting, when Jen had walked in the bar?

I was staring openly now, but luckily no one cared. Jen was inching closer and closer to Trey. They were speaking in low voices and I had no chance of hearing what they were saying. Jen was smiling, her mouth moving slowly and deliberately. Trey's hands were inching down her body, from high on her waist to low on her waist and dropping with each passing second, slowly, toward the round of her ass.

My mind seized upon a memory: Trey's friend saying she looked just like the profile.

So it was a first date, and all that was happening here is that my wife was being super-slutty.

This both turned me on and stabbed me with white-hot pain.

Of course, my unhelpful paranoia-brain suggested, there was really nothing about what he said that proved that he hadn't met her before. In fact, wasn't he quite un-shocked by her appearance? Quick to recognize her?

It was too crazy to think about. And anyway, Jen was leaning in so close that Trey's mouth was about half an inch from hers.

Fury burned my cheeks. I took out my phone and sent her a message:

[Me]: *That's pretty heavy flirting*

But she was too busy twisting some chalk on the end of the stick, looking into Trey's eyes, to hear or feel her phone in her open purse, which she had tossed hastily on a bar that ran the length of the wall.

Then I had a terrible thought:

What if she couldn't control herself? What if what I was seeing was my wife going further and further into her own fantasy, instead of mine? Or what if this Trey guy had some kind of animal charisma that she couldn't hold herself back from?

Twist, twist, twist, she went with the chalk. Trey's eyes were getting more and more intently fixated on her. His friends, privy to his intentions, had not bothered to tell him it was his turn to shoot.

Did this go beyond flirting, I wondered?

I watched Trey's hands move over my wife's body. If you asked me, it seemed like he had an intimate familiarity with the shape of her ass, of where he would find the end of her curves. Maybe even that dress. His fingers played along the low hem in the back as though he had run his fingers along it a million times.

I closed my eyes.

That was utterly ridiculous.

When I opened my eyes, Jen had her arms on Trey's shoulders.

She was really driving him wild. I could see that she was. His eyes were sunk into her neck, then her lips, then her cleavage, fixed on her body like it would pain him to look away. I had a brief flashback of that kind of hunger, the way I felt before I got inside of Jen, and the memory of it along with the fact that another man was experiencing that feeling for her, seared through me.

They seemed to be making some kind of plan to move out of there. How I knew this, I really can't say. They seemed to be shifting, gathering, flirting and twirling in the direction of the door, all without really moving at all.

Wow. I looked at the time again.

Only one hour had transpired since we left *La Terrasse*.

Dating really was a young man's game these days. As incensed and jealous as I was, I had to have some admiration for Trey.

Jen picked up her purse, and then she delved into it as though something had stung her.

She held her phone in her hand.

She leaned in to Trey. I watched his face as she whispered something in his ear. His eyes widened, confusion and then anger and then a flash of amusement crawled across his face. Resignation of some kind. Jen stepped back, and shrugged. The friends stood with their pool sticks, watching with their eyes and feigning disinterest with their bodies.

Jen leaned forward again and whispered something that made Trey smile.

Then she trotted away, as though in a hurry, holding her phone to her ear.

I stared in confusion at the scene in front of me. I felt like I had been slammed against a wall, on the one hand. My excitement, which had been building to a near-explosive tension, was blown apart like a popped balloon.

I fought to figure out how I was feeling.

I should have been relieved. My wife, who had been so close, so physically close to placing her sweet, heart-shaped mouth on the big black lips of this guy Trey, so close to letting him slide his fingers along her thigh and under her skirt – and she had left the building without so much as a kiss.

I should be thrilled.

But instead, if I was being perfectly honest, I was sitting there feeling...

Horribly disappointed.

As I dealt with this misalignment between what I should be feeling and what I was actually feeling, my phone rumbled in my pocket. Over the noise, I didn't hear the low ring. The vibrations reached through me slowly, fighting their way to my consciousness through all my mixed feelings.

“What the fuck, man?” one of Trey's friends exclaimed. “I thought you had that locked down.”

Trey shook his head, but his eyes were still on the door, still hungry, still full of lust for my wife. “Shit you will never believe this shit. That girl is *married*. And her husband just came home.”

The same raised eyebrows spread like a contagion through the group. Then they went back to playing pool.

At that moment, I slid my phone out, suddenly aware of its insistent vibrating in my pocket.

“What are you doing?” Jen laughed, when I said “hello?” as if I didn't know it was her. “I'm almost to the car, we have to go!”

“I, uh...”

“Come on,” she laughed.

“K,” I said, and I hung up.

“You still gonna try to hit that?” one of Trey's friends was saying.

“There is no fucking way that chick is married,” one of the other guys mused, holding his stick in contemplation and looking in the direction Jen had disappeared.

Trey shrugged. “Ain't my problem, gentlemen. If her old man is gonna let her run around like that..” He shrugged, and lined up his shot.

The cue ball hit its targets, and he sank several balls.

Probably everything he wanted to sink, and nothing he didn't.

I walked unsteadily through the crowd, and out to the car.

*

It's a strange thing to walk down a street toward your own car, with your wife waiting inside and all the thoughts in your head that I was having at that moment.

If her old man is gonna let her run around like that...

I've done something naughty...

Actually looks like her picture...

Hot, hot, hot, my wife Jen is hot...

Jen was in the passenger seat, the window rolled down. She had her own set of keys in the ignition and her pretty arm was draped along the window.

Watching my wife flirt with another man like that had been surreal, as though a tableau from my mind had suddenly become animated, and walked out to real life. But looking at Jen's smooth arm, resting on the open window of *our* car, brought out a very new, very different kind of thrill. It was something about the way she had led Trey on, bringing him close, making him froth at the mouth, and then nimbly slipping out of his grasp.

And into *my* car.

I walked past Jen and around the front of the car. She leaned out the window and placed her head on her forearms, folded over the window-frame. "You better hurry," she said, looking back at Brownhouse. "I had that guy really riled up."

Her mood was buoyant. This was exhilarating, but very strange. Jen, after all, wasn't one for being a tease, or being overtly sexual, or doing the sort of thing she had just done tonight. It went against pretty much all of her sensibilities.

But now, she seemed high on what she had just done.

And like anyone who is high, anyone who seems to like something enough that they might become an addict, she made me nervous.

I sank into the driver's seat and looked over at her.

"Hurry," she said, putting her arm out in front of her. "Go!"

"Really had him riled up, huh?" I said. "How's that?"

Jen gave a quick look back at the entrance to the bar. Then, she turned back to me. Her eyes were burning through mine as her hand slid over my thigh, and her fingertips tapped playfully on the erect surface of my shaft. "Oh, I think you know," she said.

I looked up at that moment, into the rear-view mirror. A dark man was exiting Brownhouse, and I didn't waste any time figuring out if it was Trey or the other black guy who had been there. I pulled out quickly, and drove far too fast down the street.

Jen smiled. I knew she was smiling about the same thing I was: the excitement of a getaway, however strange the getaway was. The warm air, the hum of sex hanging around us. It felt good to be excited about something with her again.

"Oh," she said, out of nowhere. "I forgot to tell you what the other thing was."

"Huh?" I said.

"The other naughty thing."

My blood boiled. There *had* been two.

Jen didn't say anything, and I waited, my breath caught in my throat, my mind vaguely telling me I should be paying more attention to driving. It took a while for me to realize that she wasn't speaking because she was showing me something.

I looked over because I saw the vague movement of her skirt. When I saw her, she had hiked her skirt up all the way to her slender waist, and below it she was... absolutely naked. Bare. Her creamy skin went on and on, and the only sign of anything else was the trim landing strip above her slit. Her gash and her navel and her thighs seemed to dance in the seat, a collage of the sexiest things I could imagine. Only at her thighs did any clothing appear: the lacy elastic of her thigh-high stockings, which somehow looked positively lewd without her underwear.

I stared so long that I forgot I was driving, and looked up with a jolt when an oncoming car honked at us. I jerked the wheel and missed a parked car by mere millimeters.

My wife laughed.

She had been there, first at *La Terrasse* and then at Brownhouse, walking around and bending over the pool table with Trey's hard cock against the fabric of her dress – and all that time her creaming, soaked gash had just been there, no panties in the way of any wandering hands.

My blood was pounding inside of me, and I searched with desperation on the sides of streets and in my mind for a place to stop. I had driven in the wrong direction, headed into the industrial part of the city, and for a moment I considered taking Jen into one of the warehouses or lumber yards and getting really wild in a dangerous place.

I turned onto the freeway instead, and once I had settled into the mild traffic in the middle lane, my fingers wandered to her side of the car. Jen sent the window up to block out the cooling night air. I reached directly toward her pussy, sliding my finger down the landing strip and into her folds, which were, as I had hoped, wet and hot.

“So you knew you had turned him on,” I said, hoping that she would take my cue as a prompt.

Which she did. Though not quite in the way I had imagined.

Jen turned slightly, leaning her back against the door of the car. She opened her legs a little, and the pink of her pussy peeked out from between the folds of her outer lips, glistening with excitement. The scent of her cunt traveled to me, heightened my aching desire. I sucked in my breath and tried to concentrate on looking back at the road, keeping my vehicle in the lines. But my eyes were drawn to the sight of my wife, reclining in that slutty pose, her cunt wet with excitement about another man.

Another *black* man.

“Oh God, Jen,” I said. My eyes felt like they were going to roll out of my head, looking back and forth from her to the road.

“I could feel his cock against my ass,” she said.

But I barely heard that. I barely knew what planet I was on as she said that, because at the exact same time, she slid her own fingers down to her swollen pink gash, and began to pull back on the hood of her clit.

I was fully staring at her now, my eyes nowhere near the road, neither one of us, apparently, concerned about our safety. I watched the skin of her hood pull back, and the purply-red knob inside of it burst forth.

I looked back at the road. We were way off in the left of the lane, and I directed the car back on track. A curve was coming, so I kept my eyes rigidly on it, but in my peripheral vision I could see that Jen's other hand was dropping to her gash. That her pointer finger was making little circles right in the center of her cunt.

“Do you know that guy's cock was practically down the side of his jeans? Like, to here,” she said, and I looked over, quickly, to see her moving her hand across her own thigh in the middle.

“It turns me on so much thinking about someone fucking me with such a big, long, cock.”

Black cock, I urged her to say.

But instead she continued to stroke herself, and she moaned lightly and rocked her hips.

My cock was practically bursting. I couldn't keep my eyes on the road at all. I pulled over on the shoulder, so wildly distracted I must have forgotten to slow down. Loose gravel clanked against the undercarriage, and the tires slipped. The car came to an awkward halt, and dust rose around us.

And then I just watched, from the side of the car, as my wife brazenly brought herself to orgasm, her pointer finger working with methodical rhythm over the slick face of her clit. Her eyes were locked on mine, her lips were turned into a strange expression, parted, neither smiling nor not.

But even though her eyes were on mine, I could see that she had withdrawn to her own mind as she neared her climax. Her own thoughts.

And seeing how we had just come from there, I could only guess that she was thinking of Trey as she stroked herself over the edge, closing her

eyes to let out the low growl of a large, wild cat as her juices gushed onto the bunched fabric of her dress. Trey, and his big, black cock.

Jen's eyes fluttered open. Her legs were shaking slightly, and she pulled her knees together and leaned over to feel my cock with her fingertips. Satisfied that her performance had done what she had hoped: drive me to a state of such readiness that it was painful, she leaned back in the seat and brought her fingertips to her lips. She placed all four fingers in her mouth and sucked the ends loudly.

“You had better get home,” she said, “before a cop comes along.”

I looked at the dashboard. Somehow, in all of this, my foot had slipped off the clutch and the vehicle must have lurched forward and stalled, but fuck if I even remembered that happening.

I summoned all the mental powers I could to safely get us back on to the road, and drove home with Jen's hand in my lap, playfully tapping my cock in anticipation.

*

When we got home, we didn't make it out of the garage. Jen leaned over and unbuckled my pants, reached in with her long fingers, and pulled my cock out. I had the keys in my hand, suspended in the air, and stared down, resisting nothing, as she tugged with her firm grip on my shaft until the head of my cock overflowed with precum. Then she placed the blade of her tongue on my cock and wetly slurped up the salty liquid. Her tongue swept over the head of my dick playfully, like she was eating a soft-serve ice cream, lapping at it like she just had to have some more.

I reached down and pulled on the seat release to send my seatback crashing back as far as it would go. This way I had a better view of her, and her mouth, and all of the very wet and enthusiastic things she was doing to my cock.

She paused for a moment, and flipped her hair to turn her face up to me as she stroked my shaft with her hand. Strands of her silky hair scraped over the raw, pounding flesh of my cock. They stuck to it, because I was dripping precum over the top and Jen had let her saliva pour over the head of my cock in sloppy slurps.

“Now just pretend I'm sucking Trey's cock like this,” she said. She was turning her head already, but I saw her lips turn up in a smile as she felt my cock throb in her hand.

She took me inside of her mouth, and bobbed up and down on my cock. At intervals she kissed the length of it and turned her head to give me a better view.

And as she asked, I imagined that she was slurping and sucking on the thick black cock of her friend Trey, flashing her eyes at me occasionally, her mouth busy and wet all over his dark black shaft.

And that's why I came, with almost no warning. Jen sat up a little and watched the fountain of cum spurting into the air. A few sticky ropes of it landed across her lips, and she let them rest on her mouth for a moment before her tongue emerged from her mouth to lick them up. A streak of cum landed across her breasts, dripping into her dress, snaking along the curves of her body beneath the fabric.

She pumped the rest of my cum out with her hand, staring at my cock.

It was so easy to imagine her doing the same, with a different, darker piece of meat in her hand.

Jen released my cock finally, and sat up and back into her seat. We were both still panting with excitement. The window had fogged up and we both laughed lightly when we looked at it. The car smelled heavily of sex.

Leading up to my climax, I had only the drive to release the energy that had been bottled up since that afternoon. But now, with my cum splattered all over Jen's chin and her tits, and some of the car, the whole thing seemed so much more... seedy than it had just thirty seconds before. Jen twisted the ring on her finger, a simple gold band that she had insisted on because she hated any sort of jewelry that would catch on something.

“That was fucking incredible,” I said, to fill the silence that somehow seemed to be growing awkward, which was the last thing I wanted, the last direction I wanted this to take.

Jen twisted her ring some more and looked out the foggy windshield. Or rather, at it.

“You don't think it was a little too much?” she said, and her voice seemed quieter, weaker.

It was strange. Only moments before Jen had seemed so completely in control that I thought maybe she was a different woman.

I reached over to move my fingers lightly over her neck in a tender caress. “Jen, I don't get it,” I said. “You were so... you seemed so into it.”

But the truth was, I was a little relieved. Now that the testosterone and the lust had exploded from inside my cock, I felt my mind clearing, and making way for all the disturbing thoughts I had been having recently about Jen. Suspicions, anxiety, and loss of control were all creeping in and darkening my mood a little with every second.

Seeing Jen feeling... whatever she was feeling... a little twist of guilt? A little shame?...felt good. It felt a little dirty, a little wrong, to be sure, but it felt good every time she twisted her wedding ring around her finger.

I moved my fingers playfully along her neck. She moved her body slightly, closer, so that my fingers pressed against her skin a little more. Her eyes were distracted again as she looked into the fog of the windshield, and whether it was embarrassment about what we had just done, or guilt about something else she had done, or a desire to something even more – I couldn't know. I wasn't sure I wanted to delve into it, narrow it down to any one thing. Find out if it was something I didn't want to know.

All I knew is that whatever was happening in her mind now, it felt better to me than her cavalier, devil-may-care attitude from earlier.

She gave her ring another twist. Then she shook her head lightly. “I don't know,” she said, finally. “I was really into it, but...” She turned and looked at me. “It seems sort of... I don't know... *skeezy*.”

Another drop of disappointment took my whole body on a ride. I tried to keep my face from crumbling with it. There was also a flare of anger that came with the feeling – I mean, she led me to this. *She did*.

“Why 'skeezy'?” I said calmly.

She looked at her lap. “I don't know, don't you feel like... kind of bad?”

I looked into the condensation on the windshield. “I mean, honestly,” I said. “I feel bad for Trey.”

This made Jen laugh, and I soared with another high of relief.

I decided to drag out the humor, take her mind off whatever was making her feel dark. After all, I didn't want to lose the ground I'd already made. “What happened to your underwear, anyway?” I said. And then I added: “That was about the hottest thing I have ever seen, by the way.”

Jen looked over at me, encouraged. I saw her sexy alter-ego creeping back into her face. "I just forgot them," she said.

I gave my head a small turn. "Forgot your underwear?"

The bad feeling, the suspicious, jealous feeling was creeping back inside of me, dark and slimy, filling up my heart.

Jen rolled her eyes. If she was being caught in some kind of lie, or felt guilty about anything, she didn't reveal it. "Not my *underwear*, entirely. I had them on when I went to work, of course."

But it wouldn't it be just horrible and delightful if she hadn't? If under her jeans she had no underwear, giving Dave easy access? Wouldn't it be wonderful if she had practiced this whole performance with him first?

The memory of her texted picture from earlier in the day, which seemed like a lifetime ago, surfaced to freshly rub my wounds raw, and reveal the oozing sores of suspicion and raging jealousy. I bristled.

I'm not sure what Jen read into this. Maybe she thought it aroused me. She got a little smile on her lips.

Maybe she thought it made me feel exactly the way it did: provoked. Jealous. Like a rabid dog. Maybe that was her game.

"I just didn't think plain cotton panties went with this dress."

My heart was pounding in my chest. I wanted to yell: where were you when you sent that picture?! Who were you with?! Did you take your panties off for him and ask his opinion? *Oh David, what do you think, for my date with my husband? Should I wear these, or just go like this?*

I pictured Jen sprawling across Dave's ugly office sofa, spreading her legs and showing just how she would work me up in the car.

Don't worry, David. If I show him this he'll never suspect a thing.

I shifted in my seat. "We better go inside," I said.

Jen's eyes had already dropped to my crotch, and her eyebrows were rising as I spoke. "Wow," she said. And then she looked at me. "That's good. All of this..." she waved her hand around the car, "got me pretty worked up."

As she said "worked up," she leaned toward me and whispered it, her breath hot on my face. Her fingers slid over my rumpled pants and she used her pinkie to rub my shaft, which was painfully hard again.

Then she popped out of the passenger's seat, and hopped up the stairs of the garage, leaving me to follow her.

And follow her I did.

And so once again, I slid into my own kind of fog, about what my wife was doing.

I really had no idea.

And instead of asking her, I fucked her wildly while I imagined all the delicious possibilities of her faithfulness and her loyalty, her remorse and her guilt, or her clear conscience that was getting slowly corrupted by our dating app games. Or about how much I'd like to make it even more corrupt.

Chapter 8

THE QUESTION

"I'd like to get back to what we were discussing last session," Dr. Heller said, after a bit of chit-chat about why I had missed my appointment the week before and other pleasantries about the weather, which I was making a conscientious effort to drag out for a full hour if I could.

She set her pen down and folded her hands over her notebook. "Is there any news about that situation?"

"Uh... what was it, again?" I said.

Dr. Heller's face twitched ever-so-slightly with the expression of a middle-school teacher dealing with a smart-ass boy. It disappeared quickly, though.

"Your wife. You had gotten into her cell phone, and found something that disturbed you."

My skin was getting hot, and, I feared, probably showing that it was. "Oh yeah," I said, leaning back to feign relaxation. "*That.*"

Heller arched her eyebrows. "How did that end up playing out?"

"Well," I said, about to lie through my teeth. At the last second, though, I felt a real need to confess. It almost seemed to come up and out of me like vomit. It took me by surprise, so much so that I couldn't even believe my mouth was moving, even as I heard the words coming out of it.

"So I ignored your advice, doc, and I went ahead and broke into her phone the next day. And I found all of these dating apps, and I went through them all night, until Jen got home. Late, by the way. And I say to her, 'hey, Jen, what the hell is all this,' right? Oh – yeah, and I almost forgot. I also dug through her shit after I read these messages she has. They're not... incriminating, exactly, the messages, just like... messages from a few guys. But nothing back to them except these weird little..." I paused. I waved my hand, understanding that my story had already derailed. "It's not important. She has all these messages and new underwear. And not like, Hanes cotton panties, either.. new lingerie. Really sexy stuff."

I looked to Heller for affirmation of some kind. A trace of sympathy. Some recognition, or at least a flicker of knowing what I was talking about.

Her face was utterly neutral.

“So, I confront her,” I continued, and now my voice was starting to seem a little shaky. Now that I started actually saying all of this, it sounded terrible, and I sounded like an idiot. A cuckold. A dumbass. When you say things like: “My wife had a bunch of dating apps on her phone and new lingerie,” out loud, it's pretty obvious what's going on there.

“And she tells me, it's just research. For school. For her post-doc.”

Heller raised her eyebrows.

“She's a sociologist,” I said quickly. I found myself rising to my own defense. “So, you know... and the thing is, I know I sound like a fucking... dipshit cuckold, right? But the thing is she wasn't like... she didn't freak out. She just had this reaction that was...” I strained to remember exactly how Jen had reacted. I had to push aside all of the memories of *La Terrasse*, and Trey, and it was like wading through heavy curtains. “I don't know. She just said... 'oh, yeah that, I don't need those anymore, whatever, delete them,' you know?” I was tapping my foot maniacally and I stopped. “So... but then I said, 'what about the underwear?' because that's... damning, right?”

I waited.

Heller clicked her pen. “And so? What did she say?”

I had leaned forward on my knees to stop my feet from tapping so much. I leaned back, exasperated with myself and Heller. I exhaled. “She said... it was just time for new underwear.”

Heller pursed her lips. Was she on my side here? And what side would that be?

“Do you believe her?”

I wagged my finger in the air. *That's the thing, Heller. That's the fucking thing.*

I shook my head as I did this.

“Let me ask you another question, Chris, because I think this is the most important one, okay?”

I nodded. My feet were going berserk again.

“Do you want to believe her?”

I pinched the bridge of my nose and closed my eyes tightly. “Okay, see... that's... yeah, I know, okay? I know that's the question.”

Heller paused.

“Let's take a different tack, shall we. How is your relationship with your wife in other respects?”

“Fine,” I answered, a little too quickly.

Heller stared at me.

“I mean... it is, okay? It's fine. I have... we don't fight, we don't really have any problems, we always, I don't know, have a good time.”

Heller waited.

“Are there any problems in the bedroom?”

My whole body reacted to this with a cold chill, but mysteriously, I got a little aroused. Not some full-on hard-on, just a creeping one. I looked over at a shitty Monet reprint in an ugly frame.

“The reason I'm asking – and I know this can be hard to talk about – is because, in my experience, men are generally concerned about their wives having an affair because of something that is happening in within their marriage.”

“Really?” I said sarcastically.

Heller's face beamed ice to me.

“Look,” I said. “There aren't any *problems* in the bedroom.”

Heller lifted her notepad and flipped through it. “You've mentioned that your wife is quite a bit younger than you.”

A silence.

I shrugged, feeling uncomfortable. Heller, that vulture of an old bitch of a shrink, was quickly circling in on something, and I didn't like it one bit.

“Do you feel insecure about that at all?”

“She's only seven, eight-ish years younger than me,” I objected. “It's less obvious every year. Or, you know, different. And no. No, I don't feel insecure about that.”

“Okay. Well, what I'm trying to get at here, Chris, and I think it's something you should think about as well, is that you have a few things that have caused you to be suspicious of your wife. And she's provided you with an explanation of them. And you still seem... unconvinced by that explanation. Is that fair to say?”

I shrugged. “I guess.”

“But I think you might be missing a more important issue, which has to do with why it is that you went looking for this evidence in the first place.”

I clapped lightly.

Heller pursed her lips.

We sat in silence. This was a great ploy of hers. Stone me with her face and silence at \$100/second until I caved.

I sighed. "Okay. Look, she has this guy she works with, you know? Dr. Emeritus."

"His name is Dr. Emeritus," Heller said blandly.

"It's what I call him. Anyway, Davie. He's a real Indiana-Jones guy, right? Rugged, all that masculine stuff. Except he wears these really gay scarves. But anyway, there's that."

"And you think she might be having an affair with him?"

I pinched my nose again.

Did I? Did I honestly think that?

"Have you talked to Jen about this?"

"I just said I did."

"No, not about your snooping and the underwear. About this professor. Specifically."

I shrugged again.

"So, here's another important question. And I really want you to think about it: *why* haven't you confronted your wife about Dave?"

I shrugged again.

"Often times people will go to great lengths to avoid confrontation with their spouse, especially about matters of infidelity. I'm wondering if perhaps your suspicions about her dating apps and her new underwear are not a deflection of a more serious concern."

I rubbed my forehead. "Well, this is why I pay you the big bucks," I said.

Heller shifted in her seat. "I'm going to ask you try something. I want you to answer my next questions without hesitating or thinking much about them. Just yes or no."

"Fine," I said, sighing.

So Heller asked me a bunch of crap questions, wily psychologist that she is, until she got to this:

"Do you want your wife to have an affair?"

Yes.

The word was out of my mouth before I could stop it.

“Wait! I mean, no. No, of course not.”

Heller folded up her notebook, looking smug. She placed the pen in the little flap at the top and stared me down. “Well,” she said. “We’re nearly out of time -”

“Wait, I want to talk about this. That was... I answered... it isn’t really what I meant.”

“No?”

“No. Of course not.”

Heller leaned on her notebook. “I’d like to suggest something, since our time is nearly up. I want you to spend some time thinking about...” she waved her hand in the air lightly, and made a face, “the *possibility*, that you answered honestly. The *possibility* that you want your wife to be having an affair -”

“I -”

Heller held up a finger to silence me. “*Not*,” she cautioned, “as any kind of judgment, but with an open mind. And ask yourself: what is the *reason* I might want that?”

“Who would want their wife to have an affair?!” I said defensively.

“There can be a lot of reasons. I’ll give you some examples, but I caution you to not allow them to influence your own thoughts. There are cases of partners who feel pressured sexually, and are relieved that their partner has taken their sexual preferences elsewhere. This can be beneficial for their marriage. There are people who have complicated emotional problems associated with their marriage, for whom their partner’s infidelity serves as a useful tool for escaping those problems without having to take responsibility for them. There are people who find infidelity sexually arousing, even. There are many possibilities. I am only suggesting that you explore the possibility that, deep down inside, you are behaving this way toward your wife and her possible infidelity because it is something you might actually *want*. And depending upon what that desire is, it can be healthy or unhealthy. Certainly, if that is not the case, then you will need to address these problems differently. But for now, I think you could benefit from giving this idea some serious consideration.”

I sighed.

“I’d like to leave you with this thought, as well, because it’s related, though I’d prefer for you to think about why and how. It’s this: we often

spend a great deal of time on struggles that we believe are internal, when in fact they are struggles between our own natures and the expectations and norms of society.” She shook her watch with her characteristic shake.
“Well, that's time.”

I cannot believe, sometimes, I have to pay someone to say all this shit I already know.

Chapter 9

SOME PROFILES

Dr. Heller and her bullshit questions, however obvious they might have been, threw me a little off my game. I got busy at work; so did Jen. The heat of our adventures at Brownhouse sort of cooled

I picked up the phone and answered Jen's call wearily and warily. I was accustomed by now to her calling me every other day to report that she would be late coming home.

"Late again?" I said, almost cheerfully, after greeting her.

"No, not late," Jen said, her voice happy and smiling. Seductive.

"Want to get a bottle of wine and look through some profiles?"

"I..." I said, surprised. It had been almost a week and a half since we had even mentioned "the profiles."

I did want to, that much was true. Very much. Very much I wanted to get a bottle of wine and look through some profiles. Perhaps inspiring us to go out and experiment with one of them again...

But the cloud of suspicion wouldn't let me enjoy the suggestion. Not entirely.

After all, why today? Why so out of the blue? What had motivated Jen, sitting around in the library or the whirring computers of the stats lab, to think: today I'd like to engage in my husband's fantasy?

Versus any other day?

Had her date canceled? Were her fixes not enough?

"Sounds like a 'yes,'" Jen said, oblivious to my inner torment. "Red or white?"

"Uh..."

"How about both, then? Okay, I have to go submersible now," she said, referring to her descent into the stats lab.

"Don't do anything I wouldn't do," I said, lacking anything more intelligent to say.

Her voice broke up a little as she entered the building. "I woul...you woul....with Sven so...love you."

I slid my phone into my pocket.

I moved my cursor around on the screen, whatever intelligent thing I had come up with for work just seconds ago having flown from my mind. I tried to reel myself back in, but the thoughts about Jen just kept nagging and nagging me.

There was the gentle tug of the desire to ask Jen to take this fantasy further. A slow, persistent pull on my psyche in one direction.

There were the constant, sudden jerks in another direction of my suspicions. Parts of Jen's stories, things about her behavior that just didn't quite fit together. These would surface, slowly like bubbles in a lava lamp, and then burst and send me reeling with the thought. Cold and hot: what if my wife was actually just cheating on me, stringing me along in her elaborate game, making an ass of me?

There was another force, maybe best described as drag, since I'm using all these boat metaphors – the drag behind me of commitment, of concern for our marriage. The constant hum in my mind that sharing my wife with other men was a perverse and stupid thing to do. A thing that could only end badly.

But the end result of all of these competing forces was that I was looking forward to going home and drinking wine with Jen, lying on our stomachs on the bed and searching for men. Talking about which ones she liked, and why she liked them, her tongue getting looser with every sip of wine, her mind getting dirtier with every glassful. Her cunt getting wet and ripe as she looked at all of the ripped abs and thick biceps, and told me how she imagined their cocks would feel in her hand. And then maybe fucking her, from behind, while she looked at their pictures and told me what she would like them to do to her.

Fuck.

My head was thin on blood and reason, and my cock was taking most of those things out of my system. I blinked at the screen. The campaign I was working on did not even ring a bell in my mind: slogans I was tossing about didn't even seem like something I myself had written.

What the fuck?

I could barely make out the images in front of me for all the images my brain was boiling up from the dirtiest trenches of my mind: Jen on her hands and knees, stuffed with black cock. Jen, on her knees, her hand wrapped around a fat prick, guiding it to her mouth.

Why couldn't it just be enough that she was flirting with these guys? Playing a game with me? Talking dirty? Surely I knew that I should stop here, push her no further, get her to stop before things got out of control.

A delicious shiver went down my spine:

If, in fact, they hadn't already.

*

“Okay, what about this guy?” Jen said, laughing, and cradling her wine glass against her chest, trying to pass me the phone without spilling the liquid from the glass. She failed, and the phone dropped into my lap as her wine sloshed against her shirt.

“That's fine,” I said, jovially. The wine had also gone to my head, and we were crouched on the floor, giggling like two adolescents. “Let me get that for you,”

I unbuttoned her shirt – a flannel shirt that I was pretty sure, though not certain, was actually mine. The shiny, unfrayed knobs in the intricate lace of a new black bra blossomed out of the opening. I rubbed my finger over the lace, and made a face that seemed to convey what I wanted it to: my suspicion, still lingering, about her new collection of underwear. However it made her react, it was a mystery. If Jen was telling the truth or not, there was one thing she knew: she held immense power over me by playing the game of being coy and unrevealing. Her face said nothing as I fingered the material, stroking the soft flesh beneath it, beaming my distrust to her.

“Hmm,” I said. “A flannel shirt and a gorgeous bra.” I leaned forward and pressed my lips to her skin, just above the line of the embroidered edge. I slurped at her skin, even though very little wine had soaked through the shirt. I was pleased that her body gave a slight ripple.

In response to my “accusation,” she said nothing, which also delighted me.

I picked the phone up and unlocked it again. I looked at the screen.

“Mickey Z.,” I read. “Huh. That's a pretty stupid name.”

He looked a little stupid, too. Not dum-dum stupid, just... thick, thug stupid. He had a hat with a tall brim on it tipped slightly sideways on his head. His arms were covered in tattoos that were inelegantly mismatched

indicating a frenetic, impulsive personality. His face was good-looking, dangerous and masculine, a bit hard-edged, with a scar on one cheek.

"I don't know about this guy," I said warily.

I was perfectly serious.

Jen's eyes widened as she took the phone from me. "Really? I *like* Mickey Z."

She was joking, of course, and she rolled her eyes to prove it. Then she shrugged. "Still...there's something very sexy about him."

"Oh yeah?" I said. "What?" My cock twitched. Images of Jen's flawless skin tangled in the brutish, tattooed arms of Mickey Z., his cock (probably tattooed as well) plunging in and out of her trimmed bush...

Jen smiled as she watched obvious flush rise from my neck to my face. "It's the, um... I don't know, like, *dangerous* look about him. Like, 'I've been in a knife fight,' you know?"

"That sort of thing is sexy?" I said, incredulously, though I was sure I knew exactly what it was about him that was making her cream her panties at this moment. Because she was, I knew she was. I started to slide my hand along her thigh so I could find a way into her absurdly baggy jeans and prove it.

"It's like that like, half-mute kinda dumb guy, the warrior guy, from...what's it...?"

"Every movie?" I suggested. But I knew she was thinking of Game Of Thrones. The two episodes we had watched together. Khal Drogo, the beast-like warrior from wherever. I didn't know; I was probably the only person alive who repeatedly fell asleep watching it.

She was swiping – scratch that, *stroking* her phone. "Yeah, true enough. But that's the thing. It's probably evolutionarily hardwired." She looked up at me. I couldn't tell if she was joking or dead serious, or what percentage mixture of these two things she was. Did she secretly harbor a very serious attraction to men like Mickey Z.? Did my wife imagine that she was fucking a man like that instead of a man like me? Was her enthusiasm in bed mimicry, or the product of her own fertile imagination? Did she picture herself fucking a man like that, instead of me?

And why in the *fuck* did it turn me on so much to think a thought like that?

I slid my fingers underneath the strap of her sexy new bra, sliding it down her shoulder, beneath the shirt. I peeled the lace that was pressed against the swell of her breasts away, until her nipples sprang loose. Jen's tiny nipples, which pebbled when she was aroused, were hard in the center of the dark, exotic chocolate of her small areola. I bent down and suckled one of them, and her chest rose in response, pressing her flesh against my chin. I bit lightly into her nipple, and she exhaled. "So you and Mickey Z.," I said, my lips against her flesh. "What kind of date do you think you'd go on with him?"

"This is from Lust, baby... there's no 'dating' going on," Jen said.

I was working my fingers into her jeans now, trying to get the material and her legs out of the way so I could get to the center of her sex, beneath the panties that I could feel were satin and embroidered – matching, I guessed, the black bra. I wanted to confirm what I believed: that she was wet, and that it all emanate from her thoughts about the manly man on the screen of her phone.

I moved up to her face with my mouth, and bit into her earlobe. "You make it sound like you've already checked it out," I said. "Already used it to hook up with someone,"

My pointer finger, at that moment, dipped beneath the fabric of her panties and found the thick, slippery nectar of her cunt. The stain was soaked through, and I wormed my finger into her hole, feeling that she was gushing with excitement. I could see her lips turn upward as I nuzzled her ear, egging her on.

Come on Jen, say what I want you to say.

"Maybe I've already met up with Mickey Z.," she purred. Her own hands were clumsily (we were both quite drunk) moving to unbuckle my pants. The meat of the side of her hand was resting against my cock, and I knew she felt the pulse of my excitement at her words. My confined cock was throbbing against the confines of my jeans, aching to get out. Aching to get inside my wife's slippery cunt while she told me all about what she would do – or what she already did – with Mickey Z.

Impatient, I pushed her onto the floor and ripped the flannel shirt wide open. I rose up on my knees and unbuckled my belt and jeans. Jen took my cock in her hand and began to rub the length of it. The skin of my shaft was sticky with precum, so her palm stuck a little as she moved it up

and down. I was shocked when she slipped her hand into her own jeans and then came back to my cock, using her own juices to lubricate her handjob.

“So you and Mickey,” I said, prompting her. “Where did you meet?”

Jen was smiling. I was bending awkwardly to tug at her jeans and expose her pussy. She shrugged indifferently, her hand wrapped around my cock. “At some bar,” she said.

Had it been detailed, it probably would have stung me less. The cavalier, realistic, “at some bar,” cut through me.

“And did you fuck him?” I said, jumping to the chase now that the scent of her drenched cunt was rising up to my nostrils, and her hands were squeezing my cock and glancing over my balls.

Jen just smiled mysteriously.

“Where?” I said.

“In the car,” Jen said, smiling. “He had a van,” she added.

I became impatient and flipped her over, jerking down her panties – indeed black, matching her bra. Her small ass gleamed with the dripping excitement from her cunt. She folded upward, her pants sliding down her legs along with her panties. She pushed herself up on all fours.

I guided my cock to her hole, but I hesitated because I wanted to wring as much of this story from her as I could. I placed the head of my cock against her clit, slowly rubbing it. The heat of her soaked pussy lips enclosed around the head of my cock like a kiss, and it was almost impossible not to ram my dick inside of her and fuck her senseless, but I wanted just a little more fantasy.

“How did he fuck you?” I said.

Jen laughed. “Just like this,” she said, tossing her hair loose and looking back at me.

Fuck. My wife was so fucking hot. At that particular moment she looked like the pages of a dirty magazine come to life.

Then she moaned like a porn star. She moved her ass against the head of my cock. “His cock was so big,” she purred. “He didn't take his time like you are. So it really hurt at first, when he thrust all of his fat cock inside of me -”

Jen was cut off as I lost control of myself and slammed my dick into her pussy. I imagined Mickey doing just what I was now, but with a bigger cock. Fucking my wife hard, so hard that her knees scraped over the rough

carpet in the back of his skeezy van and gave her rug burn. Slamming his cock all the way to her cervix, stretching her open, gliding through her tight pussy like butter because she was so wet for him to begin with.

Jen yelled loudly and obscenely as I rammed my cock deep inside of her. I hadn't fucked her like this in ages; animalistically, almost barbarically. I reached down and grabbed her hair and pulled on it.

Jen's pussy clenched around my pistoning cock, and then I felt a gush of warmth as she came. She yelled and tried to pull forward with her head, but I had her hair wrapped around my hand and I did not relent. "Did you like him fucking you, you dirty little whore?" I said. The words were sort of out of my mouth before I thought about them.

"Oh, fuck, yes I liked it!" Jen screamed. "I liked when he fucked me full of his cum."

I exploded inside of her. I dropped her hair and grasped her hips, almost dizzy with the force of my orgasm.

I knelt over her, panting, for a few minutes.

Then the realization of what we had said to each other came creeping slowly back into my memory.

Shit.

"Uh..." I said. "Did I, uh, go too far with that?"

Jen slid off my cock and stretched forward like a cat, then flipped on her back. I was relieved to see that the look on her face was one of amusement.

Well, relieved, and disconcerted.

"You mean when you called me a dirty whore?" she said.

I nodded.

She looked to the side. As though she were thinking about it very seriously. Then she said, "nah!" and smiled. She wriggled away and sat up. I sat back on my heels.

We finished off the wine and had a fine time chatting. Laughing. Making jokes and not even talking about sex.

But I was miles away. Miles away thinking about the fact that, while I loved my sexy new wife – her new underwear, her propensity for dirty-talk, her amusement at playing around with my fantasy and dating apps – I was also still suspicious of it all. It was scary, this change in her.

And could it really have come about so suddenly?

Could everything have really unfolded just the way she said it had?
Could she really have just been doing research, innocently, and
coincidentally decided to buy some new underwear and shave her pussy and
turn into a wildcat who fulfilled my basest fantasies, all at the same time?

I mean:

You could see why I wanted to buy it enough to talk myself into it.

But you could see why the nagging thought that I was being a fucking
jackass cuckold was never far from my mind.

Chapter 10

FISHING

It was some time later. A vaguely foggy evening.

“I’ve got one,” Jen said, her fingers swiping over the screen of her phone.

I shouldn’t have been driving, I realized, wiping sweat from my forehead.

I’d had a few drinks. Not enough to make me a bad driver.

Maybe a puff of weed?

My mind was foggy. Where was, I even? It was Halloween, somehow, already.

I looked down at Jen’s legs again. As she shifted in her seat, her firm muscles flexed inside the orange and white thigh-high stockings of her costume. Incredibly, filthily sexy thigh-high stockings.

The fog lifted in my mind. *Yes. Halloween.*

Ironically, Jen was dressed as a fish. Ironic, because the dating app she was swiping away at that evening – the dating app she had used to find her date that night - was called Plenty Of Fish.

It was also ironic that the costume was so fucking hot.

A fish costume.

The stockings weren’t the half of it. I believed, but wasn’t sure, that she was supposed to be “Naughty Nemo,” but who cared at this point what she was supposed to be? The leggings were hooker-height, coming to a few inches above her knee. They went down to her ankles, where they ended without covering her foot. When she moved, the fabric slipped away from her ankle and it peeked out from beneath the fabric. Inexplicably, this peek-a-boo game with her ankle was driving me wild. She was wearing a pair of stripper-height platform black shoes that made her my height exactly, and drew her already-long legs to a cartoonishly, slutty length.

From the shiny orange band at the top of her thigh-high Naughty Nemo stockings, her cinnamon-mocha thighs were bare, all the way to a frilly lace tutu-like thing. It barely covered her ass, that dress. Sitting in the

car, the whole getup was scrunched up and I could see flashes of white panties when she moved.

The panties. Wearing plain white cotton panties like some dirty schoolgirl, driving me insane.

The skin-tight white and orange tube top of the dress barely made it to her tits. The dress had crushed her small, model tits together to make a deep crevice between them.

There was all of that, getting me hard as a rock, making my balls ache. Distracting me from looking at the road.

That was why I was so... foggy.

There was the beer and a few puffs of a joint I had mistakenly taken to calm myself down. They rose up though my memory like bubbles in a lava lamp. Edgeless, unreal.

Did that really happen?

There was the fact that my wife was swiping away at a dating app. Looking for a hookup on Halloween night.

An actual hookup.

Thinking about it, thinking about what we were planning to do, squeezed another injection of adrenaline into my blood.

I felt beads of sweat form and start to drip along my ribs.

“Here, turn here,” she said, pointing her whole hand with the phone at one of the dark streets in the conglomerate of filthy, overcrowded and half-destroyed student homes bordering the university.

The university. My heart fluttered again and my eyes wandered to Jen's slender legs and the phone in her hand. In the blue light of the phone, holding it as she was, she looked incredibly young. Incredibly young, and incredibly slutty.

Why were we here? Why the university?

I gripped the steering wheel and pulled my eyes away from her. Why the fuck was I getting so worked up about this? My cock was throbbing – actually throbbing, like 20-years-ago-, adolescent-, surging-, testosterone-filthy-throbbing.

And I was driving my wife around, looking for...

It came back to me as I grasped through the fog: her university-aged “date.”

The streets were dark and humming with activity. It was Saturday night, after Halloween, but it looked like the party hadn't stopped since the night before. Students were out, drunk, horny, and all dressed up for Halloween.

The knot in my stomach was getting bigger, threatening to twist my stomach inside and out and make me throw up. I was sweating through my own costume, one I borrowed from a friend.

It was a Yeti costume, and even without the head on, I was baking. More costume irony.

I had the heat on for my scantily-clad wife. But it also didn't help that my blood was boiling in anticipation, and maybe fear, of what we were about to get up to.

Or what she was about to get up to.

"God," she breathed. "There's no parking."

She looked at me. Her pretty brown eyes were framed by dark liner, a smattering of glittery orange and white eyeshadow (the effect, like her schoolgirl white panties, gave her vaguely juvenile look. It made me think of lip gloss and bubble gum, and should have been highly disturbing, but instead only ratcheted my fucking cock up another ten clicks). Her lips, painted light pink, turned up and then down, a sign of indecision.

My heart rose and fell with her mouth, soaring and then crashing.

"Maybe it's a sign," she said lightly. "Maybe this is a bad idea."

I braked hard for a gang of frat boys who were crossing the street. One of them held his hands up in the air and yelled, for no apparent reason. I stared him down, not knowing whether he was being aggressive or just a jackass.

"How old is this guy?" I said.

I was talking about her date.

I felt a terrible and delicious thrill as the dirty truth wriggled through my mind: now that Jen looked so...young...I was leaning more toward someone a little older, perhaps.

Someone who would know what he was doing when he slid those white panties down to her knees.

I wiped my eyes. Jesus, I was coming fucking unhinged.

Really unhinged. What the fuck was I doing? How the fuck had these thoughts gotten inside my head?

I didn't *actually* want my wife to act like a slut, did I? I didn't *actually* want someone peeling that fish costume until her pert breasts popped out of it and bounced in front of some other guy's mouth.

Did I?

“Jesus,” I whispered aloud.

Jen was staring at the frat kid, who apparently had forgotten either his anger or enthusiasm, and was now running across the street to jump into a bush. Heavy bass vibrated in the street beneath us.

“He's supposed to be a grad student,” Jen said, shrugging. It took me a moment to realize she was answering my question about her date.

Grad student. That could mean he wasn't too far from Jen's age.

I edged forward down the street. “He could be lying,” I thought aloud.

Jen snorted.

Of course. If there was one thing she'd figured out by doing research on dating apps, it was that everyone was lying.

Also, she had lied. Profusely. In her own profile.

I had lied profusely.

Memories tumbled around in my mind, loose and disorganized:

Writing her profile.

Did that happen?

Spending hours on Jen's dating apps, sorting through her choices, salivating over the possibilities. Making her appealing. Sexualizing her, Making her younger, much dumber, much more like a silly slut than she could ever possibly, actually be.

The profiles I'd made. Were they real?

Jen was not 22.

She wasn't at a community college. She wasn't a flight attendant. She wasn't any of the extraordinarily easy, slutty things I'd made her into.

And now I was driving her to meet some guy, with the hope in the back of my mind that she would act out all the filthy things I wanted to see her do.

Wasn't I?

I looked around the car, seeking signs of reality. Condensation stared back at me from the bottom of the windshield, realistic, far too real.

I looked over at her again, uneasily.

It was a strange unease, the feeling inside of me.

I had done all of these things, hadn't I?

I'd effectively pimped my wife out on the internet, and gotten hard thinking about it...but...

She was into it.

She was *so* into it. She was having as much fun as I was. She had slipped so easily into her role as a slutty bimbo that I had to wonder how it was possible. I had begun to suspect her of dark secrets, of a former life in which she had been the dirty little slut she was so easily becoming.

Not yet, I reminded myself, squeezing the steering wheel.

Nothing had actually happened yet.

Up until now it had all just been a game.

Up until now we had just flirted with the idea.

The memories of the things we had done swirled in my mind. Just out of reach though. Slippery and ephemeral. Had they really happened?

We *had* posted her picture and sent a few sexts. We had teased a few guys and then Jen had told me dirty, made-up stories while I fucked her.

My head felt foggy. We had done all of that, hadn't we?

But we had never actually gotten into the car, and gone after a guy.

Until tonight.

Jen interrupted my thoughts by fishing a mask from her purse: a simple, lacy, carnival-style half-mas. She pulled it over her face. She flipped the mirror down and started putting on some new lipstick. Bright orange, to match her clown-fish costume, and compliment her cream-and-coffee skin.

Halloween was the perfect night to actually do it. People were dressed like whores, everything was make-believe. I could hide my erection and myself in this hairy fucking Yeti costume. I could stare out of the plastic grid of the eye-holes while my wife actually did some of those dirty things she had been promising for months.

My stomach flopped.

"Let's say this," she said, and pressed her lips together. Her calm demeanor unnerved me. "If we don't find a parking spot up here, like, say, between here and Proctor, let's just take it as a sign and go home."

I looked over at her. Here was my wife all dressed up like the sluttiest fish you ever saw, her phone glowing in her left hand with the profile of her

choice of hookup for the night, applying lipstick with the calm of a woman who was maybe on her way to work in the morning.

She pressed her lips together and looked over at me.

“You don't want to do this anymore?” I blurted. My voice sounded strange, almost like someone mangled it. My stomach gave another violent flop.

How could she just go hot and cold about this?

How could this woman be so willing to get dressed up in a whore fish costume – as she *never had before*, she hated slutty Halloween costumes – and go out looking for a man other than her husband to fuck one minute, and then the next minute dismiss it all with the wave of her hand?

How could she take it or leave it like that?

Jen's eyes were dark behind her mask. Coffee-colored until her pupils were almost consumed, her eyes seemed black in the dim light and surrounded by her adolescent eye shadow. The effect was startling, making her eyes large and almost frightening. I could read nothing from them.

My own eyes met hers, flicked back to the street, then went back to her face. Then my fucking eyes tipped my hand. They fell to her pert breasts swelling out in the wave of orange at the top of her costume, and the tapering of the dress to her narrow waist.

“I didn't say that,” she said.

Her voice was teasing. Or was it? I tore my eyes away from her and looked back at the road. I was paying about 1% attention to driving. I could have plowed over ten students and not noticed, the state I was in.

I swept my eyes over the side of the street, searching for a parking space. I both wanted desperately to find one, and desperately not to.

Probably, this was all a mistake. I knew that. I could feel it snaking around in my body: the cold, exciting feel of a mistake. But at the same time, it was tugging at me, whispering in my ear, seducing me.

“You don't sound too convinced,” I said, and I realized I was just saying it to make myself feel better. “Maybe you want to call it off.”

“Do you?” Jen said, and now her voice had swung back in the other direction, to a concerned tone. “I don't want to -”

And then, there it was. A Beetle pulled out abruptly, right in front of us. And the parking space we needed was not only there, beckoning us, it was only two houses away from our destination.

I pulled into the parking space, giving a look of dismay to the cars surrounding us. Beat-up student vehicles, old models handed down from parents. I had a nice car, because I was old.

Something about the entire, preposterous idea of what we were doing struck me in that moment, and I realized I didn't really want to be there at all

“Jen,” I said, ready to give her a big speech.

Jen snorted and covered her face. Then she pulled the mask down around her neck. “Oh my god,” she said. “I know what you're about to say. This is ridiculous. These guys are...puking. In the bushes. Oh god. It's too gross.” She shook her head. “No. Yeah...no, this isn't any good.”

I hadn't turned the car off.

“Call it off?”

She held her phone up, teasing me by flipping through the “grad student's” profile: an impossibly good-looking guy with straight dark hair and a million-watt smile flashed his fucking grin at me.

Jen smiled. “He's too good to be true, probably. And who makes a date on Halloween?”

She swiped the window closed and tucked the phone into her fish costume. “Too bad, Marcus Harris.”

“Marcus Harris,” I said, backing up with a smile. I was relieved, to tell the truth. Not because there was no excitement to this, not because I totally hated the idea of my wife with another guy, but because this scene – this drunken, wild, college-aged scene – was grossing me out a little. “Sounds completely made-up.”

I pulled into the street and moved as quickly as possible through the throngs of drunk party goers.

The sense of relief I felt sort of evaporated as we pulled back onto the highway, headed into the city and our regular lives.

“We still have that party at Frank's we could go to,” she said, glumly and out of nowhere.

Frank had a Halloween party every year, and it sounded about like what it probably would be: sort of fun.

It would be, at least, respectable. More respectable than those kids throwing up in the bushes. More respectable than sneaking around in the bushes myself, trying to watch my wife hooking up with Marcus Harris.

I looked over at Jen.

“It would be a shame to waste that costume,” I commented.

She grinned. “Or that one,” she said, indicating mine.

“You want to go?”

We both knew what we were discussing. We had left behind all of that adrenaline, that excitement, and we were headed to a house full of married couples with kids. Conversations about finance and mortgages.

Jen tapped the phone to her lips. “Yeah, okay,” she said finally.

So we went.

And then we were there. So suddenly, as if we had been going there all along.

I let out a low whistle when we pulled up to Frank's new house.

Jen peered up at it as we passed by.

“Hmmm,” she said. “So what it is that Frank does? Maybe I should have hooked up with him.”

She was joking. It was an old joke.

It still sent a delicious stab of pain through my gut. And then my head spun with images of Jen with Frank, her Nemo legs wrapped tightly around him.

I wondered what the hell was wrong with me and parked the car.

We stepped out and looked up and down the street. It seemed that quite a few adult parties were going on. Inside the homes, behind the vast windows of the McMansions crammed together on the street. Adult parties.

I felt a twinge of disappointment again. I followed Jen, admiring her ass in the tight shiny white material of her costume. The flouncy black lace lifted and fell, tantalizing with snippets of the bottom curve of her asscheeks. God, what a slutty costume.

What a slutty thing she had been about to do.

Hope fluttered again in my heart as I looked up to see Frank's house crammed full of people.

Maybe she could find someone here...

Jen looked back at me, almost as if she had read my thoughts. She gave a wink and a smile. She slipped her mask on, and rapped on the door.

Frank, dressed as The Hulk, opened the door and stared, dumbfounded, at Jen. I had the Yeti head under my arm and I was still

walking up the steps. Frank's eyes moved slowly up and down Jen's body. Surprised. Pleased. Trying to place her. Trying to understand how on earth fortune had deposited this hot little slut on his porch steps.

“Jesus,” I whispered to myself again.

I saw a few guys crane their necks, bending away from the conversations they were having to get a good view of Jen.

Frank's eyes flicked over to me. I saw the wild surprise he registered, and then I saw his mind wheeling as he tried to put it all together. He moved his eyes from Jen to me and back again. “It's..Chris! And....” He stared at Jen. He looked quickly back at me.

“Nice. Forgot my name. You're off my Christmas list, Frank,” Jen said.

Frank's jaw was still flapping around.

I had a rush of pleasure as I watched Frank's hungry eyes soaking up the sight of it all with surprise and admiration. He watched Jen's ass as she stepped into the house and then turned back to me. “Holy shit,” he said, plainly. He waved me in and guzzled his beer. As he closed the door I heard him breathe: “God I fucking love Halloween.”

I smiled, because I really didn't know how else to react. Frank's outright lechery as he watched my wife was doing exactly the same thing to me that her dating accounts were: making me sweat, getting me excited, and making me halfway sick.

And then there was Jen herself. I stepped through the living room, trying to follow my wife and her every move. I got caught up in a few conversations. I lost her and then I found her again.

Time seemed to move in jumpy segments.

I poured myself a conservative glass of wine while I watched her through the windows of the kitchen. Her small, almost- exposed ass was turned up as she leaned lightly on the railing of the balcony. She had already attracted quite a following: men had clustered around her and were regaling her with stories about something.

The part that bothered me, as much as it excited me, is that Jen seemed to be having a good time attracting them to her. Getting the kind of attention she was getting. She never would have leaned on a balcony in such a trashy, men's-magazine-pose, with her legs crossed and her arms draped over the railing...never in a million years. No, Jen would ordinarily

have been with the ladies who were sitting on the patio furniture talking about pillow sales, dressed as a Freudian Slip or something.

I watched her in a trance, and downed the wine. I poured myself another one when she placed her hand affectionately on one of her admirer's (some guy named John, not even wearing a costume, totally married, totally such a douche) arms. Her fingers splayed across his biceps and I watched in horror as she raised her eyebrows in admiration.

Overdone, exaggerated, bimbo-esque admiration.

Did she know I was watching her? Was she squeezing John's muscles as part of our game? Or was she doing it because she had actually turned into a bit of a slut?

I was now remembering, John was also a climber and did things like forty pull-ups in the doorway at the office, so probably his biceps *were* impressive.

Still. Such a fucking prick. He *knew* that was my wife.

I sneered. John had just said something to make Jen tip her head back and laugh. I could hear her throaty laugh through the window.

And wasn't she fucking cold out there? It was fucking freezing.

Now John was leaving. Coming back inside. Jen stayed where she was, and almost immediately some other guy, dressed unoriginally as a vampire, swooped in on her.

"You lost your head."

I looked behind me. It took a moment to focus on the source of the voice. A guy, with a vaguely familiar face buried in weird make-up that suggested nothing to me, was looking at me.

Then he raised his arm and pointed out the window.

For a moment my eyes, traveling in the direction of his fingers, went to Jen.

How the fuck did he know I lost my fucking head? Humiliation seared through me, as if maybe this guy (and who was he? Who was he?) had watched me staring at my own wife and had seen the awful thoughts I was thinking, had seen the torment and perverted pleasure that I was experiencing.

But no. Idiotically stomping around on the porch was a guy dressed as Superman, who had stolen my Yeti head (I could not even remember setting

it down), and was “scaring” all of the ladies by holding his hands up and growling through the head.

Most of the ladies rolled their eyes, but a few screamed appreciatively.

I saw the moment when Yeti-Superman spotted Jen.

He slowed his assault on the other women, and moved straight toward her.

The door was open at that moment. I heard his muffled voice through the costume. “Well, he-llo.”

A seedy, lecherous, “he-llo.”

“Dude, is that Jen?” the voice behind me said. There was no doubt who he was asking about, even though all he could see of Jen was her ass hanging out of the dress, and her silky brown hair.

I recognized the voice just then. Peter Gray.

“Has she been working out or something?”

I kept my eyes on Yeti-head Superman, who was sidling up to Jen and making some kind of move.

I shook my head.

“That’s some fucking costume. Man. I had no idea she was such a hottie.”

Pleasure swept through me. It mingled with the mild irritation I was feeling as the Yeti-man slid closer and closer to Jen.

I mean, seriously. Chances were I knew this guy. Was everyone just going to very obviously hit on my wife, right under my nose?

The thought drove me wild. A cocktail of anger and lust swept through me as I downed another glass of wine. Maybe the wine was making my head so foggy, making it so hard to move.

Behind me, Peter was still talking.

“Man, I have to tell you...just, what the fuck, man? I had no idea Jen was so fucking hot,” he said. He was wasted. He repeated himself a lot when he was.

“Yeah,” I said, and handed him an open beer from the counter as I saluted him and went for the patio door. It was unlikely Peter would remember this conversation or me leaving it abruptly, so I didn’t bother making excuses.

“Oh yeah?” Jen was saying, when I approached the two of them. She was smiling, her hand on her hip, leaning seductively on the balcony.

Her eyes went quickly to mine. She smiled conspiratorially. “This guy says one Yeti is as good as another.”

Was she suggesting something? Was she suggesting that we go back on our plan to abandon our plan? And with this guy, who was probably some jerk from work?

I was suddenly aware of the sweat trickling down my sides. A fat drop rolled down my spine. A rush of jealous anger crept up from the center of my body and over the back of my neck.

At the same time, I pictured Jen with some guy from work, her hair spread out on the mattress, her mouth open in ecstasy while she spread her legs open...

I shook my head.

“That's my head,” I told Yeti-Superman plainly. *And that's my fucking wife*, I felt like adding.

There was a brief moment of silence, while the three of us looked at each other. I couldn't tell what Jen was thinking. She almost seemed amused, and maybe a little disdainful of my outburst. Her lips were closed and turned into a slight smile.

She had picked up on my jealousy.

The only thing I didn't know is what she really felt about it. Did it turn her on? And if it did, what kind of feeling did it give her? Was it a sick feeling, like the one I had? A feeling so twisted and strange that it was hard to understand?

Or did it simply amuse her? Did she just enjoy seeing my pain, riling me up? Was this all just an elaborate ploy for her to get permission to fuck around on me?

And what the fuck did I think I was doing? It was only an hour ago that I was going to drop her off on a date. Could I actually be getting jealous right now?

Superman lifted the head of my costume. “Hey, just messin' with you.” He turned to Jen. “Jen...whoa. That's some costume.”

Brian Finley walked his eyes up and down my wife's body, and then turned jovially to me. He pushed the Yeti head into my hands.

Brian was a chubby, devoutly married guy with five kids, a long-time friend of Frank's who made all the jokes in the office. He was about a foot shorter than Jen.

He was not going to fuck my wife. He wasn't even going to try.

And, I would hope, Jen wouldn't even want to fuck him.

And all of this had been obvious from the moment I saw him through the window. I had let my jealousy distort what I had been seeing. Distort it horribly.

I leaned on the balcony as Brian left to get us some drinks, a mission he seemed likely to forget completely as he stopped to crack jokes with everyone he met.

Jen smiled and brought a drink to her lips. She looked out over the yard. "Brain Finley, huh?" she said.

I set the Yeti head on the porch and ran my fingers through my sweaty hair as I stood back up. I didn't answer. Jen's comment sliced through me, and I spent the next ten minutes staring into the yard, seeing nothing. Trying to decide what it was that Jen's comment meant. And what I wanted. I felt like a crazy man.

Jen put her arm out and touched the heat lamp that was keeping her warm. She looked up at it. She was calm, secure, in control of herself. "Hey," she said. "We should get one of these for our house."

She winked at me. "I'm going in for some more beer. I'll try my hardest not to flirt with your ugliest and most ineligible friends."

I stared at her as she slid through the door. She had a smile for everyone and seemed to know that all eyes were on her. It took her about ten minutes to get through the kitchen, and the whole time I watched her through the glass. What was so different about her? There was the dress, but it was something also else. The way she was standing, her hand on her hip. The way she was...what was she doing? She seemed to be flirting but what was it exactly that gave me that impression? Was it just what I wanted to see, and so I was seeing it when it wasn't there?

But no. No, Jen was definitely possessed by a whole new attitude. She seemed to walk taller, and it wasn't just the shoes.

Or maybe it was. Maybe shoes like that just made a girl *slink*. Maybe she had no choice but to roll her hips with every step, or tilt her ass up when she leaned on the counter.

She disappeared into the living room.

I became acutely aware that I had to piss at that moment. I looked down at my Yeti costume.

“Fucking Christ,” I muttered.

I opted to waddle in my oversized costume to the bathroom. The whole thing had to come off, and something about doing it in the backyard had seemed a bit young for my age.

When I dropped the costume down, two phones clattered onto the tile floor. Mine, and apparently Jen's, which she had sneakily slipped into my pocket.

Her phone flashed slowly with the light of messages.

Maybe just friends.

Maybe just email.

Maybe something else.

I hesitated only a moment, as long as it took me to pee, and then I sat down on the toilet lid and broke into her phone.

An alert from a dating app I couldn't even remember her having signed up for caught my eye.

Now I wasn't thinking. I went diving in, and pulled up the app.

I stared at the picture of the profile that popped up. At the message beneath it.

Something twisted cruelly in my stomach. Excitement began to boil over inside of me faster than I could have ever expected.

This guy had one *very stimulating* quality.

This guy was black.

Was it Trey? My mind felt thick again. I squinted at the picture.

He was a big, athletic guy. His muscles strained against his ebony-colored skin, and veins threatened to break out on his taut biceps. Not Trey.

Darren.

My mind, of course, went immediately to another place where his veins might strain against his skin. And from there it was just a quick leap for my filthy mind to get that big black cock into my wife's mouth. A vision of Jen with her slutty Nemo suit hiked up over her ass, on her knees with her mouth open dutifully for this guy's dripping black cock, filled my mind and I had to unzip the suit to get some air.

Someone banged on the door.

“Minute,” I mumbled, swiping away at Jen's phone. I stared at the message.

[D]: *I see ur in the neighborhood If u look as good as ur photo come over I'm bored*

My cock twitched. The app was one of those that located where you were and put you in touch with other users.

I stared at the app's map. It appeared that, in fact, Darren was only a few blocks away from here.

No fucking way, I thought.

The door rattled again. I exhaled.

Just as suddenly as I had given up on the endeavor Jen and I had set out this evening, it was back inside of me. Gnawing at me.

I stared at the map.

I mean, he was *right there*. Maybe a bit of a jaunt, but *right there*.

I typed a message back to him.

U having a party?

The door banged again.

“I'm fucking sick in here!” I screamed. I held the phone with both hands, trembling a little. My cock throbbed. All the excitement I thought I'd extinguished with booze was flaring up again.

Little party, Darren messaged me.

Good bc I'm wearing a costume

I stared at the phone.

Send me a pic

My chest went cold.

But I was drunk. I was feeling reckless. I stood up.

One sec, I typed.

I stumbled out into the party. I must have looked wild, people were giving me strange looks. I mumbled something to the girl waiting for the toilet about my costume. She rolled her eyes. The smell of weed was hanging in the air.

When I found Jen she was on the couch. She had a joint in her hands and was passing it back to an incredibly hot girl in a sailor costume. The

two had an amused look on their faces. Jen smiled at me.

I waved her over to me.

“What?” she said, mildly annoyed, as I pushed her into a corner. I leaned against her.

“Oh, god...pew, this costume needs a bath,” she said, waving her hand in front of her face.

“Check this out,” I said, too determined to get what I wanted to bother with her comment. I held up the screen so she could see Darren's photo.

The corner of her mouth turned up slightly, and I saw mild confusion on her face. “Yeah...?” she said. “I thought we gave up on this for the evening...?” She shrugged. “Or...?”

“This guy is right down the street,” I hissed. “He messaged you. He wants a photo of your costume.”

Jen shook her head slowly, her face contorted in disbelief. “My costume? How did he -”

“I might have sent him a message,” I said. I was being a little reckless, pressing up against her and talking quickly. I felt like someone had mainlined adrenaline to me: I *wanted* this.

Her eyes flicked back to the screen.

“He's pretty hot,” she said. My cock throbbed inside the Yeti suit.

I stared at Jen as she debated things in her own mind. She could go either way, I could see. She had already decided to stay here; she seemed to be in a good conversation. I watched her features like a hawk, fascinated by the way she teased me. First she seemed ready to give in, then her face clouded over with doubt, then she opened her mouth. Then she smiled. She took the phone from my hand and her fingers moved across it as she read through his profile.

“Darren, huh?”

I nodded. My mouth went dry.

She swiped at the screen, her mouth in that wry little smile she had been using since she had figured out how much this pressed my buttons, her flirting with other men.

Then she shrugged.

“Okay,” she said. “He wants to see my costume, let's send him my costume.”

She extended her hand and held the phone above her. She crossed one leg over the other and thrust her breasts out. She snapped the photo with flash and showed it to me.

I stared at the trashiness of the photo. It looked like a screen shot from some trashy porn compilation, like *Girls Gone Wild* or something. And Jen looked young. Very, very young. She had only captured the bottom of her face, her mouth, pursed a little in the pout that young girls seemed to like so much.

Had we done this before? For a moment my thoughts moved like sludge in my mind.

I looked at Jen. "Do I send it?"

She shrugged again. I saw a flicker of uncertainty cross her face. "You really want to do this thing?"

I looked at her helplessly.

"Well," she said. "It *does* seem like fate."

I sent the picture with trembling fingers.

Then I looked at Jen. We were pressed together against the wall. She had a smile on her face, and she met my eyes and burned right through me. She moved her hips a little and parted her lips. Her eyes were wet and big and focused on mine, her pupils dilated to near-black. She was so turned on by what we were doing it was acting on her like a line of coke.

We just stared at each other until the phone buzzed in my hand. I held it so we could both see it.

Damn girl. U need me to come get u?

Jen grinned as she read the message.

"It's a party, he said?" she asked, twisting on one foot. She chewed on her lip and flicked her eyes up at me.

She typed. *Show me yours. I dont wanna show up and be the only girl in a costume*

We waited in the corner of the living room, our bodies pressed together in excitement.

"You know this is an app strictly for...I don't know..." she said.

"Booty calls?" I said.

Jen laughed. The app was in fact called Booty, and I remembered it now. Anyone with a profile on it was essentially advertising that they were a slut or a guy looking for a slut. Most of the photos of women didn't even

include faces. I knew I should have been repulsed by that, but something about was almost even more exciting to me: the blatant, dirty sexuality of all.

We had hesitated a little about putting up her profile, but I had to admit it was the most enticing of all the apps. I liked that it was dirty. That there was no danger of any real affair going on between my wife and any of the users. Just maybe a shot at filthy sex.

Jen held the phone with two hands and pressed it to her lips. “You sure about this?”

I was sure. I was sure that I had been sure all along.

I was also sure that my head was spinning. That my cock was doing more thinking for me than it should. That I was drunk. That I was making a bad decision. Surely. Surely this couldn’t be a good decision, sending my wife out for some black cock on a Saturday night in a hooker fish costume using a dating app designed for booty calls in some trashy suburb across the avenue...surely this was a terrible idea.

The phone rumbled in Jen's hands and she looked down at the screen. She smiled and flipped it around to me.

Darren's torso was bare, and his body was thick with lean, sculpted muscle. I felt a little quiver looking at him: he was a masculine specimen, twice the man I was.

Jen giggled. “What kind of costume is that supposed to be?” she said.

I took the phone from her and typed that exact question.

We waited.

“Oh god,” Jen said, as the waiting took longer than expected. “This is fucking crazy.” She was getting hot. I saw a little bit of sweat on her temple.

Her phone rattled in her hand.

Gangsta. Darren had written back. Then:

I'm the only black guy at this party

“Witty,” I said, encouragingly, checking Jen's face for her reaction. I could see she found it kind of amusing as well. Especially since she had, one year, wrapped a blanket around herself and went as a tortilla to salute her long-buried Mexican heritage that nearly everyone seemed desperate for her to get in touch with. (Jen was about as culturally Mexican as a Taco Bell in Thailand.)

“So?” she said, taking the phone back.

She typed. I looked over the screen and read her message upside-down.

Still dont wanna b th only costume

The phone rattled again in her hand, almost instantly. A picture of a fairly crowded party.

She looked at me. “I mean, it's exactly what we wanted...”

My cock throbbed through the costume, and Jen's knee was against my dick. She smiled, indicating that she had felt the surefire sign of my extreme arousal. “Do we do it?” she said.

She waved the phone back and forth in her hand, screen up.

So many things could go horribly wrong with this. I felt a twinge of pain in my chest.

Then I imagined my wife on her hands and knees, with the ripped torso of the ebony Darren behind her, his fat cock in his hand, moving closer and closer to her ass...

“Do it,” I said.

It was, after all, the perfect night. The perfect chance. It was practically throwing itself at us.

I watched Jen type:

Im leaving now

She smiled when he wrote back:

just ask for the black guy

I pushed her against the wall and kissed her. She smiled again at my arousal.

I slid my hand down her torso, and oh so easily under the super-short skirt she was wearing. She looked to her right in alarm and wriggled a little as I slipped a finger under her panties and then down. But when she saw that no one could see what I was doing, her alarm turned to a wicked smile.

As I had suspected, or maybe just hoped, or maybe feared, my fingers found her pussy soft and wet. She had shaved all but a landing strip, and the feel of her smooth skin under my knuckles as I dipped deeper into her panties sent a wave of jealousy through me again. She hardly kept herself in such trimmed and pristine condition just for me.

And then I felt the opening of her cunt, slick and wet. Not gushing, not overwhelmingly sloshy. Not the equivalent of my painfully hard cock.

But wet. Another pang of jealousy rippled through my torso. It made no sense to feel that way, to be jealous that she was turned on by doing precisely the thing I had prodded her to do. But as I sank my fingers deeper into her pussy, and began to stroke her sensitive g-spot, she began to purr like a cat and wind herself up to such a state that I couldn't help feel it again: the burn of jealousy. She closed her eyes and her cheeks flushed – surely she was just trying not to make a scene (we were, after all, in the living room with ten other people) as I worked her up into a dripping lather and her pussy flexed around my fingers. But I took her closed eyes personally, inducing as much painful lust and angst as I could in myself. I imagined that she was imagining the big cock that was waiting for her, trying to block out the sight of her husband and superimpose the image of the ripped and fit Darren over my own.

Her flesh closed around my fingers, tightening them in the grip of her silken cunt as she neared orgasm. Rivulets of her tangy juices trickled over my hand. She lifted her thigh to move it against the length of my engorged shaft, but it only drove me wilder and gave me no relief at all. I felt her body shudder as she came, and she leaned her head forward to bite the bit of exposed shoulder at my collarbone.

She leaned against me, and I felt her hand pushing mine out of her. With gentle pressure she guided my fingers to her mouth, and nearly sent me over the edge as she sucked her own cum from my fingers, two at the same time, all the way to the knuckles.

She smiled.

“I hate to leave you like this,” she purred in my ear, dragging her thigh across my crotch again and sweetly squeezing my throbbing balls against my cock. “But I have to get going.”

She reached a hand down and adjusted her panties.

And then.

And then she brought her own fingers up to her mouth, and sucked her cum from them. All the way to the wedding ring on her finger, which she pulled off and into her cum-stained mouth.

“You better keep this,” she said, taking my hand and sliding it onto my pinkie finger to the knuckle, where it swirled precariously.

“Oh god,” I said.

She slid down the wall, and under the arm I had propped up to hold myself against the wall.

“Follow me in like two minutes,” she said.

I was so spectacularly dizzy that I just nodded.

*

In retrospect, I might have made a better plan with her.

Peter caught me as I was trying to leave. He held me up with a barrage of questions, delivered with a raised eyebrow. Where was Jen? Why was I leaving without her?

I mumbled half-coherent responses, which made him conclude I needed my keys taken away. My cock was still throbbing inside my furry costume, and I was sweating profusely with anxiety and lust. Not to mention it was just fucking hot. With every passing moment that Peter held me hostage, I could feel an increased sickness building in my veins. I was desperate to get to Jen, and with each dragging second he held me there, I was realizing that I wasn't 100% sure where she had gone. I was getting behind; I might miss her entirely or get lost finding this party.

Finally, out of desperation, I gave Peter the keys to my car (probably for the best) and pushed him out of the way to get out the door.

I imagine, sometimes, what I must have looked like. A drunk man in a Yeti costume, my face steely with determination, searching the streets like a madman for my wife.

At the corner of the next block, I stopped and called Jen.

“Second thoughts?” she answered. Her voice cut through me, because she said it like it wouldn't matter to her if I *did* have second thoughts. “I'm a block from the house. Where are you?”

Did she care? She almost sounded as though she didn't.

“Peter,” I said, and I realized as I did that I was out of breath. I must have run to the corner instead of walking.

And I *was* walking. Rapidly. Speed-walking for my wife.

“How do I get there?” I said.

There was a pause, while I imagine that Jen smiled. Though with what kind of smile, I don't know. She recited the directions in a low, sexy rumble.

“Okay. I'm here,” She told me. “It looks like quite a party, you can probably just walk in -”

She cut herself off.

And then she hung up.

I was pretty sure that just before the phone cut off, I heard a low voice growl: “Hey, girl.”

But that could have been my imagination, which was on overdrive at that point.

I stopped dead in my tracks at the bottom of the hill I was on.

“Fuck!” I screamed into the night.

I didn't have my Yeti head.

I ran all the way back up the hill, and burst into the party.

“You okay man?” Frank said, as I blazed through his home. I knew that I looked crazy and I no longer cared.

“Where's my head?” I shouted at Peter.

Peter just shook his head.

I rummaged through the house, and even though there was a lot going on behind closed doors in that place that I would have ordinarily paused to investigate, I didn't relent for a moment. Time was slipping away. Jen could be up against a wall by then, her legs spread and her pussy full of Darren's cock.

I took out my phone and typed her a message furiously.

Wait. Lost my head.

I found the Yeti head on the porch, and it seemed as though someone had poured beer on it, but no matter. I ran from the party again, into the night, following Jen's direction. Every ten feet or so I held my phone up, hoping for a text from her. But there was none.

I saw the party from down the street. Remarkably, it didn't look too much different than the one I had just left. It was in an older subdivision, on the other side of a socioeconomic-splitting avenue, but still a nice area. The crowd was younger, but not college-aged. A few people were sitting outside on the front porch. They held their hands up as I approached.

“Hey, sweet costume, man,” someone yelled.

I held up a hand to thank him. I had decided, running through the neighborhoods, that speechless was my best bet.

I was starting to like the costume. Inside of it, I was in cocoon of sorts, alone with my own dirty thoughts. The scenes in front of me played out like some hyper-realistic computer game. People looked through me, instead of at me. I could get away with anything.

I turned a corner. And there it was: the very thing I wanted to get away with watching.

Jen had donned her face mask, but she was otherwise as unclothed as she had been all night. She had a plastic cup in her hand and was leaning against the counter in the kitchen. Very, very close to her new date.

When I entered and began searching through the booze with my cumbersome costume, she cast me a sideways glance and grinned a little, but otherwise pretended I wasn't there.

I could barely hear the two of them as they spoke in low voices, just a foot or so away from me. They were leaning toward each other, saying the sort of things that people seem to feel they have to say before they fuck. Almost certainly that's what they were saying, and without hearing it I was enraged by it.

I stared, because I knew I could, hidden as I was behind the ratted white head of the costume, at the big fingers of Darren, the “only black guy” at the party. He had put on a white t-shirt, but the muscles he had sent in his picture were very much real, and they gave a solid masculine shape to the shirt. His biceps flexed with youthful, athletic muscle. His hair was buzzed and his dark face was handsome and flaunted maleness. Rugged, absolute masculinity.

His thick fingers, wired with a strength that was visible in the fibers of his hand, were playing up and down Jen's arm. Her toasted skin looked pale under his fingertips.

I shuddered as he moved up to her collarbone. He sucked his lips in and pressed them together. Distinctly, I heard him say: “Sort of noisy in here. Want to see another room?”

A knife of jealousy went through me again, as I thought of my wife sliding her wedding finger down to my pinkie knuckle. My wife, with her wet cunt and her wet panties just barely hiding her shaved snatch from the world. *My wife*, who was smiling and taking the hand of the very black man who wanted her to go “to another room” with him.

My heart jump started again, to an even more rapid, crazed speed. How would I follow them? I was dressed like a fucking Yeti. Who wouldn't see a gigantic hairy snowman peering at them as they fucked?

I followed them anyway, not really caring who saw me or if they were watching me watching them. After all, no one could see my eyes or my crazed face. I held my hand up, with the beer I had managed to pour from a keg in it. Several people cheerfully toasted me in the living room.

The house was more of a ranch-style. The rooms seemed to go on and on down a corridor. A lot of people were hanging out in the hallway, talking. I had to push past them. The lights were out and I could barely see Jen's Nemo costume.

And then, just like that, it was gone.

She was gone. The orange and white stripes that encased her lithe body had just...disappeared.

I arrived at the end of the hall, and there it was: the obvious. Jen had just gone into a room with her black "date."

And the door was closed.

I stood outside the door, staring at it, for several minutes.

I was in a daze. My stomach was flopping and running from ice-cold to hot and sick as I stood there thinking about the events that were unfolding right in front of me. My wife was maybe sucking on that guy's cock right this moment, and I was missing it all.

My wife was maybe sucking on some guy's cock right then.

What the fuck were we doing?

I put my hand on the doorknob. I should probably burst in, get my wife out of here. Put an end to a crazy, fever-dream of a fantasy and stop all of this before it went too far.

Because this was going too far, right? It had all been fun pretending but now the moment was actually here. This was it. I was letting my wife fuck another man.

At that moment, a couple, all over each other in slurping, passionate hookup intensity, pushed into me and I went slowly crashing into the opposite wall. They crashed against the cheap, hollow old-suburbia door and fumbled with the handle. The door flew open with their combined weight against it.

And just before Darren said, “Hey man, this room's taken!” I got a full, searing eye-full of what was going on in that room.

Jen was on the bed, kneeling with her legs spread wide open so her ass and her little white panties were exposed. The costume was peeled away from her tits, so I caught a glimpse of her dark caramel nipples as she turned toward the door. Her face was surprised, as though maybe she were expecting *me*. Darren's hand was in her dark hair, his strong fingers clutching a handful of it tightly. His jeans and shirt were off, and his cock was pointed in front of him. He had his other hand on the heavy piece of meat – and it was exactly as I had imagined it. Dark, heavy, thick and long.

Pointed toward my wife.

The implications of his hand on her hair and his cock in his hand were clear. And God, what a sight it would be. The way Jen was kneeling she would have to bend over low, thrusting her ass in the air, to get her face pushed onto Darren's fat cock.

The couple who had tumbled into the room laughed. They apologized in a peal of giggles, and tumbled back out of the room.

The door swung closed.

The couple started making out again as they stumbled down the hallway, trying doors.

I heard the door to Darren and my wife's room click.

My stomach felt as though it were squeezed by a fist of ice.

Locked out.

Seared onto the surface of my eyes was the image I had just absorbed. Slutty, slutty Jen, propped up on the bed, her head in the hands of that dark man, his fat cock erect and ready for her mouth.

I froze for a moment.

Then, the image seemed to clarify. Details focused.

Ah yes.

The window.

I pushed through the crowd in the hallway, which seemed to have gotten thicker. More people toasted me as I walked by, and I discovered that I no longer had my beer. Just a vague memory of the plastic cup hitting the floor, and a cold sensation on my foot.

I made a mental map of the house as I exited. I nearly jumped onto the front porch. I swung my gaze around the yard.

The window of the room Jen was in, sucking on her lover's cock right now, faced the front of the house. It was a corner window. And it was blocked by a hedge that came up and met the side of the house.

I looked around.

Everyone on the porch was looking at me, almost expectantly.

It didn't even occur to me – and Jen would later find this hilarious – to go back into the house, through it, and out the back door, for surely it would have led me to the same place.

No.

Instead, flying on my cock-heavy high, my mind addled with images of my wife fucking a black man, my head spinning with alcohol, I did this:

I growled.

I turned.

I ran and launched myself into the bushes.

As I struggled to get through them, I could hear that the plan had worked precisely as I had hoped for it to. Everyone was amused, assumed I was wasted, and had gone to whatever they were doing before by the time I hit the ground, as though I had never been there.

Branches snapped and cut through even the Yeti fur as I very ungracefully struggled through the bush.

When I finally emerged on the other side, with the head of the Yeti costume rolling on a cement pathway, I was delighted to find that I had made a wise leap of faith. The corner window was just a few yards away, and there was no one in that part of the yard – a little enclave around the side of the house. The lights glowed through the glass, and if I just crept up to the window, I would have a great view of my wife getting fucked.

I stood in the cold air, panting, trying to catch my breath so I didn't pass out or steam up the window.

And then, I did exactly that. I crept up to the window, and crouching in a position that would have been wildly uncomfortable had it been for any other reason than sex, I slowly raising my head until I could peek into the room.

I caught the tail-end of what I had suspected was happening in the room all the while I was flopping around the house and yard. The fit, muscular, and very naked body of Darren was in front of my wife. Jen's

dark hair was wrapped around his fist like a riding crop, and it was clear that he was guiding her head with not entirely gentle pressure up and down the length of his shaft. I strained to see her lips around his cock, but only caught a glimpse. I could see her cheeks, puffed and strained by the presence of so much meat in her mouth. But she seemed to be taking nearly all of him.

Jealousy burned the back of my neck again. Jen never took me to the back of her throat. Fuck, she hardly ever even gave me a blowjob.

Her breasts had been freed from the Nemo costume. I knew that Darren had undoubtedly smooth-talked her with his low voice while his dark fingers peeled the tube top down and her tits sprang loose. Now they bounced over the cover on the bed as she bounced her face over Darren's cock. Her nipples grazed the bed covering, and I knew that they were being tickled to arousal by the motion. My cock pulsed again.

Jen's ass was in the air. Both Darren and I had a nice view of her two rounded cheeks, parted by her cotton panties snug between her buttocks. The Nemo costume had also been roughly pushed up so that her ass was framed by the dark frills.

Almost as though it had occurred to him to look at the same thing, Darren moved a hand to my wife's ass and slid it beneath the white cotton. I watched his hand snake under the fabric of her panties and between her asscheeks. Down and around, into her wet gash beneath. As he did this, he had to push his cock deep into her throat and leave it there.

I watched in a mixture of horror and sheer delight as my slutty wife opened wider and wider and her whole mouth and throat filled up with dark black cock. She must have been gagging, I knew. Gagging on black cock while Darren slid his fingers over her asshole and into her wet cunt.

Was he playing with her clit? I wondered, as she squirmed around. Maybe it was too much cock for her, or maybe he was sliding his finger on her clit and driving her wild. Either way, my wife was being impaled by a black man, right before my very eyes.

Then, to my disappointment but also excitement (for what might come next), Darren slid his hand back up and along her back until he had both of his hands on her head. He used both hands to push her head down, and ram his cock deep into her throat.

Jen pulled away, gasping for breath. He pulled her hair so her face turned up at him.

Her lipstick and makeup were smeared and watery. A long thread of saliva clung to her lips and hung suspended in the air between her mouth and his cock for a moment, before it sank to the bed. I wished desperately that I could hear what he was saying to her, because Jen stared into his eyes and nodded.

Then she was back on his cock again, all the way to the base. Darren used both of his hands to push her head up and down the length of his shaft.

I was so distracted by the lewdness of this act that I didn't notice that Jen's hands were sliding down her torso and to her ass. When I did, I felt a shudder go through me that almost made me splatter my cum all over the inside of the Yeti costume. She hooked her hands around her panties, and slid them down to her knees as Darren pumped her face over his cock. Then she placed her hands, palms against her asscheeks, on her ass.

I stood up, unaware that I was doing so. I stood up just in time to see what appeared to be my wife's finger sliding into her asshole.

I went cold again with a terrible feeling.

This wasn't my wife.

Had Darren ordered her to do it?

And was she enjoying it? This was the sort of thing she never did...

And then an even more enraging, delicious feeling swept over me: Jen didn't even know I was watching her. Maybe she was unleashing some kind of sexual beast inside of her *because* she thought I couldn't see her.

This went on for a minute or so. Darren pushing and pulling on her head with both hands, while she drew and plunged her own finger out of and into her ass.

And then, suddenly, Darren pulled her up to her knees and climbed onto the bed. He pulled on her to turn her face up to him and sucked her mouth up inside of his. The kiss was violent, dominating...and Jen's fingers were still in her own ass.

I watched as Darren's hands found her tits and squeezed her nipples.

The man was *violating* my wife. Manhandling her, throwing her around like a rubber fuck-toy.

My cock was so hard I couldn't stand it.

They changed position at that point. Darren threw her onto the bed with her head at the headboard. I watched with a painful cock as he pushed her lean legs up to the headboard, splayed akimbo. Incredibly, Jen had kept her fingers in her ass, and now I could see it clearly, with her legs spread open. Her cunt glistened with excitement.

Darren was on his knees now, standing over her. He had his cock in his hand, and his mouth was moving to instruct Jen, my slutty wife, in what to do next.

And Jen? She was just staring at him, letting him order her, staring at his cock as it neared her pussy.

She spread her legs wider, and looked down as Darren guide the tip of his cock to her pussy. He rubbed his thick head over her clit. The head of his cock looked frightening against her small little button and the tiny black hole in the enter of her stretched cunt.

Jen turned and tossed her head on the bed, but as per his instructions (I assumed), she left her hands beneath her own weight and held her legs open and up. I watched her back arch and then, at last, through the glass of the window, I could hear her squealing as Darren stroked her clit until she came.

Darren stood over my wife, enjoying his view of her writhing body and her gushing cunt. When she came, her legs began to flail wildly, so he had caught them in his hands and closed his fingers around her ankles.

As she panted and moaned, still shuddering with her climax, Darren spread her legs slowly apart, pushing them as slowly toward the headboard. Jen's legs were still encased in her thigh-high stockings and her feet were still in her black hooker shoes.

The effect was intoxicating.

I felt around on my costume – I knew with futility – for some way to tuck my hand inside and grasp my aching cock. At this point I didn't feel that I could stand another moment of torture.

But I would have to. Darren brought his dick to the opening of my wife's cunt, and one inch at a time while Jen squealed and strained against his grip on her ankles, his thick black cock disappeared inside of her.

He fucked her slowly at first. Jen's eyes were squeezed shut and she was biting her lip, evidently having a hard time taking his fat cock inside of

her. I watched as it slid down deeper, deeper, and then finally disappeared completely inside of my wife.

Darren seemed to be in no hurry. She twisted her ankles in discomfort as he rocked slowly into her pussy. I could hear her low wailing as he worked her up with his gentle thrusts.

Then she opened her eyes. Her mouth opened wide in pleasure.

I stared as Darren then began to fuck my wife like a rag doll. He pistoned in and out of her, all the way to the tip of his cock, then ramming the full length of his huge shaft deep inside of her. She let go over her ass and pressed her hands against the headboard to prevent herself from being fucked right through the wall.

I heard her voice again, rising up through the glass. She was shrieking in short bursts each time Darren's cock was buried in her pussy. His fucking and her shrieking got faster and faster, and then she screamed until her voice cut off as she very clearly rocketed to a shattering second orgasm.

Darren thrust, then he lifted his head and his jaw muscles went tight. I stared down at his cock buried in my wife as it pumped his load inside of her.

It seemed to last for an eternity, this emptying of his seed into her cunt. Jen's legs had gone limp and he released them. They fell to the bed, on either side of his still-buried cock. He gave a final thrust, and then sat back on his knees, sliding his still-hard cock from inside of her.

I stared as they both smiled. As their bodies moved toward each other and they gave a lighthearted kiss to each other. A kiss that was amicable. Then they sort of lingered on each other's lips. I could see Jen's mouth moving, then his. Smiles. Smiles and, probably some self-congratulatory exchange between them about how good they were at fucking each other. How hot they were – because they were.

My stomach was boiling with jealousy. I felt like it would erupt up and out of my mouth.

Jesus. Did they have to do this for such a long time? Jen had her hand on his head now, rubbing the smooth shaved crown affectionately.

Affectionately.

Another exchange of smiles. Another wet, slurpy kiss.

And then Darren hopped up. He stood in front of the bed and looked down at his phone as he typed something. Jen swiped at his hand playfully,

and then rolled over, laughing by looks of it. I watched as Darren put on his jeans. My wife was lying on the bed, on her stomach. He gave her a playful slap on the ass and she smiled, but continued with what she was doing.

Typing on her own phone.

My mind started to reel. Darren opened the door and left, and Jen was still there, typing. Was she so obsessed, so converted to slut-dom that she was looking for another date?

I went hot and cold with rage. I watched her sit up and pull her tube top up and over her breasts. She looked at her phone again. Typed again.

She adjusted the bottom of her skirt, and stood up, pulling her panties from the floor and tugging them up and under her dress. I saw now that she was frowning a little.

What was she thinking?

She held the phone to her ear. Calling someone.

It was only then that I connected the mild buzzing on the ground with what was happening. I looked down at the ground. My phone was in the mulched hedging. Buzzing.

She was calling me.

“Jen,” I said, breathlessly, answering.

“Where are you?” she said. Her voice seemed strained.

I stood up and looked in at the window. She had her arm crossed over her torso.

“I did it,” she said. Her voice had a confessional tone, and almost seemed to break apart, “Where are you?” She sounded mildly desperate.

I tapped on the window.

Her eyes flew up to where I was, standing by the window.

Her mouth fell open slightly.

“I did it,” she repeated. She gave a wane smile. I could see now that guilt was slowly creeping over her face. And I don't mind saying, it sort of thrilled me.

I said nothing. I just enjoyed the perverse pleasure of watching her squirm a little. Just for a little bit. She had been so confident, it was somehow beautiful to see her uncertainty.

“Did you see it?” she said.

I waited, letting her worry build a little.

“It was perfect, honey,” I said finally, and my cock throbbed as a look of relief fluttered over her face.

“I don't know...” she said. “Did you see everything?”

“Almost everything.”

She pressed her lips together.

“Honey,” I said. “It was...it's fine. It's what I asked you to do.”

She smiled at me. It sent another crippling rush through me, to see that I still had some control over her. God, it was a little fucked up, I know that. But it felt good to see her thrown off her vampy, confident stride a little. Hesitating, a little more like the wife I knew so well, before all of this.

“Come on,” I said. “Let's get home.”

And then, contrite Jen disappeared from her face. She gave me a wicked smile. I watched as she opened her legs and slid her fingers underneath the soaked white cotton of her panties. Those conservative white panties under that slutty fish costume. She dipped her fingers into her own slit, and brought them to her mouth. I stared, incapable of doing much else besides breathing heavily into the phone, as my wife closed her lips around the tips of her fingers. Her fingers coated in her cum and the dank semen of her departed lover.

“Meet you down the block,” she said. “I have to go clean myself up a little bit.”

The call ended as she pressed the screen of her phone, rose up to her full, slutty height, and turned to open the door and disappear into the house. I could barely walk through the backyard with my hard-on, and I stumbled into more than one person. Luckily it was Halloween, I had my Yeti head on, and I was snug and anonymous in my costume, as I made my way down the street to wait for my wife and her dripping, unfaithful pussy to come back to me.

It was when I got into the car that it began to sink in. The thing we had actually done. The cold, hard pain of it.

I looked out the window of the car.

It was then that I was aware of my hands on my cock, pumping furiously and getting nowhere. Nothing was changing, no orgasm was building: just a low, painful throb of desire that wouldn't go away.

I squinted at the windshield. The crack, left days ago by a rock, wasn't there anymore.

Days ago...

What day was it? Did it even make sense that it was Halloween? Already?

A slew of missed appointments and deadlines went through my mind.

And then I looked over. Jen was in the passenger seat, wearing a completely different costume, her finger in her mouth. She was slurping something off her finger, licking it like a lollypop.

My Yeti hand was still around my cock.

"I just had to go back for more," Jen said, laughing.

She was wearing next to nothing. Straps of black that didn't even cover her shaved pussy.

She laughed and licked more cum from her fingers.

I just had to go back for more... for more... for more...

Chapter 11

AWAKE

I woke up with a start.

The sheets were soaked through with sweat. Without even reaching down to confirm it, I could feel my hard cock pounding with the adrenaline that had just surged through me. In spite of the shock of the dream, and waking from it, and the cold fear that had surged through me, I was still aroused as hell. The dream had been so real, so full of banal detail, so lucid, that I felt like I had lived it. Right to the crushing end.

I rolled over and rested my hand on Jen's body. She was breathing slowly with the deep, calm breaths of a sleeping person. I let my hand rest on her side for a bit to confirm that she was there, safely asleep in her regular ratty nightshirt, not a “Naughty Nemo” costume. She was snoring softly, not laughing at me.

And then I rolled over, and spooned her.

My cock responded to the heat of her body by getting even more riled. The scent of her neck was pungent, sweet and sleepy. I pushed her hair from her skin and pressed my nose against the slightly damp skin just above the muscle of her shoulders.

I looked over to the clock. 5:00 am.

Jen was going to be very angry at me. Very angry at me indeed, if I woke her up from a deep sleep and tried to have sex with her.

But the haunting, searing memories of my dream, so realistic and so wildly erotic, would not disappear from my mind. My hand moved up her chest, beneath the fabric of her shirt, until I found the swell of her breasts. I swiped my hand across the center of her tits, just grazing her nipples, coaxing them into hard little balls. They pebbled for me, and then I grasped her breasts in my hand, kneading the soft flesh and thinking about the details of my dream: Jen's mouth stretched open for big black cock, taking it all the way down her throat.

I moved my hand down. A shiver went through me when I reached the cotton of her panties: I remembered catching a glimpse of her white cotton panties before I had gone to sleep. That's why they had made their

way into my dream: beneath her Naughty Nemo costume, down around her ankles, her knees, then back against the shaved skin of her pussy and soaking up another man's cum.

I slipped my fingers into the folds of her pussy. She stirred against my body, and gave out a little moan.

Her cunt was not dripping with the cum of another man, but it was wet and hot. Whatever Jen was dreaming about, it would seem, was just as erotic as my own dreams.

She gave a light moan again as I worked my fingers deep into the folds of her cunt, and I found the hard center of her clit. Her legs were folded over each other, creating a tight but not impenetrable, rubbery sleeve into which I had to burrow.

Jen squirmed against my body. I pushed her back against me now, trying to delay what I assumed was the inevitable: she would wake up, be annoyed, and roll away, slapping my hands. Jen hated waking up early, and she did not possess the same raging testosterone that fueled this kind of dumb idea at 5:00 am.

The same testosterone that, likewise, prevented me from having a more lucid thought, such as: perhaps I shouldn't do this and piss my wife off.

To my surprise, Jen did quite the opposite of what I suspected, and sort of folded back into and against me. I felt her body awakening: her muscles went from limp to slightly tense, filled with waking movements instead of the haphazardness of sleep. Her long lashes were still strewn over her cheeks: she didn't open her eyes or admit to full wakefulness, but her breath became more deliberate and shallow. The back of her neck cooled and her abdomen grew warm, even as my fingers became slippery inside of her flesh. I knew she could feel me now, that she was mostly awake and that she knew that the hard flesh against the small of her back was my cock, insistent.

I pressed on the button of her clit, and the hard center of it darted away from me in the softness of its surrounding flesh. Jen stirred.

"It's me," I whispered, still drunk on my dream. "Your big black lover."

I watched her face as her closed eyes flickered a little and tugged at the corners of her mouth until an amused smile was barely visible on her

lips. She made a lighthearted moaning sound.

She knew I was joking, right? That was the reason for her smile?

Of course it was.

She wasn't smiling because she was still half-asleep, suggestible about where she was and who she was with?

Her hand slid over her body and down between us to my cock, which she found easily out of habit, and grasped through my boxers. Her hands squeezed it firmly: I was completely hard. So hard, in fact, that some precum dribbled from the tip of my dick as I let images from my dream prance in front of my eyes in the dark.

Jen held on to my cock and purred like a cat. My own hand was still embedded in the flesh of her pussy.

“Oh, *Trey*,” she said, in a sleepy and believable bedroom voice.

My cock bounced against her ass. I had propped myself up to look at her face, but there was no indication visible on her lips as to whether, for sure, she was just teasing, or in fact had just woken up and didn't know where she was.

I lost patience trying to make her come with my fingers in her pussy like that, so I slid my hand out of her panties and then along her spine, between us, until I could (awkwardly) tuck it into her panties from behind and slide them down her ass with a jerk.

I exposed her ass crack, and my knuckles grazed her soft pussy lips on the way down: she was utterly soaked. Slippery excitement coated my fingers.

I was about to take my cock from her and point it toward her cunt, but she was already doing just that. The tip of my cock was already being guided to her soaked hole.

“Mmm,” she moaned. “Get that fat black cock inside of me and fill me up,”

Her eyes were still closed. It was so easy to pretend, now – if this even was pretending – that she was just a sleeping slut whose mouth was running away from her, revealing her treachery. That she was going to take my cock into her pussy and realize that she wasn't being fucked by her black lover, Trey, but by me. And then, after I pumped her treasonous cunt full of cum, she would have to beg me to forgive her for all of her transgressions.

My cock pulsed again. Jen gripped it firmly and pushed it inside of her, lifting her leg a little to get better access to her overflowing pussy.

Once I was positioned well inside of her, I pushed her leg down with my arm and wrapped myself around her, pulling her torso tight against me.

“Yeah,” I breathed into her ear. “Tell me how you like that. Tell me how you like that big black cock in your cunt,”

Jen's pussy clenched around me. I thought for sure I felt a welling up of her juices. “Oh, fuck,” she moaned. “Oh, *Trey*. ”

Her eyes were still closed and there was still very little to really show that she was awake and aware of what she was saying. Maybe she even really believed Trey was fucking her, The thought drove me wild and I rolled her over onto her stomach. I lay on top of her hot body and gathered her hair in my hands. For a moment I just rocked into her cunt as she squirmed and moaned beneath me. “Oh, that feels so good, baby,” she said.

I lost control a little, and sat back on my knees, pulling her by her hair and her hips to a bent over position, her head on the bed and her ass slightly up. I was still deep inside of her. I gave her hair a little jerk, then grasped her hips with both hands and began to pump her pussy over my cock. She was so wet that her pussy squelched with each thrust. I swept up some her juices with my left thumb and, surprising even myself in my early-morning daring, I slipped my thumb into her ass.

She gasped, but her puckered hole opened up for me, and with the slippery lubrication from her cunt, I was able to fuck her ass with my thumb quite easily. She moaned with each thrust, and her ass clamped down on my finger a few times in discomfort, but she didn't wriggle away or protest.

She opened her mouth and squinted her eyes as her own excitement built until it burst. It wasn't long after that when my own cock exploded, as I stared at my dick moving in and out of her pussy beneath the sight of my thumb, buried to the knuckle in her ass. Her orgasm made her ass spasm and clamp down on my finger, and I couldn't help but savor the idea of having my cock deep inside of her ass, and all of its tight, hot, silken flesh.

Or Trey's cock. Even better.

Another shudder went through me, squeezing my cock completely dry and filling up her pussy with everything I had.

I slowly pulled my thumb from inside her ass as she moaned in mild distress. I stared at the sore and gaping hole as it spasmed closed. Jen balled

her fists up in the sheets on the bed and tossed her head to the other side.

“Fuck,” she said.

I thrust my cock deep inside of her. I was still pretty hard, and I didn't feel like pulling my dick out of her yet. I liked the way she was pinned down to the bed, the way her ass looked and the way her pussy was stuffed full of cock. I liked that she still hadn't opened her eyes.

She gasped a little.

“I'm not done with you yet,” I said, beginning to fuck her again to my own surprise. It had been years since this sort of thing had happened to me.

As I pounded into her for a second time, I rifled through the images of my dream. And so, in spite of it being round two, and Jen's pussy being full of cum, I had to struggle to wait for Jen to come again before I filled her up a second time.

*

Jen seemed almost catatonic for more than a few minutes. I reached over and drew my fingers along her back, just to make sure she was all right. At first there was no response from her, almost as if she was sleeping. But after a few strokes, her body shifted beneath my fingertips and she stirred, growling a little.

I don't mind saying that my male pride was quite fluffed by the sensation of her satisfied, purr-like growl beneath my fingers. And the faint smile that played over her lips. I supposed, at that moment, that perhaps there was something to what Heller had been jabbering at me about often enough: that maybe the age difference between me and Jen did, in the back of my mind, worry me somewhat.

But almost as soon as I had grasped this small straw of sanity, it slipped from my fingers. Jen stretched out, extending her arms over her head, and then opened her eyes.

“Wow,” she said. “What brought that on?”

But she was already smiling a little, like it was rhetorical question and she held some kind of excellent hand by knowing the answer.

I kissed her. “Well, one could easily ask you the same question,” I said.

I was referring to the fact that she had not been angry for being woken up at 5:00 by my cock rubbing against her back and my fingers prying into her.

A flush spread across her face, and she didn't answer right away. It was only then that I realized she thought I was talking about how she had gone along with my game about Trey, and that it had somehow embarrassed her.

Which for some reason - one I didn't really care to dig too deep into and which I silently reminded myself *not* to mention to Dr. Heller – got me even more hotted up than what she had just done.

I put my hand on her cheek. “No, I just meant... morning sex isn't usually your thing.”

Jen's eyes opened wide. She rolled her head over her shoulder to look at the time, which was projected by her clock onto the ceiling. “What time is it?” she said, as she did this. “Oh, god. Oh, you fucking asshole!” she said, and she was only half joking. But she snuggled up into my chest with her hands together and played with the short hairs with her fingers.

She was silent for a while, but then she whispered. “No, but, seriously. What got into you?”

“What do you mean?” I said, mysteriously.

She pulled on my chest hair slowly but violently.

“Ow. Okay,” I said, and she smiled. “Why did something have to 'get into me,?'” I said. “I just love you. And you're hot.”

Her fingers curled into my chest hairs.

“I had a dream,” I said quickly.

Her eyes, which had slowly drooped closed as she was ripping the hair out of my chest, snapped open. Her fingers relaxed.

“Hmm. What kind of dream?” she said. “Because I had a dream, too.”

A little shiver went through my spine.

“You first,” I said.

She shook her head.

“Okay,” I rolled onto my back and put my arm on my head. “It was just so... realistic. It was Halloween, and we had decided to... you know. Actually go through with... you know.”

“Cleaning the bathroom,” she suggested.

I rolled my eyes. “But it was weird, there was all this really realistic back story in it. We went to a party at Frank's, and then you sent a message to some guy -”

“Was he black?”

I felt a little lump sort of congeal in my throat. I nodded.

It just wasn't something I particularly cared to admit to outright. Just like in my dream.

“Trey?”

I shook my head. “That's the thing. It wasn't... but it sort of was. You know?”

“And so what did I do?” she said.

I grimaced. “Well, you were wearing a “Naughty Nemo” costume..”

“Nemo,” she said incredulously. “Like the fish? From that kid show?”

“It... wasn't like that,” I said.

“Nemo's a boy.”

“Look, it was a hot costume. I saw one online a while ago, that's why it was in my dream. Do you want to hear this or not?”

Jen smiled and kissed my shoulder. “Okay, so I'm dressed like a fish, and I...”

“See, this was the thing,” I said. “There was all this stuff in my head about how I had made all these profiles for you online, and you were going to sleep with some grad student, but then we decided not to, and then you got some message from a guy on an app called *Booty* -”

Jen snorted.

Then she got very serious. “Actually, she said, “you should sell that.”

She scrunched up her nose.

“I mean, it's a little racist, but..” she added. “Finish, please.”

“So, we went to this party, and there was the guy, and you, uh...”

“Got caught.”

I furrowed my brow.

“Because I'm a fish?” Jen prompted.

I smiled. I turned to her. “You're being awfully tolerant of my fantasies,” I said. A thrilling flutter went through my stomach.

Maybe you could be more. More than just tolerant.

“What did I do with this guy?” she said.

“Um... it was pretty explicit,” I cautioned. “Really... visceral,” I added.

“Did I have sex with him?”

“Uh..”

“Yeah, okay, of course. But like.. what kind? And where were you?”

I rubbed my finger on my forehead. I was feeling, once again, very exposed. Having sexual fantasies is one thing, and getting someone to go along with them is another. Doing it in the sort of blind shuffle that most sexual things are done in, it's only a little uncomfortable.

But coming out and telling my wife that I had imagined her lips spread out around a thick black cock, and that I had imagined it in such visceral, filthy detail that I could hear the sticky gag in the back of her throat through a window? To tell my wife the very sordid details of my imagination and my fantasies?

It was hard. Almost invasive, however much I also wanted to do it.

“Hello?” Jen cooed. “Come on, I want to hear about this.”

Jen slipped her hand down to my dick, which was already coming back to life a little.

“Okay,” I said, taking a deep breath. “But promise me you won't, like... I don't know, take any of it too seriously.”

She propped herself up on her elbow. “You sure?”

I nodded.

Even though I wasn't. I wasn't sure at all how seriously I wanted Jen to take any of this.

I told her the story. And then, we fucked again, like rabbits.

And then, I double-checked my appointment with Dr. Heller.

Chapter 12

ANOTHER QUESTION

Dr. Heller had asked me a question, and somewhere in my musings, I had forgotten what it was. She was now piercing through me with her dull gray eyes.

“I, uh... forgot the question,” I admitted lamely.

Heller repositioned her notepad and crossed her legs in the opposite direction. She seemed to be summoning great patience from somewhere deep in her soul, though when she spoke she didn't seem strained at all.

“Do you know how far you want Jen to go?” she said, in a monotone voice. “That's the question.”

Most days that I see Dr. Heller, I get around to thinking the same thing. How I cannot believe that I have to pay good money to get someone else to ask me the same question I already asked myself a hundred times.

I sighed.

“I don't know. That's the problem. I don't know.”

“You say Jen reacted... fairly receptively to your dream, when you told her about it. She seems receptive to your ideas. Let me ask you this: is her reaction what you actually wanted?”

I sighed.

The truth was, I didn't know. Good old Heller, hitting the nail on the head every time.

“I'm not sure,” I said. Then I got impatient. “I mean, that's exactly the problem. Right? I don't know. This is something I really want, and it's something I really don't. That's why I'm unhappy about it half of the time.”

Heller's face remained impassive. “Well, Chris, there are many people who maintain healthy relationships outside of the conventional boundaries of monogamy, as I've said. I have personal experience with a number of healthy marriages in which the couples manage their marriage and their extra-marital relationships. But I've also seen a great number of relationships of this type fail. If you are asking me for my opinion -”

Fuck, *finally* -

“ -then I would tell you that the relationships that work, with this kind of activity, are those in which both parties have very clear boundaries and goals determined at the outset, prior to engaging in extra-marital activities. These are people who discuss beforehand what it is they *want* and *need* from such activities, and why they can't get it within their own relationship. I think, as with any... what's the word I'm looking for?... any 'activity' that relates to marriage, it should be goal-oriented, and a central question should be: how is this going to improve my marriage? If you don't have an answer to that question, well, then, perhaps you should consider that it is something that will not strengthen, but rather, deteriorate your marriage.”

I put my face in my hands. So much red tape.

“I find that men typically have a hard time considering these questions when sex is involved,” Heller said helpfully to my silence. “And that's quite natural. However, I believe you should invest some serious thought into -”

“That's all I've done!” I said, interrupting. “I give this nothing but thought all day, every day.”

“That specific question?” Heller said, arching her eyebrow.

I played smart-ass again, annoyed by her Dr. Ruth-y superiority complex. “What question?”

“How will this improve my marriage?”

I smiled a smart-ass smile.

“I think, Chris,” she set her notepad down and lined her pen up at the top of it, a sign our session was ending. “That you know exactly how this will be an exhilarating sexual experience. But you don't have an answer to the question I just posed, and it's *that* question that you are avoiding.” She crossed her legs and looked very shrink-smug. “I think the person you should be talking to about his is not me, but Jen.”

I rolled my eyes. I knew what was coming next.

“So before our next session, I'd like for you to think of a way to approach Jen and have a meaningful conversation about this topic. How could you bring it up? What could you say to her to keep the conversation on track?”

Heller pulled a sheet of paper from her notebook and handed it to me. She'd already given it to me a hundred times.

It was a point-form list of suggestions for having a productive conversation with your spouse.

I took it and promised Heller I'd give it a try, with 0% intention of actually doing so.

CHAPTER 13

CAUGHT

Jen, to my great surprise, was sitting on a barstool at the kitchen counter when I walked through the door. It was so unexpected that it gave me a jolt of adrenaline that made me shake.

She had papers in her hands, like some classic movie scene where a husband gets caught for having spent money on hotels and flowers, and not hidden the credit card bill well enough. The power of the allusion was so strong, in fact, that I almost felt guilty for having done precisely that. I felt caught.

There was nothing about Jen's look when she lifted her eyes to the door that really dispelled that feeling, either. My heart slammed against my chest.

Jen shifted the papers in her hands.

"What are you doing home?" I said, trying to sound cheerful and sounding, instead, demented.

"Took the bus," Jen said, quickly. "Have you been seeing a shrink?"

That was Jen.

Analytical.

Direct.

Semi-autistic in her lack of marital tact.

I set my briefcase down on the counter.

There was no point in confirming or denying it. She had our insurance papers in her hands, and it was pretty obvious what was going on.

I went on the defensive. "Why'd you open that?"

"I thought it was mine," she snapped. "Why are you seeing a shrink?"

I decided to attack instead of answering her question. "Why would it be yours?"

"Because I went to the doctor."

"And you thought, 'oh Chris Brighton, looks just like my name.'"

"Don't be a dick. I just saw the envelope. Are you going to answer my question?"

I rubbed my forehead.

Was I?

She folded the papers up. “Okay,” she said, and she actually sounded compassionate for once. “I’m sorry. You must have your reasons for not telling me. I just.. thought we maybe...”

A very bad feeling was sinking down through my core. Jen looked down at the envelope as she folded it up. She seemed sad more than anything.

Fuck.

“I’ve been seeing her about us,” I blurted. Then I grimaced. I pinched the bridge of my nose. “Okay. Not really *us*, but like, this thing. About... you know.”

Jen looked at me. “What thing?”

“The... okay, so I have this kind of... well, you know how I’m a little OCD. I have anxiety. I get really fixated on certain things...” I was babbling.

Originally, I had gone to see Heller about plain, old-fashioned anxiety. It had turned into a discussion of my marital issues, my sexual desires, and my anxiety about those.

But the original reason had been “generalized anxiety.”

Jen looked unsure of what to say, and she looked over the bills again with a sort of confused grimace on her face.

I started blabbering again. “It didn’t start with the – I don’t know, it isn’t what it looks like..” I

Jen held out her hands, palms toward me. “It’s okay,” she said. “I shouldn’t have... pried, I guess. I just, I’m surprised is all.”

I closed my eyes. “I went there for anxiety,” I blurted. “And then it turned out the anxiety had to do with you.” There was a pause, and my whole body seemed to twist in the wind and burn up in the silence. The next words were coming out of my mouth as though someone had had taken over my body. “And my sexual fantasies about you.”

There.

There it was.

I had spent thousands of dollars on this sentence.

Shit.

Driving home, I’d given my appointment with Heller a lot of thought. I’d wanted to find the right time to have the right conversation with Jen

about all of this. This whole situation was blind-sighting me.

Jen was dumbstruck, and her mouth was hanging open when I opened my eyes.

Not hanging open in utter, complete disbelief. Just hanging open slightly.

I-don't-know-what-to-say open.

Her face softened.

“Look, honey, I had no idea you were this... like, I had no idea you felt this much anxiety about it. You know? I only played along with it because I thought you were into it. I don't have to do that.”

I sighed. “This is just the thing, okay? I *am* into it. I'm...” my breath caught in my chest and I felt suddenly half-ill. I was on the verge of saying that it was way more than just fantasy for me, and it was terrifying. “I'm into it, I think, for real.”

Jen's eyes seemed to widen without actually doing so. Her eyebrows went up ever so slightly.

“I always thought you were...well, you weren't. I always thought you thought me and David had something going on. To be honest.”

“And you don't?”

Jen glared at me.

“But you're into it,” she said, teasing me a little, but obviously still annoyed.

I decided to take the high road, The one that Heller would recommend.

“I'm into it and I'm just... I never knew how to tell you that. Plainly. I was... I am... really worried about what you'll say, if you'll think I'm a bad person, if you'll be angry.”

I realized all of this was true. I was actually just terrified of Jen's reaction.

Jen didn't say anything for a few beats. Then she set the papers down and crossed over to the fridge, where she took out a half-finished bottle of wine. She got two glasses, and moved her head in the direction of the living room. “Let's just go relax for a little bit,” she said. “It's sort of a lot to think about.”

I watched her leave the room. I was more grateful to Jen at that moment than I ever imagined I could be, and I wondered how it was that

she knew just the right thing to say at that moment.

*

We had some wine, and Jen deftly talked about unrelated topics. Almost like she was a shrink herself. I sort of resented the obvious way she was managing me, psychologically speaking, but at the same time I was impressed and... I don't know, strangely touched by her tenderness.

The reminder of wine in the bottle disappeared quickly and we opened another one.

Jen got a little more sultry as the dry chardonnay worked its way into her system.

She got hot, and peeled away her sweatshirt. Then she kicked off her jeans, and was down to a tight-fitting black shirt and black boy-short panties in no time.

She was draped over the couch, her hair spilling across the green suede, her mocha complexion a perfect compliment to the color pallet of her hair and the skin of the sofa. She brought a finger to her mouth and nibbled it with her teeth. "So I don't exactly know how I feel about... going all the way," she said. "I have to think about that." She looked thoughtful for a moment. "You mean, all the way. Like...your dream?" I didn't say anything, just gave a nod. I was getting pushed back into the stomach-twisting, heart smashing place of discomfort and angst I had been in at Heller's office and in the kitchen, earlier.

"I have to think about it," she repeated. "But I have to say that I enjoy the game we have going. You know, leading some guys on. Getting them all excited. We could... go that far."

My head reeled again.

Staring at her, being sucked in by the idea more than anything because she was all legs and skin all over the couch, I realized what it was that was making me so crazy: I wanted control over this. I wanted control over myself, and my cock was fucking that up. Royally.

And I wanted control over her, and I wasn't taking it because..

Because...

Jen was already looking at her phone. She crossed her legs and her shirt slid downward on her slightly angled midriff. She began to swipe

through her phone, as though I weren't even in the room.

Oh, but she knew I was in the room, didn't she?

She knew exactly what she was doing.

I stared at her, letting her drive me wild with her faux-innocent face as she “casually” swept through her potential matches on what, as far as I could tell from across the room, was the app *Lust*.

“Oh, here's Trey again,” she said casually. She giggled. “At Brownhouse again, can you believe that guy?” She bit her pinkie finger. “Still,” she commented. “He *did* have quite the... package.”

I was sitting in the armchair next to her. I moved my hand, and my fingers were able to brush her hair.

“What else is there?” I said.

She held the phone up higher to give me a good view. “Take your pick,” she said. “A city full of horny men.”

And, it would seem, they're all interested in your wife.

Jen was swiping now, slowly enough that I could see the matches' profile pictures, but fast enough that I got an eyeful of just how many horny bastards there were in this city who evidently found Jen's profile appealing enough to give it a shot.

Of course, did that really say anything? Most guys that age would fuck a cantaloupe if there were no other option.

“And all these guys have... what? How does it work? 'Liked' your profile?”

It's the way it had worked in my dream.

Jen pulled the phone close to her. “I guess,” she said, and her voice had the uptick at the end of her sentence, the reminder that she was younger than me, that she belonged to a different generation of women. Her fingers told the same story, playing with the app, opening screens and swiping with the effortless agility of someone who spent a lot of time looking at the thing.

I shivered.

I couldn't help but wonder if she did it all the time, this wanton perusing of eligible men in the city. Men who were interested in her. Possibilities...

Perhaps it was just a fantasy for her too, something to keep her from actually wandering or becoming bored with her marriage. A way to assuage

her regrets at monogamy, perhaps?

Every thought like those that passed through my head seared me with its painful and delicious heat.

“So tell me,” she said. Her voice rattled a little. She was quite toasted by now, and her neck was at an awkward angle. “Who looks good?”

I stared at the screen as guy after guy floated by on her screen.

“There,” I said, as the screen filled with a dark, black torso, and only part of a face.

Jen held the phone up. “Him?” she said.

I didn't answer. My cock was starting to throb, and my stomach twisted. I was feeling a little exposed by what we were doing. Exposed as far as what it was that boiled in my own mind, and exposed in that we seemed to be taking another plunge.

Putting her out there.

Marketing my wife.

Jen flipped on her stomach and looked at me. She read from the screen. “Raphael – oh my God, really? Age... oh, lord. Twenty-three.” She giggled, and started to roll onto her back.

I stopped her. “What else?”

She gave me a look, and then a smile. “Uh... okay... well, he's good-looking.” She shook the phone from side to side to emphasize the point. “He's into... fly fishing and yoga.”

I stared at her. She laughed. “No, he likes: clubbing, gamer girls, and.. I don't even know what this last word is.” She raised her eyebrows. “He's hot, though.”

My cock pulsed.

“How hot?” I prompted.

She looked up at me. She read my face for a moment, and we were on the edge again, the one where she could go either way and all I could do was wait to see what she would do. Would she tease me and give in to my fantasy, or would she laugh it off?

The tension was thick in the air, at least for me, as I held my breath in my mouth and waited for her answer.

Her shoulders moved slightly, and at first I thought she was going to shrug it off with a laugh.

And she *did* shrug.

But then she made a face. "I'd do him," she said.

Our eyes met.

It seems like we looked at each other for a long time. I have no idea what happened inside of Jen in those moments. If she felt the same ice-cold queasiness, the same heart-stopping excitement, the same rush that I felt. If she felt like she was looking out of a plane she wanted to jump out of, deciding if she would actually do it. If she was as turned-on as I was. If her pussy was pulsing with desire the way my cock was throbbing.

Was she just putting on act for me right now? Or did this turn her on as much as it did me?

Was she actually the one looking for an excuse to take it all the way?

I found myself incapable of moving. Incapable of breaking the spell for what seemed like an eternity. Was this it? Was this finally going to be the moment where we agreed to actually do this thing? Or maybe it was the moment that Jen started laughing, and told me she'd already done it hundreds of times, already done *him* hundreds of times, all right under my nose while I sat here salivating and scraping up the seconds.

Another shiver went through me.

"You would, would you?" I said dryly.

Jen said nothing. She was waiting for me, though I couldn't tell from her face if she needed leadership or she was setting a trap. Her expression was eager but I couldn't say for what.

"Why don't you message him, then," I said. My wine glass was resting on my knee and moved my finger around the edge of it in a slow circle.

Jen rolled onto her back without saying anything, and for a moment I felt like she had slapped me. Then I saw her opening up a messenger.

"Dear Raphael," she said. "I am very pleased to receive your profile in the -"

She lost her nerve with her joke and cracked up.

"Okay, seriously. What do I write?"

"Is this your first time contacting him?"

She turned her head and looked back and up at me. Disdainfully.

That was a good, sign, right? A sign that she wasn't just chatting with every guy on her dating apps, that she was telling the truth when she said she didn't use them except while I was around?

“Do you usually contact these guys first?”

She gave me the same look.

“No,” I laughed, lying through my teeth. “I didn't mean it that way.” (I had. I had meant it exactly as entrapment). “I mean, like, does *one*, a woman, usually contact the guys first on these things?”

Jen shrugged and kept typing. The screen was too far away for me to read the words.

I watched with delicious horror as, without checking it with me at all, she sent it.

“What'd it say?” I stammered.

The usual,” Jen purred, flipping over on her stomach again. “Want to send some more?”

My cock twitched. What did she mean, “the usual?”

Her phone dinged at that exact moment. The sound was actually a lip-smacking kiss sound.

“Clever,” I commented, in reference to *Lust's* cheesy sound effects. My stomach was churning as she opened her messages.

“It's not from him,” she said, with mild surprise. “Some guy named Mark.”

I said nothing. Mark sounded like a nice guy.

A white guy.

I was loads more interested in Raphael. Or Trey.

She turned the screen and held it toward me, laughing.

[Mark]: *ur hot whats up?*

I smiled. “Original,” I said.

“I get a lot of that,” Jen said.

See, this was the thing.

Little comments like this one. Offhand comments that slipped out of her mouth. Comments that could mean something - or nothing at all. What did she mean, she “got a lot of that?” How did she get a lot of it if she never got on these apps except with me?

“Here's another one,” she said, rolling her eyes.

I took the phone from her hand without asking permission. “Lemme see that thing,” I said. “Jesus,” I commented, looking at the user's profile.

“What is this guy, like twelve?”

“My profile is really... young,” Jen said, twisting her fingers together.

I swept through the app. “Oh my God Jen, you say you're twenty-two on this thing.”

She laughed a little. “And people believe it.”

Another one of those comments, coming down on me like a hammer.

“I thought you never used this,” I said. There was plenty of accusation in my voice.

She looked up and backward at me again. “Huh?” What's that mean?”

“Well, just – how is it that you know people believe it, if you never use this thing.”

She snorted disdainfully and looked back at her hands. “God, Chris,” she said dismissively.

I felt my cheeks starting to burn with rage. Not blinding rage, not throw-a-chair-through-the-window-rage. A rage of fury and infatuation.

I wondered if I should press the issue. I didn't want to seem childish, and I didn't want to harp on something that would only end in a fight. And I didn't really want to know the truth, no matter what the truth was – that was my secret pleasure. Not knowing for sure.

But then, I also hated the way Jen had taken control of everything, how she was so smug as she played me like a harp.

I mean, what the fuck? Where did this even come from in her?

The phone vibrated in my hand. Jen looked back at me.

“It's Raphael,” I said. I clicked through to his message.

[Raphezzz]: *im game where u at*

I stared at his profile picture again. I imagined his dark skin pressed up against Jen's, his arm looped under her leg, lifting her up so I could get a good view of his black cock sliding in and out of her.

I read the message to Jen.

“Wow,” she said, flipping over and falling to the floor on her knees.

“He doesn't waste any time. I thought we could get a little more fun out of that.”

I wasn't sure, for a moment, what Jen meant by “fun.”

She had shuffled over to me on her knees, and leaned across my lap to peer at the screen. She looked over at the bulge in my pants as she did, and smiled. "Well," she said. "Maybe we can string him along for a bit."

She curled her arms around, over my thighs, leaning the soft fullness of her breasts on my lap, and began to type.

[Me]: *cant get away right now but maybe this will keep you waiting 4 me*

I looked at Jen's delighted face as she typed. She was positively evil, delighting in what she was doing. Stringing this poor guy along. I could see the glee on her face. It was frightening and exhilarating to see.

Then she looked at me. "I'm thinking of sending him a dirty picture," she suggested. Like in your dream."

I shivered again.

"Of what?"

Jen moved her shoulders and her lips suggestively. "Your choice."

I sucked in my breath.

There were so many things I wanted her to do, but inside my mind I scrambled to think about whether or not I should actually ask for them. How far would Jen go? Just thinking about the question made me sick to my stomach, as though I were careening down the hill of a roller-coaster.

How far *would* Jen go?

My choice, my choice...

Her phone beeped again. She flipped the screen so I could see.

[Raphezzz]: *got nothing dont tease me*

Jen was smiling over the phone. "So? What do I send him?"

Something terrible. Something that would drive him wild.

Immediately coming to mind were ideas like this one: Jen could pull her panties to one side and snap a picture of her shaved cunt.

But it was too far, wasn't it?

Too much for me to suggest to her.

Jen turned the phone around and looked at the screen. "I want to do something really naughty," she said.

It felt as though she had read my mind. Her words sent me flying on an uncomfortable high. Uncomfortable, because I wasn't 100% sure that I wanted Jen to *actually* do anything naughty.

Not... too naughty.

She put the phone in my hand. Then she reclined on the couch, facing me, and gave her hair a toss. "Okay," she said, and she almost seemed a little sheepish. "You ready?"

Oh, I was ready.

No, I wasn't.

I stared as Jen looked off to the side first, and then slowly parted her legs. She was wearing a pair of black underwear – a simple, boy-cut pair that was part of her new collection. She slid her palms over her thighs, close to the center of her legs. And then she said: "Don't get my face in it."

She was excited as she leaped over to see the photo after I took it.

"Is it hot?" she said, looking at me.

"I can't really... judge..." I said, stupidly.

Jen's legs were hot. The photo of the center of her body, covered only by black panties, would have driven any man wild. It was making my chest tight and my cock hard as hell.

Jen rolled her eyes. "I think it's pretty hot. Okay, now... do I send it? Is it too much?"

I was dumbfounded. As in: I actually couldn't form words.

So, she watched me shake my head idiotically and mouth words for a few seconds, and then she just went ahead.

She sent it.

My heart felt like it was getting folded up along with the electronic message, scattered all over the universe, put back together again somewhere.

"I can't believe you just did that," I said, breathless.

Jen was crawling toward me now. Her hands were on my pants, unbuckling my belt, taking my cock from inside my pants. She was so in control of herself in that moment, as though she hadn't just done what she had done.

I imagined Raphael opening her picture. She had her hand around my cock, and was looking at me with that teasing, smug, in-control look that grated through me and turned me on as much as it infuriated me. She

stroked my cock, which had been hard since she suggested this game, which was defeating me at every turn by just gushing precum and telling her to just keep going, just take things all the way.

Her phone rattled on the table and she leaned back to reach for it without taking her hand off my cock. She smiled when she read the message.

[Raphezz]: *damn (a bunch of strange, unintelligible emoticons) more plz what u doin plz dont make me wait*

She still had the phone in her hand, and the way she was holding it was so dangerous and sexy, it sent a shudder through me, along my spine. She was terrifying and incredibly sexy at the same time. She brought my cock to her mouth and licked the tip of it, moving the blade of her tongue around the crown of my cock in fat, slurping laps. Her mouth was wet and she let her saliva drip down onto my cock. She pressed her lips to the head and sucked up the oozing precum into her mouth.

Then she looked up at me, grinning a little, and slid my cock into her mouth.

She went halfway, and used her hand to stroke the remainder of my shaft. I sucked in my breath, scarcely able to hold back the cum that was surging up inside of me.

Then she paused, and leaned her head back, still rubbing my shaft up and down with her hand. The phone was in her other hand, resting in her palm, bobbing slightly as she moved. The shiny black surface of the screen looked like the most seductive of weapons, and it sent another pulse of pleasure through me. What was she planning to do?

“You want to do something pretty bad?” she said. She was still stroking my cock, and my balls were boiling over with a need to release. There was nothing I could say at that moment except that sure, I would do whatever fucking thing she suggested, anything at all. I exhaled sharply and whispered, “sure,” because it was all I could do to hold on and not burst all over her face. I wanted to stick it out for whatever she was going to make happen next.

She twisted her left hand, and held it up. She looked sideways at it, and it took me a second to process what the hell she was doing. Then she

moved the phone forward, and started to take my cock into her mouth again.

She was taking a selfie. Of herself. Sucking my cock.

“Jen, Jesus,” I said, because I felt like I should.

At the same time, Jen staring at the lens of her phone, taking a picture of herself sucking my cock, was also hot as all fuck. I wasn't about to really *stop* her.

And what was she going to do with it next?

I threw my head back as I thought of it, and I knew that she would probably go through with it. I grasped her head and began to pull her down further onto my shaft. Her lips slid over my dick and were nearly at the base, when she slid insistently up against the pressure of my hand.

“I'm going to send it,” she said. Her fingers were typing something, and I strained to see, but could not.

I looked down.

Her fingers were on the phone now, her face a little lit up in an almost demonic way. Her eyes were on fire as she swept her fingers over the screen.

“What are you writing?” I said hoarsely. I could barely breathe.

She turned the phone toward me.

I stared at the picture for so long I barely had time to read the text she had composed. Her mouth around my cock, it looked utterly unreal. As though I were getting an actual dose of my own fantasy, seeing my wife suck another cock besides mine. Another spasm surged through me and my cock bounced in her hand. She squeezed me and smiled.

I scanned the text quickly as she pulled the phone away. I could only make out part of it:

[Me]: *just sucking on my -*

Lazily, still half staring at her phone, she put her hand on my cock. I had been bouncing up and down from nearly exploding to aching painfully, and her touch alone was nearly enough to send me over the edge.

Or maybe it was her face, looking hungrily at the phone.

Maybe it was all the potential of the message I hadn't finished reading.

Then she turned back to me, and met my eyes again. The phone was still in her hand, sort of theatrically. She pressed "Send."

Then, without having to put much effort into it, she rubbed my shaft and squeezed the cum from inside of me. "Fuck!" I yelled, as it spurted onto her low-neck shirt, and her lips, and her hand. She ran her tongue over her mouth, and licked up the threads of pearly cum that had roped over her lips.

Then she fell back on the floor, and pulled me toward her and with her, her hand on my shoulder. She stretched out on the rug and pushed me down to her spread and open legs. She used one hand to pull her panties aside and slide her fingers into the slippery mess of her ripe cunt. I joined my fingers to hers and ripped the fabric of her panties slightly as I pulled them to the side and explored the buttery folds of her pussy with my tongue. I moved along the slight bumps on her skin, where her shaved snatch was just starting to grow back, and into the silky inner lips, toward the target of her hardened clit. I found it with my tongue and swirled around the center of it as she moaned and squirmed. Then I sucked her clit into my mouth and pushed down on it with my tongue. She gasped, and I repeated the maneuver, pleased with how she thrust her hips up for more when I pulled away. I licked at her gently, driving her wild.

My cock was getting hard again. I played with her clit, teasing her until she was tossing her head back and forth from side to side. Her phone lit up in her hand and vibrated, but she didn't even look at it or register it. She grasped the back of my head and pushed her pussy against my face, rubbing herself against me until she shrieked in pleasure.

I rose up, hard once again, and fell on top of her. Her eyes were closed, and her legs were still shaking with her orgasm. She let me slide the phone from her hand, and, leaning against the floor, her soft breasts beneath me and my cock swallowed in her hot pussy, I read through the messages we had just sent to Raphael.

Her mouth around my cock.

Her message:

[Me]: *just sucking on my old mans cock maybe come by later*

And Raphael's response:

[Raphezzz]:: *hells yeababee*

I imagined him showing the picture to his friends. Or maybe sitting alone in a bathroom, the phone against the wall, leaning over the toilet and jerking off his cum as he pictured my wife's mouth around his cock.

And then I exploded inside of Jen's cunt, dropping the phone to grasp onto her hair and pound my cum deep inside of her, my mind filled with images of Raphael's body covering hers the same way and filling her up like I was now.

Chapter 14

MILLION-DOLLAR QUESTION

Jen pushed her hair out of her face. She was sweaty and her cheeks were flushed. Little droplets of sweet sweat dotted her upper lip, begging to be sucked off. But I was too fucked-out and dizzy to lean over and do it, as much as I wanted to. I felt around above my head for her phone.

"I can't believe you sent those," I said. There was no confusion about what I was discussing. I wanted to see them again.

Jen smiled and reached up absently to join my hands in the search. "Yeah," she said. "I better delete them in case someone sees them at work or something."

Suddenly my heart plummeted again with a terrible thought. "Hey, this guy doesn't have your number now, does he?"

Jen shook her head, and said, almost like she couldn't believe I was that stupid. "Nooooh. That's what the apps are for. I can just delete him forever and he'll never come back."

I felt a little relief, but it still made me nervous. Nervous and strangely a little turned on. The idea that Jen had just sent out her dirty photos and they might be -

"What about...?" I found the phone and opened up the pictures.

"The internet?" Jen suggested. "Why do you think I didn't get my face in there?"

A cold chill was overtaking my whole body as I sorted through her messages to examine the photo. It was one thing for her to send a sext to a random guy, but it would be quite another for her just to be free and loose on the internet.

I found the pictures, which indeed were quite anonymous.

God, Jen had acted like such a little slut.

The thought of it twisted in my gut, both painful and pleasing.

"That's cold," I said absent-mindedly.

Jen looked at me, perplexed.

"Cutting him loose like that," I explained. Though my mind wasn't really on what she had said about never contacting him again. It was more

on what a slutty, naughty girl she had just been, more on what possibilities lay terrifyingly and tantalizingly in our future.

Jen turned to me, and her face was a little incredulous. “You seemed to think it was pretty hot.”

I couldn't deny that.

Maybe this was the moment, I thought. I desperately wanted to return to the conversation we'd been having in the kitchen. I couldn't remember, now, how it had wrapped up.

Jen folded her hands over her chest.

I opened my mouth, but couldn't find the right words to say, so I just trailed my fingers up and down her skin. She shivered a little as I stroked her shoulder.

“You're so beautiful,” I said.

Jen bit her lip and grinned. She turned her head a little to look at me.

It was obvious that we had to get back to the topic.

I sucked in my breath.

“So,” I said, using my joke-voice and sort of hating myself for having to hide behind it to have this conversation. “How about that thing we were talking about in the kitchen.”

Jen shrugged and rolled her eyes playfully. “What thing? I've totally forgotten all about it.”

She must have seen something on my face fall – I felt it, my features sort of sagging, even though I fought against it. She punched me playfully. “Just kidding,” she whispered. “Okay... well, so you have a... what is it? About me with another man.”

I nodded.

“And this is... is it an anxiety, or a fantasy?”

The intelligence of this question floored me. Then it made me want to slap Heller, because my wife had taken almost no time at all to figure out to ask me what Heller should have, months ago.

Never trust a person who charges you hourly.

“That's the thing,” I said, but my voice was almost enthusiastic.

Jen shook her head. “What thing?”

“That. That's the million-dollar question.”

Or, in the case of Heller, multi-thousand dollar question.

Jen looked confused and held her hands out in exasperation. “So which is it?” she said.

“That's just it.”

Jen put a couch pillow on her face and yelled into it. She threw it aside. “It's like 'Who's On First?' here.”

“I'm 100% certain you have no idea what you're talking about when you say that.” Jen hated sports and she hated old television and film. *And* she was only 28.

“*You* sound like the one who doesn't know what he's talking about.”

I sighed.

“It's... complicated.”

Jen looked over at me. Her eyes moved over my face, sharp and hawk-like now. This was Jen's analytical mode. I half believed she would spit out some grand solution to all of my problems right then and there.

“Do you want me to have an affair?” she said suddenly. “With Emery? Is that why you think about it all the time?”

“No.”

“Is that what started all of this?”

“Er... kind of,” I was starting to feel uncomfortable.

“And would you want me to have an affair with someone else?”

Her hand was moving down my torso now, headed straight for where my cock was coming back to life. She placed her hand over it, and her eyes kept searching mine.

“No affair,” I said, and the word itself, and all of its implications, sent a painful spark through me. My cock twitched. I wanted desperately to explain that this was not the same thing as my fantasy, not exactly right...

“What about something... like a one-night stand?”

I didn't have to nod, because the sensations that went through me told the whole story against Jen's skin and under her hand.

That was what I wanted.

I nodded anyway.

Jen collapsed on the bed for a moment, face-up.

I tried to read her face, because I had no idea what she might be thinking. I was struggling to rein my thoughts in, to think of the right thing to say to get this conversation either derailed completely or back on track,

directed by me instead of her. It all felt so dangerous, so potentially explosive.

Jen let out a sigh and rose up. She slipped her shirt over her body and stretched.

“It's a lot to think about,” she said. She stroked the sole of my foot with her toe. “Let me sleep on it.”

“O – kay?” I said.

She smiled, and left to take a shower.

I stared up at the ceiling, unable to have a single coherent thought.

What the fuck had just happened?

Chapter 15

DREAMS COME TRUE

I left early for work the next day, so there wasn't really any more discussion about the topic. Not that I had any ideas about how things would proceed from there. Jen was already shocking me enough by just offering to consider my fantasy in what seemed like a serious way.

So I was mildly surprised when I received a text from her in the afternoon.

The first thing she sent was a picture taken from a Halloween costume website. It showed a mime costume.

But not just any mime costume.

Sure, the girl who was modeling it had a slightly better body than Jen, in the sense that she had big boobs to plump out the tight striped shirt with the low cut collar, but I could easily imagine Jen in the thigh-high stockings the model was wearing.

[Jen]: *couldnt find naughty nemo*

I stared at the phone. What was she up to?

It was only then that I realized Halloween was that evening. Somehow in all the confusion of my dream and Jen's wild texts, I'd forgotten the date completely.

My phone kept buzzing.

[Jen]: *there's also a schoolgirl costume*

Another picture.

I stared at the costumes, my mind spinning ahead. What was she up to? I didn't dare think it was what I hoped it was. My heart slammed against my chest as I tried to think of how to respond. My stomach was twisting up again, squeezing out the delicious warmth and horrible cold that it was to be jealous and afraid and turned by Jen.

[Jen]: *too cliché?*

[Jen]: *hello? Oh, there's also a nurse.*

My fingers shaking, I typed:

[Me]: *are you ordering online?*

It was dumb but it was all I could think of.

I waited, my blood boiling, my imagination going wild. I didn't dare to actually touch upon my fervent hope that Jen had possibly gotten it into her head to...

No, it couldn't be.

[Jen]: *halloween is today silly I'm at costume shop. What do you want to be?*

The text hit me in the face like a ton of bricks. I actually felt as though I was slammed into the floor, and lifted into the sky. I was falling, flying, smashing into bits, all at once.

I started to type, but I gave up. In my frantic state I was typing garble. I called her.

"Ye-ees," Jen sang into the phone. I could feel her smile through the receiver.

"Where are you?" I said. It wasn't what I had expected to say, and it came out almost desperate and stalker-like. I cleared my throat. "I mean, what are you doing?"

Jen treated me to a light giggle. "Getting a costume together, silly."

"For what?" I said, after a pause. My mouth was dry.

Jen let me simmer over the phone for a while. I could imagine her in some costume shop, holding a mime costume up to her lithe figure, smiling smugly. Enjoying teasing me like this.

My heart started to beat faster with every passing second. I wanted her to say it with a desperation I had never felt before.

"I found a party for us," she said, dragging her words over my skin like a sharp blade that was making no cut. A shiver went down my spine.

“Which one do you like better?” she said. “The mime or the schoolgirl?”

My mouth flapped sort of uselessly. “I have.. I.. whatever one you...”

A beat of silence.

Then, like serrated whiskey, her most pussy-cat purr warbling up from her throat, she said:

“Well... it's your fantasy, though. So you choose.”

My head seemed to fill with an anesthetic. I went numb everywhere but in my dick, which was about the only thing left of my body I could feel as her words wrapped all around me and began to squeeze.

I just breathed into the phone like a maniac, still unsure if she was saying what she seemed to be saying.

“Chris,” she purred again. “You still there? Also, they don't have a yeti costume. But they have Chewbacca, which is...whoo! Pre-tty pricey. But... it seems like a pretty good idea.”

Still, I just breathed.

“You know,” she said, her voice sultry again. “To be able to hide in your costume.”

More breathing. Something slithered inside of me and my vision went dull from the blood pressure that surged through me.

Finally I managed to talk.

“Are you saying what I think you're saying?”

Jen said nothing for a bit. “Oh,” she growled. “This is an idea.” Then a pause.

“Come and pick me up here around eight. There's a thing with the grad students or something.”

“Then?”

Another delicious pause.

“Then, we're going to make your dream come true.”

Chapter 16

OUR OLD FRIEND TREY

I was at the university at 7:30, sitting in the parking lot, trying to get my raging feelings under control. I was shaking as though I had overdosed on caffeine or nicotine, but I hadn't had any of either.

Later in the afternoon, Jen had sent me a text telling me that my costume was at home.

And it was. A very expensive-looking Chewbacca costume. When I put the costume on, the sensation of being inside the Chewbacca head so approximated my lucid dream I almost fell over with a dizzying sickness.

She was really doing this.

I had taken the costume off to drive, opting for some jeans and a shirt in the car. I was burning up in spite of the cold, my hands on the steering wheel. Trying to get my head around what was about to happen. Around the extra slice of pain that it gave me to have to go into her office and retrieve her.

Trying not to let my imagination run wild with the other perverse fantasy that perhaps she was up there with Emery, trying on her costume, letting him adjust some strappy piece of it (I still had no idea which costume she had chosen), kissing her shoulder as he did. Sliding his fingers into the tight striped shirt of the mime costume. Taking the naughty schoolgirl costume to a theatrical place, bending her over the desk and spanking her while he told her how bad her last batch of stats had been.

I sighed.

Or maybe it was just a grad student party.

And maybe Jen was just teasing me, just dragging out the games we played.

She didn't really mean to "make my dream come true," did she?

I was supposed to have a solid conversation about this with her. That's what Heller would say.

The scene before me was surprisingly tame when I opened the door. A handful of students were standing around with plastic cups that appeared to

have punch in them. They seemed moderately, but not especially drunk. I scanned the room quickly for an ultra-sexy costume containing my wife and found none. I went back over everyone again, and saw only the typical assortment of black capes, pointed hats, and clown wigs that one might expect at Every Halloween Party from kindergarten to corporate America..

“Oh no! Didn't you find it?”

Jen's voice.

She was draped in a black cloak with a witchy-looking hood on the back of it, a not particularly sexy costume at all. My eyes readjusted the scene in front of me. She was standing by Emery, who was dressed up as a vampire.

My heart sank again.

This had all just been an elaborate tease.

“The costume's at home,” Jen continued. “I sent you a text.”

She seemed to be playfully winking at me, even though she wasn't.

I looked at her. “It's in the car,” I said half-heartedly.

Someone handed me a plastic cup. “Hey,” he said. His accent, even on that one word, was so thickly Scandinavian it seemed like he kneaded the word around for an hour in his mouth before it got out. I turned to see the man who obviously Sven, the very blonde, very dorky Swede who apparently ran the stats lab. “You must be Chris,” he said. “I'm Sven.”

I held up my cup to toast him.

I was feeling the bile of disappointment in my stomach. I could barely keep my grim mood from tugging the corners of my mouth downward.

Jen, however, was smiling at me, twisting a little in her costume.

“Sven is also really into marketing stats,” she said. “So he's been waiting to meet you.”

Sven swooped upon me like a hawk, and I sipped the atrocious and very weak punch from the plastic cup while he launched into a mostly unintelligible monologue.

This was such a terrible disappointment. It seemed that everything I had been promised by Jen, and everything I had enjoyed imagining about her was falling apart into a pile of plastic capes and cups and – I grimaced at the snack table – pumpkin cupcakes.

But no sooner had I abandoned all hope, and begun to actually try to decipher Sven's rambling narrative, than I saw that Jen had slinked away

with Emery. The two were leaning against a brick wall, standing very close to each other. Their plastic cups were practically touching on the rim, and they were leaning forward to whisper to each other.

Jen had placed her foot against her other leg, and her boring black cape slid away to reveal that her long leg was clad in a black and white striped stocking. As she moved closer to Emery, tucking a strand of hair behind her ear and speaking to him in a low, conspiratorial tone, the cape slid away a little more and a flash of her thigh peeked out.

I met Sven's eyes and nodded, to keep him talking, and then I looked back at Jen and Emery. Jen's gaze wandered over to me as she took a sip from her cup, and again her eyes seemed to glimmer and wink at me, even though she didn't actually do any of that.

My heart surged as I watched: Emery looked down, and he must have seen the striped stockings beneath the cape.

His fingers moved into the fold of the cape and pulled it open.
“What's this?” I heard him say, amused.

Jen pushed his hand away and the cape closed before I could see the costume that was evidently beneath it. She whispered something, smiling at Emery.

I closed my eyes for a little more than a blink, replaying the sight of his fingers on the hem of my wife's cape, pulling it open to view what was underneath.

A gesture of extreme familiarity.

The kind of space-invading familiarity that two lovers could have.

I opened my eyes and looked at them.

They seemed to be moving closer to each other.

Jen laughed, running her fingers over the rim of the plastic cup.

Her eyes suddenly jerked in my direction. A brief glance.

Just to be sure I was watching.

As soon as she turned back to Emery she seemed to move closer again. Her smile seemed to get more wicked, and her eyes seemed to take on even more of a devilish glint.

“...so that is why I gahbhemmla und wordstahrten fahber for the best, yeah?” Sven finished with flourish. He clapped a hand on my shoulder. His face had gotten ruddy and I could see from his eyes that he seemed to have taken quite a hit from the watered-down punch.

“Yeah,” I said, enthusiastically, which seemed to please him. He nodded, and then abruptly turned, smiling foolishly, and walked away.

I looked back to where Jen and Emery had been standing, and my heart plummeted to my feet when I saw that they were no longer there. For a few eternal seconds I panicked: had she just run off with him? Was this the guy she planned to make my dream come true with?

God. Not *Emery*.

My eyes swept in ragged jerks over the room, and I was just about rising to hysteria mode, when a puff of air caressed the back of my ear.

“Boo,” Jen said softly.

I whirled around. She had her cape wrapped around her hand, and the hood pulled over her head. It was an oversized black hood and framed her pretty face nicely, but it also vaguely made her look satanic. “We have to get going,” she said. Her mouth was turned up in a knowing, naughty little grin. I felt a pang of excitement ripple through my relief.

“You're leaving?” It was Emery. He had turned all the way around, abandoning a conversation directly behind Jen.

Jen patted him on the chest. “I told you. Our friend Trey invited us ages ago.”

She looked at me. “Ready?”

I could barely contain the radiating excitement that had burst open when she said “Trey.” That and getting to wave bye-bye to Emery had just buoyed my mood so much I was going stratospheric.

“See you around Dave,” I said, as Jen pulled me through the small cluster of people by the hand, and out into the hallway.

Then we were in the cool night air, on our way, it would seem, to see Trey.

Once we got outside, Jen walked ahead of me. “It's cold as balls out here,” she said.

An expression I had never understood.

Her feet made a very sexy, very feminine hard clack on the pavement. Her hood blew away from her face and she didn't bother to fix it. The cape billowed out behind her and I caught a glimpse of her stockings, which came up to mid-thigh, giving her legs a vague aura of prostitution that was incredibly arousing. Whatever she was wearing above that was not visible:

if it was a skirt, it was as short as my imagined “Naughty Nemo” skirt, because I didn't see anything but her thigh, all the way to the car, no matter how much her cape billowed.

I unlocked the door remotely, and she popped in, shivering.

I climbed into the car and looked over at her. I turned on the heat.

She was clutching her cape for warmth. One piece of the long material, though, had slid away from her thigh. I reached over and gave it a little push, so that it slipped away from her legs. Her bare thighs, above the line of the stockings, were covered in gooseflesh. “You're freezing,” I said. “I had better warm you up.”

Jen had no objections to me taking her thighs in my hands and rubbing them to get them warm. She grinned at me as her teeth chattered.

“So, what's this party?” I said.

She chattered and grinned silently at me for a moment. Her prickled skin smoothed under the heat of my hands, and the silkiness sent a shiver through me. I could feel myself getting aroused. I slid my hands further along her left leg. I had twisted in my seat to hold her thigh in both hands. I moved up the length of her muscle, closer to where I could feel the humid heat of her pussy with my fingertips as they approached -

She pushed my hands away. “Not yet,” she said. “We have a party to get to.”

I reluctantly coiled back into the driver's seat. Jen swept her cape up and covered her legs. She was grinning, having a great time dragging out her teasing.

“So what's this costume?” I said.

“You'll see,” she smiled.

“And where are we going?”

Jen flipped the sun visor down to look in the mirror. “Just get driving. Head west on Jefferson.”

I stared at her. She was twisting some red-orange lipstick from a tube, and it slid out slowly like an emerging cock, headed toward her lips, ready to stain them with its dirty color...

She turned to me sharply, her eyes still smiling. It was only in that second that I realized Jen had an incredible amount of control over all of this: herself, me, the lure of her potential sluttiness. “That's all I can tell you right now,” she said, and her voice was breathy.

Then back to the lipstick, smearing it on thickly.

I stared a few cold, enticing seconds more. She wasn't *really* going to have those very same lips around Trey's cock in less than hour, was she?

My cock throbbed painfully.

I put the car in gear, and followed her instructions blindly. Turning left on Jefferson.

Chapter 17

THE REAL PARTY

Jen got out her phone in the car, and began to type on it, smiling at whatever responses she was getting from, presumably, Trey.

Ordinarily I might have found that rude, but knowing that she was chatting with a potential lover, or maybe more than one, made it sizzling instead. Every glance up at me that I could see in the corner of my eye, every grin, every quick typing fit, was a potential communication to the man she was going to fuck.

What could she have planned? And how was I going to get to watch it? Surely she couldn't orchestrate something just exactly like my dream? I could feel my anxiety building: what if I missed her, somehow?

Or what if this was all just another tease?

What if I actually *wanted* it to be? Did I really, really want my wife to let that guy put his ebony cock inside of her?

A flash of the image of Jen's pussy, filled to stretching with black cock exactly as I had imagined it, sent a shudder through me. The car jerked a little, eliciting a wary eye from Jen.

"Sorry," I said.

Jen dropped her phone into her cape. "Turn up here... I think we need to park somewhere on this street."

I obeyed her instructions, resigned to just follow what she told me to do and go along with whatever it was. I turned the wheel deliberately, set the parking brake with a forceful pull, and placed my hands on my thighs, palms down.

Jen looked over at me. "Okay. So... it's about five houses down on that next street," she said, pointing her finger to the right. "I'll go first and then you can show up a little later. In your costume, of course."

I felt something twist inside of me. "Is this really Trey's party?" I said.

Jen smiled. "You're wearing that suit, right? So just... you know, walk around. Enjoy your anonymity."

She pushed the door open. "Fuck," she said. "It's cold out here."

She looked back at me. “Okay. Last chance to back out.”

Her words seared through me. I shook my head, only a little, mostly from side to side.

Jen slid the cape away from her shoulders.

I stared at her costume. It was black and white striped. The top looked like a very tight button-up blouse, except hardly any buttons were closed. The front was open deep into her chest, and the lacy edges of a black bra were visible among the folds of the shirt.

Her midriff was exposed, and then a scandalously short shirt began at her hip bones. The material clung tightly to her shape, and because she was seated in the car, it barely covered her snatch. Then bare legs, then her slutty stockings, and the black stiletto heels on her feet.

It was an incredibly sexy, incredibly slutty costume.

“What's that?” I said.

She shrugged. Then she pulled a pair of fake, cheap plastic handcuffs from her purse. She twirled them. “'Naughty Prisoner' or something,” she said, laughing. “I don't know. I just thought I looked hot in it.”

I sucked in my breath.

“Is it close enough?” she asked, her voice seductive.

“It's great,” I said.

She leaned over and kissed me, and her hand slid over my bulging cock as she did. I felt a smile quiver on her lips when she felt how hard I was. “Okay. See you on the flip-side,” she said.

Her kiss, and the touch of her hand, slammed through me in two pressured bursts. The sound of the blood in my own ears was almost deafening.

I knew I should probably have said something about rules, or arrangements, or something. Just a final checklist, to make sure we were both on the same page. But I was paralyzed, transfixed, as she climbed out of the car. Her small, round ass was barely covered by the tight striped skirt. Her lean abdomen and her oval-shaped, long belly button were bare from just above her hip to her second rib, the faint outline of which could be discerned beneath her skin, just under the stripes of her skin-tight “blouse.” She shook out her long hair, and began to walk away. When she was about ten feet away, she turned and blew me a kiss from her plumped-up, red-orange lips.

When she turned right at the next street, and a lamp caught the perfect profile of her figure, a terrible thought went through me.

It was the way Jen had pointed in that direction.

It's about five houses down on that next street.

These weren't the directions of someone who had never *been* to a place. No one gave directions like that, so casually, in terms of number of houses... unless they came to that street all the time.

Right?

Jen disappeared in that moment, having walked far enough along the next block to be out of sight. I stared at the empty street.

I took out my phone, suddenly seized by a strange panic, a desire to act, a desire to...what?

Put the brakes on it?

I held the phone in my hand, staring at Jen's number.

My heart twisted in fear and delight, and then one of the two won over. I called her, my heart pounding in the space between pressing the button and the sound of the phone ringing.

What was I doing? What was I going to say?

I had no idea, I just needed a second. A pause. A little more time to decide if...

But the time was over, I realized in horror, as the sound of Jen's phone vibrating reached my ears. She had left it behind, somewhere in the folds of her cape.

I jumped out of the car and yanked the Chewbacca suit out.

Hurriedly, like a madman, I stuffed myself into it. I cursed when I slipped it up and found it was on backwards. It was a fucking monstrosity. I shook it off and cursed some more, shaking the furry, slightly dank costume up again. The zipper caught partially up my chest. Whatever. I slammed the car door and started off down the street, filled with a kind of lusty rage that I couldn't understand myself.

About ten paces away I realized I had forgotten the head, and a wave of creepiness passed over me as the similarity with my dream clanged away in my mind. I stomped back to the car and fished the head out, tugging it unceremoniously onto my face.

The world went uncomfortably dark. The lights dimmed. A car passed me on the left, and scared the shit out of me because I barely heard it.

Fuck.

Overheating already, even in the cold, I walked furiously to the next street and went right, following my slutty little prisoner-wife.

Exactly five houses down, as Jen had indicated – a fact that still burned inside of me – was a house that was unmistakably in the throes of a party.

This party looked a little rougher around the edges than Trey himself looked. We were in Inglewood, a neighborhood that was half-revamped but had dodgy patches here and there. There were certainly a few more dark faces at the party than there had been in my dream.

I felt a little itchy, a little uncomfortable, a little panicked, as I walked up to the porch. I paused there, feeling surreal. I was hot. I wanted to wipe a drop of sweat from my eyes. Jen was nowhere to be found, and it was only a matter of time before someone recognized that I didn't belong here and did something about it.

But no one paid any attention to me.

I was safe in my wookiee costume.

Another strange shudder went through me, a sense of having been in this scene before. The house was nothing like the one in my dream, and the crowd was quite different, but the floating, dreamlike sensation of being there and not quite there was oddly familiar.

Was I actually here? I ran through a checklist of “reality” items to be sure: my feet were touching the ground, I was breathing, I could remember what I had for breakfast.

I was largely sure this was real.

I pushed my way into the house, stomach clenching and twisting. The inside of the house felt hot, and inside the costume I began to sweat. It was as much from the nervous excitement as from the heat. Trickle of sweat licked my spine, my ribs, my balls.

I let my eyes search frantically for Jen, for her stripes and her exposed skin. I let my breathing become as ragged as I wanted. I passed through the rooms of the house, no one looking at me for more than a second. I began to grow confident in my persona as a non-entity, hidden in my costume. I was essentially invisible: just an unknown person in a costume.

An open-concept kitchen and dining room made up the back of the house. The lights were dimmer here, and it was hard to see through the plastic mesh of the eyeholes. I paused near a wall and took a moment to survey the scene. A couple next to me was making out heavily in a seat sunken into the wall. They paid me no attention, even though I was staring at them blatantly. They were an attractive, young couple, and the girl was dressed like an angel, but the guy's hands were down the front of her costume, hard and lumpy over the shape of her breasts, fondling her. I watched for a moment, as transfixed by what I was seeing as the fact that I was being allowed to stare.

But I needed to find Jen. I scanned the room again. My heart was being crushed with each second that I didn't find her.

Then stripes caught my eye. Jen was sitting on a raised bench along the wall of the sunken dining/living room area. Her legs were swinging playfully, her ass barely seated on the ledge. My eyes went firstly to her short skirt, which barely covered her, and the shadow between her legs, which she was barely keeping together. If I were closer, I would have been able to catch a glimpse of whatever was there in the center. She had a drink in her hand and she was smiling, holding it coquettishly next to her cheek.

My heart went cold again. Next to her, looking fit and athletic as before, was the unmistakable form of Trey. Trey from Brownhouse.

I could see from his body language that he was moving in on her. Talking smooth, getting ready to lean in, maybe place a hand on her arm, slide his fingers along her skin and ignite her with his touch. Then he would move down, brush his fingers over her thigh...

I felt like pinching myself again. After having such a lucid dream, and now having such a dreamlike experience in real-life, I felt I could no longer trust my own mind.

I walked slowly into the room and looked around for an excuse to be there, or a place to tuck myself away. I located a keg and moved toward it.

"Nice costume," a guy standing next to the keg said dryly. "Need a beer?"

I moved my giant wookiee head in assent. Because I was free to turn my head a little within the confines of the costume, I could appear to be looking at him and still have a pretty great view of Jen and Trey, who were coming closer together, smiling more, getting ready to touch.

I felt the weight of the cup in my hand get denser. “Thanks,” I said gruffly.

“That you, Mac?” the guy said.

I moved my head “no,” and he shrugged, turning to another person who wanted a beer.

There was no way to drink my beer, I realized, so I turned slightly away and pretended to be watching something outside, my eyes straining to the right to see Jen.

Almost as if Trey had read my thoughts, he was moving in. His dark hand went to Jen's, and he made little circles on the back of her hand. He was talking, his eyes on hers. I couldn't hear anything but the loud murmur of a party, the sound of music overbearing and distant at the same time.

His fingers were moving up her arm now. Whatever he was saying, it was making Jen look to the side in mock embarrassment and amusement. No, her look was saying, she could *never* be such a slut. I watched as my wife played that game of reeling a man in, giving in a little, shaking her head to indicate she shouldn't be so naughty, her body softening with each second as she let him get in closer and closer.

My cock was throbbing painfully now, my heart rate so fast it bordered on being dangerous.

I felt a wave of near-nausea as I watched Jen's playful, dangling legs part, and Trey's body slipped between them. Her striped stockings were on either side of him now, and they were no longer swinging playfully. He stroked her arm with the back of his hand, drawing it along the length of her limb until he reaching her neck. He splayed his fingers out and brushed her hair away tenderly.

Surely Jen could see that I was right there. I willed her to look at me, but she only flushed with the touch of Trey's fingers and tipped her head slightly.

His dark hands kept moving, stroking her skin until he drew them along her throat and lifted her chin.

He was going in.

Jen's eyes fluttered up to meet his and then he lowered his mouth closer and closer. He brushed his fat lips over hers, teasing her just a little, before he swallowed up her mouth in his.

A curtain of red seemed to fall down through my eyes as I watched him kiss her passionately, probing her mouth with his tongue. It was a dominating, engulfing kiss, and it seemed to cross the room to grasp me viscerally, squeezing my heart and my balls in a vice.

I was so caught up in the way he was swallowing her sweet mouth in his that I had barely noticed that his hand had dropped back down to her thigh.

I had turned slowly as I was watching, and clearly I was no longer hiding that I was staring. But again, no one seemed to notice or care. Trey released her mouth, and Jen's closed eyes fluttered open dreamily. He looked from side to side, and then his dark hand moved inward on her thigh, between her skin and his pants, stroking the very top of her inner thigh with his fingers.

Jen's mouth opened in a very poor imitation of scandal, but she did nothing to stop him as his fingers slid further up. I couldn't see, exactly, nor could anyone else, but anyone looking at the scene would have known that his fingers had made their way at least to where Jen's panties, wet with excitement by now, covered her mound.

I saw a smug smile turn Trey's mouth up in a big smile. He said something, a little surprise on his face, and bit into Jen's lower lip. Her body rippled against him and her eyes flashed with naughtiness.

She had no underwear on.

The realization hit me: it was so obvious in the pleased expression on Trey's face. His fingers had probed right up under her skirt, right there in front of the whole crowd, and found nothing to stop him from dipping into her soaked folds.

Surely not. Surely Jen was not being that big of a slut.

He leaned in and began to kiss her again, and Jen's eyes dropped in a pleased half-lidded purr.

Then, she lifted her eyelids for just a moment, and stared directly at me, as Trey's square jaw worked tirelessly to massage her tongue.

Then the look was gone.

Trey dragged his wet lips over her cheek and up to her left ear, his hand still deep between her legs in a lewd display of indecency that no one else but me seemed to care about, and he whispered into her ear.

The next seconds, or half-second, seemed to move as slowly as anything ever had: Jen's eyes fluttered, she looked briefly at me, then she lowered her eyes again, and her lips parted in pleasure.

And clearly formed the syllables: "Okay."

Trey wasted no time, He used his free hand to grab her ass and pull her down from the ledge. The hand he had been massaging her with stayed where it was until her feet touched the floor. Her striped skirt rode up, promising but not delivering a view of her bare snatch. Trey used that hand to tug the dress down to an acceptable place on her thighs. And then he turned her around, still holding her to him so he could kiss her lecherously. He gave her another spin and pushed her in front of him, his hands moving all over her body. He kept her pressed against his hard chest, and I knew that his cock was bulging against her lower back.

I didn't dare turn with them. It took all the willpower I had to wait a beat, and watch them in the reflection of the glass window as they made their way through the crowd of partiers toward the hallway.

I set the beer down on the kitchen counter and turned to follow them.

What in the fuck were they doing? Where were they going? I began to panic as I tried to consider the possibilities. How was I going to be able to watch them if they went upstairs to a bedroom? This felt like my dream, but it wasn't. There was no way some lucky circumstance would appear, giving me the opportunity to peek inside (I had a momentary chuckle as I imagined myself running outside, digging around for a ladder).

But the panic started in again as I watched Jen's striped legs disappearing up the stairs, swishing sexily as she climbed. Trey was ahead of her now, leading her away – away from me and away from any possibility of me seeing them together. He had her hand in his, and she was letting him pull her upstairs.

By the time I made it through the people to the base of the stairs, they were no longer at the landing. The stairs cut through the center of the house, and so they could have gone in either direction at the top of the stairs. A girl in a pussy-cat costume, with see-through leggings and no skirt, was huddled on the top stair. She looked at me and smiled rather wickedly.

My heart started to pound. It was a small house, and no one seemed to be upstairs except the people who had business up there. I was totally conspicuous in this costume, which had been fun up to this point but was

now a major liability to... well, stealth. But with mounting despair I thought about the upstairs, how it couldn't be more than a few bedrooms, and how I was going to end up standing here at the foot of the stairs, waiting for my wife, missing all of the excitement.

Behind the cat-girl, Jen's stockings suddenly appeared. From where I was, I – or anyone – could see right up her skirt, where a shadow fortunately hid her shaved, probably soaked slit. She looked down at me with a smile on her face. Trey was nuzzling her neck, and his hand was wrapped around her bare waist and moving nearer to her breast with each passing second.

Jen held a hand up, palm out, and waved it slowly back and forth. Then they began to walk back down the stairs.

It was a signal for me, but I had no idea what it meant. Jen's legs neared me on the stairs. Trey had released her as she walked down, but she had a hand on his shirt that she was gently tugging.

I stood where I was, again transfixed. Jen stopped in front of me, and slid her hand under Trey's shirt at that moment.

“Chewie,” she said. “Can I get by?”

A beat. No more than half a second, but it seemed like an eternity. My eyes were riveted to Jen's hand running over Trey's muscled torso beneath his shirt. His dark hand on her shoulder. Jen's wicked smile, a little dark, as though the spirit of Halloween had invaded her.

The remark slowly registered with me.

I was Chewie.

I needed to get out of the way.

I felt a gentle pressure on my chest.

Jen's hand.

Pushing me slowly back. The idea of the contact against me and also Trey sent an electric shiver through me. I stared at her hand. She was making lazy, gentle circles on Trey's stomach. Low, grazing his pelvis. Soon she would be dipping into his pants, finding that huge, thick cock, and squeezing it hard.

My own cock pulsed. I moved backward with the gentle pressure that Jen was applying to my chest.

“Yo man, move outta the way,” Trey said, suddenly impatient.

Jen smiled as she passed me. Trey pushed ahead of her, taking her hand. He was moving with the kind of single-mindedness and determination that only a man who is sure he will get laid has. They had a plan, and it involved them leaving the house.

I looked back up the stairs. Wasn't this Trey's house? And why wouldn't they just use a bedroom?

When I looked back, Jen was in the doorway, and dropping onto the porch. They were going.

I held back for a bit, standing on the porch as they chose a direction – left, and started walking in a hurry. Trey's hands were all over my wife, but they were walking with the pace and determination of a couple who had a place to go.

I hopped off the porch. I was grateful that there seemed to be some late-night trick-or-treaters out, and quite a few people on their way to parties. Jen and Trey turned at the street Jen and I had parked on.

Jen was shivering, rubbing her arms and walking quickly. It was cold enough out that our breath was visible. Mine steamed out of my eye holes. Condensation was gathering in wildly uncomfortable places as I chugged along in my awkward costume.

By the time I turned the corner, Jen and Trey had arrived at... our car?

My pulse skyrocketed. The doors were open, and Jen was lowering herself into...

The passenger seat.

I stared as the lights of the car came on. The engine was started, and Trey was behind the wheel of *my* car. With *my* wife.

I was walking toward them as though on a mission, my breath loud inside the Chewbacca head, my blood pressure straining the arteries in my neck. The lights of the car suddenly dimmed to parking lights.

And so I had a view, as I approached the car. Trey and my wife were kissing in the front seat, and Trey had his hand dipped into the tight shirt of her costume. I went cold thinking of how his thumb was probably stroking her nipple right now, feeling it pebble under his skin, thinking about how he would bite into it and make her moan.

I kept walking, and I looked into the car as I passed it. Only one image, as though I had simply taken a snapshot and then it burned through me and stained my mind forever: Jen's hand between Trey's legs. Her

fingers splayed wide and curved slightly around the thick column that bulged in his pants. Visible even to me, inside my stupid Chewbacca head.

I kept walking, my heart pounding and my thoughts racing.

What was her plan? What were they doing?

Maybe they would fuck in the car. That had to be it.

I searched the yards in my immediate vicinity. There was no place to hide. No good place, where a Chewbacca could stare at a car with a couple banging inside of it without being... incredibly noticeable.

I turned to look back at them at that moment, and the brake lights came on precisely then, as though for me. The back of the car was fogged up from the inside – and not with cold. The car moved slowly away from the curb, as I stared in helpless horror, unable to move.

I watched my own car, with my own wife, drive away from me. Trey, the black, athletic stranger from *Lust*, at the wheel.

For a few moments I just stood there on the street. All different kinds of panic set in from all sides.

This was fucking ridiculous. This guy just drove off with my fucking wife.

In my car.

This was dangerous as hell.

And I was left alone on the street, my cock throbbing and my heart exploding, in a Chewbacca costume, with *no fucking car*.

A vibration nagged me out of my trance. A vibration in my pants pocket.

Buried in my stupid costume.

I lifted the head off and let it fall on the street. Then I tore at the costume and peeled away the top half of it. I stared at the screen.

[Jen]: *Goifinfg homm se u therr*

I imagined what Jen would have to be doing to type this poorly, and shuddered.

But at least she had her phone. At least she had communicated with me. And she was...

Going home.

I stared at the screen some more.

“Fuck?” I said. Really more of a question. Like, “what the fuck?”

The phone vibrated in my hand.

[Jen]: *I told him I'm texting u to see when youll be home If we go the long way can u get a cab and hide somewhere befor we get thr?*

The feeling of excitement began to win out as I read her words. I didn't necessarily want Trey in my house, but the wisdom of the plan was breaking through to me. It seemed like it was either this or miss out, and I was finally going to have to call it.

And the thing is: there wasn't really any way to absolutely stop it. The wheels were already well in motion. Now it was just a question of whether I wanted to be there or not when Trey defiled my wife.

I started to type.

But then a message from Jen appeared on the screen, as the phone rattled in my hand.

[Jen]: *Or better yet, I can take another kind of detour...*

There was no question, of course, what that was. I felt my stomach turn again. But I finished typing the message I was already composing.

[Me]: *OK Meet you there.*

And then, in the cold of the street, I had another thought.

[Me]: *not our bed though*

There was a long, empty silence around me as waited. No answer from Jen.

I called a cab, and headed up to Grange Road to try to hail one sooner. I was about a block away when I turned around, remembering that I had left my Chewbacca head on the ground.

It was there, staring back at me.

I turned and kept walking. That was the least of my problems, and I didn't have a minute to lose.

*

In the cab I must have looked ill, as I thought about how Jen was going to delay Trey's arrival at our house. Would she be blatant about it, and tell Trey to pull over, then just bend over and suck on his cock right there on a public street? I pictured her hair bobbing up and down while Trey looked down at her luridly, a smile on his face as my wife slurped and gagged on his gigantic cock until he burst inside her mouth.

The cabbie asked me if I was okay.

"Yeah," I was barely able to say. My cock was so hard it was starting to make me sick to my stomach, and my balls were painful as hell.

Did Jen get my message? Not in our bed. I really meant that, and I would have said something a lot sooner if I had had any inkling that we would end up in this situation.

The cab pulled up to my curb slowly and I threw money at him. "Hurry, hurry," I said. "Get out of here."

The cabbie's eyes crinkled in the mirror, as though he seemed to know if not what I was doing exactly, what it had to do with. *We all have wives*, his eyes seemed to say.

I ran around the house and fumbled with my keys to get in through the garage door. This was stay out of sight, but I realized too late how stupid it was. If they opened the garage door, there I would be: Chewbacca home invader.

But that didn't happen.

In the house, in the dark, I spun around, unable to process what I was doing.

My phone buzzed. It was Jen.

I answered the call, opening my mouth to shout: "Hello?" but stopping myself just in time.

What if it was a secret call?

Or what if it was an accidental call?

I listened.

At first I heard nothing. There were vague, unidentifiable sounds coming through the phone. Maybe the sound of a street. Definitely not driving. It was all I could do not to scream into the phone.

Were they kissing? Is that why it was silent?

Fondling each other?

What?

And then I heard Trey's voice. A low rumble, very low. A moan. Then a sharp exhale. "Oh fuck, baby. Just like that." He was whispering, his voice strained.

And then I heard it: the unmistakable slurp of a wet mouth around a cock.

My wife's wet mouth.

On his big, fat black cock.

More slurping. Sticky sounds, the sounds of his cock inside her mouth as she sucked away on him.

"Fuck, fuck that feels good," Trey whispered. Then his voice deteriorated into low grunts.

Then nothing but sticky slurping.

And then a sharp, loud yell, as my wife sucked the cum from inside his cock.

Panting.

The pop of her mouth as she released his dick.

I wondered if she had swallowed, and supposed that she had.

My stomach felt like it had been frozen.

She had really done it.

"Uh.." Trey murmured.

Then Jen's voice, unintelligible. Inviting.

And then silence. I held the phone to my ear, straining.

But she had hung up.

*

I stood immobile in the kitchen. I stepped out of the Chewie costume after shimmying it down to the floor. Reality was pounding at me like a fist in the dark: *my wife just sucked another man's cock. My wife just sucked another man's cock.*

I don't have any idea how long I stood there. I basically forgot about the original plan.

And then I heard the garage door opening.

Another rush of panic. I looked frantically around, kicked the Chewie costume under the table, and dashed into the living room, where I looked around again, my heart pounding, my brain reeling for an answer. A place to hide.

The door to the house was opening. In a panic, I threw myself behind the couch, into the small space where there was less than two feet of space between me and the wall.

I still had my phone in my hand.

What to do? If she fucked him in here, how would I be able to see them?

But where else could she go?

And almost as if she was reading my mind, Jen sent me a message. At the same time, her voice got low in the kitchen, and a light went on. "Just have to make sure..." she was saying. "You want something to drink?" she said.

I looked at my screen.

[Jen]: *where ar u*

I took a deep breath. In the kitchen, I could hear the rustling and the low shuffle of two bodies pressing together. The smack of a kiss. They weren't going to waste any time getting inside of my wife.

My head was spinning. If I told her where I was, would she come here to fuck? How would I see her?

But still, if I told her to go somewhere else... where would that be?

I typed.

[Me]: *Living room*

But maybe it was too late. I heard the loud thud of bodies hitting the floor. The clatter of Jen's phone as it went sliding across the kitchen tiles. Panting.

They were just going to do it right there in the kitchen.

I crawled on my elbows toward the end of the couch farthest from the view of the kitchen. It was a bad view, but the way I was facing. I peeked out, and seeing nothing, ventured further. Then I continued to crawl until I was behind the chair. Now there was the definite smacking of bare skin against bare skin, the wet slurps of kisses.

I dared to peek out.

I could only see their entwined arms, and Jen's hair splayed on the kitchen floor like a fan. Trey was holding her arms to the floor, sucking on her face.

And then his head moved down. His hands reached down to push Jen's shirt up her body. I saw her nipples spring loose.

He gathered her wrists up with the shirt, above her head. He gave the shirt a little twist and tied her hands loosely together. Then he lowered his head again and took one of her nipples in his mouth. I stared as his fat lips closed around Jen's tiny round pebble. She lifted her chin and pushed her tits toward him. I heard her throaty moan and my own cock nearly burst.

And then Trey's head disappeared. Slowly. Setting like a black sun, until it was out of view.

And then Jen's mouth fell open, and she twisted violently. She lifted her head, and then threw it back. "Oh god," she said.

And it was obvious then what was happening: the big lips and the red tongue of the black man in my kitchen were sliding over the bare skin on either side of Jen's shaved cunt, nuzzling, teasing... and then plunging into her buttery folds, lapping up her honey-sweet juices, sliding like a snake over her smooth clit, sending a shudder through her and then another. Enjoying the way my wife spasmed in his hands and started to purr like a cat.

Jen wrestled free of the striped shirt and lowered her hands. I couldn't see where they were going. They came back into view, clasped by one of his giant hands.

"Oh God, oh god, oh Gooooood!" Jen squealed, and then her voice was cut off by a silent scream as she very obviously shook with a fierce orgasm. Her hands went limp for a moment, and her mouth was frozen in an open "o."

Then she started to twist her head from side to side. "Oh, no," she said. "No, please, no more. Oh God."

She started to squirm backward, and with her body came the black head of Trey, between her legs, unrelenting in his attack on her pussy. His hand held her flailing wrists firmly, and she slid away, but he simply moved with her. They moved back until they were in clear view. The whole time Jen whined and squealed, claiming she could take no more. Trey didn't care, he just kept attacking her, until her abdomen was spasming wildly and she was pant-screaming to the rhythm of his assault.

I could hear in her voice that another orgasm was rising up inside of her, but just as she nearly reached the peak, her voice terrifyingly high-pitched, Trey lifted his head.

Jen collapsed. "Oh, God, no, please don't stop."

Trey rose up on his knees. "Don't worry," he said, smoothly. He unbuttoned his pants, and slid them down with his underwear to release his cock. It bounced heavily in front of him.

My eyes widened. That was a gigantic cock. Thick, long, so big it was weighed down at the end and bounced lightly with its own weight as Trey walked on his knees until his cock was hovering over Jen's face.

I stared as the little slut of a wife I had opened her mouth, extended her tongue, and licked at Trey's big, swinging balls. She flicked her tongue at them, and he let her lap at them for a bit before he lowered himself down and his hairy sack disappeared entirely inside of her willing, wide-open mouth. I stared as Trey looked down and watched my wife suck on his balls, and then lick the length of his shaft as he moved back down her body.

He slapped her twice on the side of her hip, and pushed her lightly, so that she knew to roll over. "Get on your hands and knees for me," he said. His voice as commanding, no-nonsense.

And my wife was happy to obey.

I was crushed against the floor, afraid to move, especially now that they were both facing my direction. On my side was the darkness of the room, but still – Trey could look over here and see that a man was staring at him.

He didn't look at that, though. Instead he looked down at my wife's ass as he pushed her skirt up. I shuddered, thinking of his view – formerly mine alone, now his. Jen's smooth, mocha ass, her dark pussy lips hidden beneath shaved folds of buttery-brown, her dripping cunt engorged from his tongue. He guided his big cock to her pussy. He moved the head around,

and Jen lifted her head and winced and squealed as he ran his hard crown over her clit.

Jen let out a slow and pained moan as he pushed himself inside of her. Slowly, inch by inch. In spite of the sticky wetness of her cunt, which I could hear from across the room, there was obvious resistance as his fat cock stretched her open and pushed its way into her tight hole.

“Is that the biggest cock you've ever had inside of you?” I heard him say, when the base of his dick was swallowed by the lips of her pussy.

“Oh fuck, yes,” Jen panted. “Oh God. It's so big...” her voice faded away. Her eyes were wide in discomfort and shock. He was slowly pulling out of her.

“You'll get used to it,” Trey said, in his smooth voice. He began to fuck her, slowly. I wished, desperately, that I could see his cock inside of her, the stretching of her pussy lips, the column of his black dick as it pushed her folds lightly in, then tugged them out.

Jen moaned. The discomfort was fading, and now she was beginning to squirm in pleasure again.

He began to fuck her faster. “That's it,” he said, placing a hand in her hair and pulling on it. His thighs began to slap rapidly against her ass as he pistoned in and out of her. “You're not even gonna feel it when your old man fucks you after this,” he said. “Once you go black...”

I shuddered. I could see the size and shape of his cock when he pulled away – the slickness of it, covered in Jen's excitement, and the girth of it, which seemed to be increasing with every thrust into my wife's cunt.

Jen's breathing was getting ragged.

“That's it, baby. Come for me,” Trey breathed.

Jen's whole body seized up as she was racked by another orgasm. Trey wound his hand in her hair and held her up by the hair so that her hands barely touched the floor as he began to ram himself ferociously into her pussy. The squelching and slapping of his cock inside of her clawed inside my chest. He was manhandling my wife now, just fucking the living shit out of her, and I couldn't look away, or think of anything I would rather see more. Jen's body was practically limp: she was spent, still moaning lightly from her orgasm. This went on for what seemed like an eternity, until Jen began to mumble, “Oh, God, I can't take any more, it's too much..”

Trey just kept fucking her. He thrust deep inside of her and withdrew almost to the tip of his cock. Finally, I saw his muscles harden on his sculpted torso, and he threw his head back and rammed himself so deep inside of Jen that she howled like a tortured animal. Trey slammed his cum inside of her, thrusting deep over and over again to get every last filthy drop of his cum deep into her swollen cunt.

He released her hair, and Jen fell forward. I stared at the sight of them as long as I dared: Trey kneeling over my wife, his cock embedded in her pussy. Then, fearing he would look up and see me, I pulled my head in behind the chair.

As their panting died down, I heard my own wild breathing. My cock was screaming at me, nearly bursting through the outer skin. My fingers itched with such desire to plunge into Jen's stretched pussy and feel the slimy juices of Trey's cum that I could barely restrain myself.

But instead of leaving, by the sounds of it, Trey appeared to be putting the moves on my wife again. There was the slurping, sucking sound of kissing again. Then an uncertain giggle from Jen. "Again?" she said.

Jesus, who was this fucking guy?

I didn't dare look out. I pushed the hanging flap of material at the bottom of the chair up, reached under it and pushed up the flap on the side. I could only see their skin slapping together, their bodies twisting and rubbing against each other. Shadows. No details.

I balled my hand in a fist.

Trey mumbled something in a low voice.

Jen laughed. "No, no way. He's gonna be home any minute."

Another low rumble.

I leaned toward the sound.

Did he just say what I thought he said?

I want to fuck you in your bed.

Jen was protesting, saying that she couldn't, but he interrupted her protests with a sloppy wet kiss, a low, smooth rumble.

She wouldn't.

They were standing up.

"No, I can't," Jen was saying, but she was laughing a little.

"Seriously. You have to go, he'll be back any minute."

But Trey was pushing her backward down the hallway. "I'll make it quick," he said.

Jen's voice disappeared into wet, slurping sounds again.

They were moving down the hallway.

Rage filled my head, and my ears pulsed with sound of my blood. When their voices were nearly down the hallway, I rose up from behind the couch. I stood in full view, but Trey had his back to me, and was crabwalking my wife toward the bedroom.

She was resisting, moderately, but still, there they were, going...

I stood for a beat of silence, and then I felt a rush as adrenaline and decision shot through my arteries. The sickness in my stomach subsided. I walked with deliberation through the kitchen, to the back door.

The loudest one, if you slammed it, as Jen nearly always did.

And then, with a flourish that surprised even me, I opened the door wide and slammed it closed.

"Honey!" I yelled, loudly and with a big smile on my face, "I'm home!"

Then I waited. I stood in the kitchen, filled with a kind of smugness, as I listened for exactly what I expected to hear.

The slide of the doors to the small, low porch outside of our bedroom.

A puff of air as the cold from outside blew through our warm, sealed townhome.

I looked through the window, and saw the frantic shadow of a dark man, leaping – very gracefully – over our fence.

Then I walked, calmly and finally feeling quite smugly in control of myself, to the hallway, where I turned, and strode down the hall.

Jen was on the bed, her feet crossed in front of her, a nervous smile on her face. She looked half-caught, half-guilty. Even though we had agreed on all this, she seemed a little ashamed. The door was still open, and the room was getting cooler by the second, but I paid it no mind. I reached the foot of the bed, and slid my boxers down, stepping out of them. I reached for Jen's ankles, and dragged her to the edge of the bed, spreading her legs apart as I did.

The acrid scent of another man's cum filled my nostrils.

I pushed Jen's legs up and open, touching her swollen pussy lips with my fingertips. She squirmed a little, still sore from the abuse of Trey's

enormous cock.

“Is it true?” I said. “Once you go black... ?”

I had my cock in my hand, and I was teasing the face of her clitoris with it. She was twisting and squirming in reawakened arousal. I brought her ankles together and pushed her legs up toward her face. Her pussy blossomed open, and a gush of cum dripped out of her cunt and down to her asshole.

I moved her legs slightly, so I could see her face. I raised my eyebrows. “Well?”

Jen bit her lips and smiled.

“...you *might* go back,” she said.

I slid the first delicious inch of my cock into her hot pussy, sticky with Trey's cum. “Oh yeah?” I said. “And what about your husband?”

She reached toward me and grabbed my ass, pulling me so that I sank into her unfaithful, dirty cunt. I felt Trey's cum spill out and over my balls.

Then I fucked my wife until her pussy was overflowing with mine.

Jen slid her legs over my arms and around me, her heels against my lower back. She ground herself up against me until I was deep inside of her. Her eyes opened, wet and large, and she consumed me with her gaze as we kissed.

We lay like that, panting with the exertion of our adventure, for what seemed like a long time. Finally, reluctantly, I rolled off of her, and we lay face-up on the bed, our feet over the edge.

Jen rolled toward me and placed her hand tentatively on my chest. I looked over at her. She seemed a little uncertain, as if she was asking for something. I took her hand and brought it to my lips.

“Was that okay?” she said, finally.

I kissed her in response. I kissed her fingers again, and we placed our foreheads together. “That was hot,” I said. My heart was still pounding. We looked at each other for a moment, and even though it seemed so impossibly strange, I could feel a sense of connection unlike any before. There was something about taking my wife back, getting her beneath me after she had let herself be used so thoroughly by another man, feeling her pull me inside of her to the depths of her center, that made me feel more completely attached to her than ever before.

“Fuck,” she said finally, smiling. “It's cold as hell in here.”

The sliding door was still open. We laughed again, and I jumped up gallantly to close it.

Jen pulled on my t-shirt, still damp with my sweat. I fetched my boxers from the floor.

“Want something to eat?” Jen asked, tentatively.

I was, in fact, starving, now that she mentioned it. We kissed again, and she trotted ahead of me toward the kitchen. Her top and her shoes were scattered in the kitchen, wet and tangled. She opened the fridge and, not knowing what else to do, I collapsed on a stool. Her ass hung out of the shirt as she stood on tiptoe to get a glass from the cupboard. “I’m so thirsty,” she said.

I stared at her skin, still wet with cum. Mine and Trey’s. I felt a pang of jealousy, and a wave of arousal.

Then, from beneath me, a low rumble.

A little ping.

Jen turned toward the sound.

I bent down, and picked up her phone, which had fallen, like everything else, to a random place on the floor.

I turned the screen toward me.

I New Message

And next to it, the linked “D” and “B,” vaguely reminiscent of asses and tits, of *DeBauch*.

I looked at Jen.

She shrugged, gave me a wry smile, and took the phone from my hand. She set it down on the island counter.

“Later,” she said, handing me a glass of water.

Her face full of seductive and mysterious amusement.

END

MORE FROM ARNICA BUTLER

*If you enjoyed Grand Slam,
give my other novels a try!*

See [My Author Page](#) for a complete list of books, or...

[*A Conventional Hotwife*](#)

Paul Banks was thrilled when a luggage mix-up five years ago opened a window of opportunity for his long-buried desires. Since that time, he and his wife have been playing a little game at their yearly company conventions, and every year his wife ups the ante, going further into his fantasies. But Kathy Banks might be getting just a bit out of control, and things might be going a little too far...

Or not.

[*Grand Slam: An Interracial Hotwife Adventure*](#)

Charles keeps a secret desire about his wife Zoe. Her sizzling beauty is typically hidden under scrubs and a hair bun, so his fantasy may never happen. But a wrong turn on a weekend getaway turns out to be the opening pitch of a very naughty game, and Zoe seems determined to knock it out of the park.

[*A Well-Laid Trap \(2-Part Series\)*](#)

It all begins when Patrick is convinced he saw his wife with another man at a downtown bar.

He begins to investigate. But the more Patrick uncovers about Jordan's

activities, the less he understands.

The biggest problem is, Patrick can't decide how he really feels. On the one hand, his wife seems to be betraying him, and on the other, his sex life has reached a scorching pinnacle he never thought possible.

But he had better hold on to his hat, because when he finds out the truth, things will get much, much hotter than he might have ever imagined...

Opening Up

If you are a fan of Arnica Butler but missed her first few novels, or if you prefer scorchingly hot but romantic fare, enjoy this bundle containing Arnica Butler's previously published, light and fun hotwife novels: ***The Hotwife Summer, The Hotwife Tattoo*** and ***A Gamble***. These novels are not in KU, but the whole set can be yours for only \$4.99!

Ela's Performance

Peter's sweet-faced and fiery wife is headed back to school for a degree in violin performance. Unexpectedly, Peter finds himself becoming very paranoid about who Ela is spending so much time with, and what she is doing at school so very late. It isn't as if he doesn't have his reasons for suspicion. There's the way his own relationship with Ela started, and their own past experiment with an open relationship before they were married. A few other strange things to fuel his jealous fantasies...

And when he discovers someone from Ela's past has resurfaced, he'll take a chance and confront his own desires and obsessions...but will he get what he really wants?

The Hobby Job

Former career professional Laura is going crazy living her stay-at-home-mom life in a small country town. Her husband Conrad has the perfect solution: get a "hobby job." Laura gets turned on to the idea, and to Conrad's surprise, chooses to wait tables at a run-down restaurant down the street. But she gets a lot more than a hobby job when she meets Nate, a young, hot waiter who has his eyes on her from the start.

Conrad and Laura start on separate journeys, exploring new possibilities in their marriage, and opening up to their hidden desires, fantasies, and needs. Will their journeys merge, or will Laura's "hobby job" make a hobby of their marriage?

The Hotwife Tattoo

When Greg's brother marries his wild, tattooed, ex-girlfriend Renee, he knows things will be a little complicated. But when Renee befriends his wife Sara, she starts to change in almost unbelievable ways. Greg sees that there is something more to Renee's plans than just friendly sister-in-law bonding. Is Renee's influence all bad, or can Greg get something he has always wanted and never admitted to his wife – maybe even himself?

The Tenant: A Very Naughty Hotwife Novel

Once upon a time, his exotic and incredibly sexy wife Anna loved to indulge Brian's fantasies...to a point. She teased strangers, and took them to cruel, tantalizing places. But she never went all the way. The game ended when Brian and Anna got married, and that was that.

Or was it?

When the gorgeous, charming, and very black John moves into their basement rental, Brian finds that his sleeping desires have been building up all these years. He doesn't just want Anna to tease. He isn't just toying with the idea. He is obsessed with driving his wife to do things with another man. Lewd things. Obscene things.

When he confesses his desires, is Anna just a little bit too willing to make things just like old times? Is she too easy to push over each new line? Brian can't help but wonder if his own obsessions have gone too far...or if Anna's have.

A Gamble: The Making of A Hotwife

Ryan is just an average guy, coaxing his sweet, beautiful wife Victoria into playing into his hotwife fantasy – even if they're just pretending. But a trip to Vegas with his co-worker Brad and his sexy wife Irena turns Ryan's life upside-down. To help Ryan, Brad makes a proposal that could change everything...but it all centers on Victoria's innocence. How far will Victoria go to save what she holds most dear, now that her virtues, her love for Ryan, their marriage, Ryan's desires, and even their finances all hang in the balance? This is a 52,000-word novel about risk and romance, filled to the brim with the hard, steamy scenes you love. Please enjoy!

The Hotwife Summer

When Ben and Summer have the chance to spend the summer in Italy, their stale marriage starts to heat up in ways Ben could only have dreamed about. Summer is ready to take his hotwife fantasy all the way, and her choice is a sexy, Italian, Michelin star-studded chef. It's too late to put the brakes on what he's set in motion when Ben discovers the humiliating truth about Summer's choice of man. Summer has a taste for being naughty, and a filthy little plan of her own. Will it be everything he could wish for, or will Ben's cuckold fantasy turn into a nightmare he can't escape?

Well-Constructed Affairs

As a hot female construction engineer, John's wife Adria draws a lot of attention at the job site. Which isn't all bad. But when Adria opens the door for him to tell her about his sexual fantasies, he doesn't realize she has opened the door on her own – very dark – fantasy as well. A fantasy she hasn't shared with anyone until now. The couple are off on an exploration of their desires...but is their marriage well-constructed enough to withstand the forces of their fantasies?

Nikita Gets In Too Deep

When Cole and his wife Nik arrive at their usual vacation spot in dull Cape Breton, they're taken by surprise by the most unlikely of next-door neighbors: ultra-sexy Paige and wealthy, commanding Mitch. And these new neighbors are full of surprises. Cole and Nik embark on new adventures in their marriage, trying new things and pushing boundaries they'd never even discussed. It's invigorating, but Cole can't help but wonder if his transformed wife hasn't gotten herself in too deep...

Not Black And White

When a photographer turns Rick on to the idea of watching his wife with another man, Rick feels an obsessive desire inside of himself catch fire. He can't help arrange for his shy, girl-next-door wife Danielle and the rugged, black photographer to cross paths. He knows that Drake Reyes' erotic photographs are not as abstract as they appear, and that Reyes sleeps with his married models. He knows his wife is not immune to Reyes' charms – no one is. He just can't help but imagine what it would be like to stand in his gallery, looking at Reyes' lurid photos, knowing his own wife is the model, knowing how the photos were taken. But was it really his idea, or have Drake and Danielle been as manipulative as he has?

Please note, this is the novelized version of the short story Black and White, with significant changes to all scenes depicted in the short story, as well as the point of view. There is, however, some repetition: scenarios which occurred in the short occur in the novel. There are plenty of fresh new adult scenes, however. Please enjoy.

A Dark Place: Cuckolded In Lagos

Three people are carving out their fortunes in Africa's largest city, but each of them holds a deeper, darker desire. What is the secret desire of the angelic Charlotte, who finds all men's eyes on her after dark in Lagos? What about Andrew, who keeps a secret hunger so buried perhaps he doesn't admit it even to himself? And what could be darker than Clement

Ambode's already shadowy “*reliability*” as an all-purpose contractor in the underbelly of Lagos?

Charlotte, Andrew, and Clement will find themselves in a very dark place when their worlds collide in this ultra-sexy, novella-length cuckold story.

NOVELLAS BY ARNICA

Try To Have Some Fun

Poor Keith. He's been condemned to a campy cruise with his family and friends. Worse yet, he suspects something is going on between his wife and bad-boy Hank, the husband of a family friend his wife has invited along. Keith's in for a very big surprise – and much more naughty, adult fun than he expected on this cruise – when he finds out what's really going on.

Claire's Cowboy

When he gives his wife Claire the gift of a vacation of her choice, Chris is perplexed when she wants to go on a horseback-riding adventure in Montana. Nothing about that kind of trip has ever appealed to Claire. Next, she mentions a mysterious ex-lover, and she turns out to be nearly a professional at riding horses. Chris can't help but wonder if her choice of vacation, and the rugged man who will lead the tour, are just an uncanny coincidence...or if there is something more to Claire's cowboy?

Nothing Better To Do

Rob is finding out from the locals in his wife's small mountain hometown that his soccer-mom wife Kirsten may have been quite a different person once upon a time. He'll find out the truth first-hand when a late summer blizzard traps everyone at a party, and his wife comes up with some very indecent ideas for passing the time.

After all, there's nothing better to do...

If you're a new fan of Arnica Butler, why don't you try [Wives Gone Wild](#)?

I've put together ten of my short stories about wives on vacation, who get taken every way you can think of while their husbands watch. **Ten stories for \$4.99!** For fans of my longer hotwife novels, these stories may not be for you (but then again...they might). These are quick or medium-length, dirty stories about men taking willing wives right out from under their husbands' noses. Most include very graphic scenes of humiliation, menage, cleanup and...well, that's all I can write about here!

Stories included in this bundle are: *Double-Cucked; Cuckolded in Texas by The Oil Tycoon; Watching My Wife Get Trucked; St. Paddy's Day Cucktale; A Long Hard Winter; Watching My Wife Get Lumberjacked; My Wife Goes Back To Black; Cuckolded On A Plane!; Cuckolded In Vegas!; and Cuckolded on My Dominican Vacation.*

All stories are available for purchase individually for \$2.99 and some are in Kindle Unlimited for free, with the exception of Cuckolded In Texas, which is only available here. I want to give readers a chance to read some of my earlier works and quickies at a discounted price.

Because sometimes, you just want to get down and dirty, right?
Enjoy!